Transparency Report: July to December 2023

Introduction

Reddit's mission is to bring community, belonging, and empowerment to everyone in the world, which requires ongoing efforts to keep Reddit safe, healthy, and real. As part of this, we regularly assess our platform and share insights and findings about the health of our communities, our efforts to foster safe interactions, and how we enforce our policies.

Our biannual Transparency Report provides insights and metrics about content moderation efforts by Reddit moderators and admins – including content proactively removed as a result of automated tooling – as well as community-level actions, impact on user accounts, and legal requests we received from governments, law enforcement agencies, and third parties to remove content or disclose user data from around the world.

Prior Reddit Transparency Reports are available in our Transparency Center. You can see our other updates on the Reddit blog and on r/RedditSecurity.

TL;DR

Redditors posted over 4.4 billion pieces of content on Reddit from July through December 2023 (+.2% compared to the first half of the year), bringing the total content shared on Reddit in 2023 to over 8.8 billion posts, comments, private messages, and chats (+6% over 2022).

Mods and admins removed 3.7% of the total content created (1.9% by mods and 1.8% by admins), compared to 3.8% for the preceding six months. As expected, spam accounted for the majority of admin removals (67.7%), with the remainder being for various Content Policy violations (29.6%) and other reasons, such as content manipulation (2.7%).

Excluding spam and other content manipulation, admins performed roughly 22.3% of all content removals during the second half of 2023, representing a 43.8% increase in admin actions since our last report. As Reddit's tools and enforcement capabilities keep evolving, we continue to see a trend of admins gradually taking on more content moderation actions from moderators, leaving moderators more room to focus on their individual community rules.

We're also bringing our approach to community-level enforcement into increased focus through the introduction of a new "Communities" section in this report. This includes Reddit admin actions taken to ensure that subreddits and moderators adhere to our Content Policy and abide by expectations laid out in the Moderator Code of Conduct.

Finally, now that we have published four 6-month datasets (beginning with our first Mid-Year Transparency Report in 2022), we are able to provide more useful trends and information across the legal request sections of the report. Interestingly, we saw overall decreases in global government and law enforcement legal requests to remove content and produce account information compared to the first half of 2023. At the same time, there was an increase in terrorist content removals between July and December 2023, where 60% of the removed content was related to the tragic events in Israel and Gaza that began in October.

Read on for more details about all of the latest data and insights.

Our Approach to Content Moderation

Content moderation on Reddit happens through a layered, community-driven approach. This approach is akin to a democracy, wherein everyone has the ability to vote and self-organize, follow a set of common rules, establish community-specific norms, and ultimately share some responsibility for how the platform works.

Reddit's Content Policy serves as a set of principles-based rules that apply to the entire Reddit platform, including our users and content on Reddit. Users then create their own communities (known as "subreddits") and establish additional rules that are tailored to a community's unique and often highly specific needs.

Users who write and enforce these community-specific rules are volunteer moderators (known as "mods"), and they perform the majority of community moderation actions without involvement from Reddit, Inc. This self-moderation effort at the community level continues to be the most scalable solution we've seen to the challenges of moderating content and behavior online. Reddit employees (known as "admins") are responsible for enforcing the Content Policy across Reddit with the help of mods, who apply the Content Policy to their communities in addition to their own specific rules. All of this is done through a combination of automated tooling and human review to prevent, detect, and remove violating content.

We also receive government and law enforcement requests from around the world regarding removal of content for alleged violations of local law. We review each of these requests carefully and object when appropriate. In situations where we find no underlying Content Policy violations, Reddit may restrict access to the reported content in the requesting country if it violates local law. For more information, please refer to the "Legal Removals" section of this report.

Content Policy Updates

In July 2023, we announced updates to Rule 3 and Rule 4 of our Content Policy to clarify the scopes of these rules as part of our ongoing efforts to evolve sitewide policies and keep Reddit safe and healthy.

First, we updated the language of our Rule 3 policy prohibiting non-consensual intimate media to reinforce existing prohibitions against faked depictions of non-consensual intimate media, including those generated through AI tools.

With the Rule 4 update, we added language to make it even clearer that inappropriate and predatory behaviors involving minors are strictly prohibited, and we will continue to actively enforce against this content following our existing procedures. In addition, we expanded the scope of Rule 4 to explicitly disallow non-sexual forms of abuse of minors (e.g., neglect, physical or emotional abuse). Importantly, it is worth noting that this change does not prohibit supportive conversations in which survivors of abuse or concerned community members discuss their experience or seek help.

One of the goals of these updates was to help users better understand our policies and report violating content. In line with this, from July to December 2023, we observed a 216% increase in the number of user reports about posts and comments that resulted in admin removal for Rule 4 violations as well as an improvement in the actionability of these reports compared to the first half of 2023.

Content on Reddit

Every day, millions of people around the world post comments and share other content on Reddit. In the second half of 2023, redditors shared over 4.4 billion pieces of content across Reddit's diverse communities (slightly more than in the first half of 2023). To keep this vibrant platform healthy, we deploy our layered, community-driven approach to content moderation. In addition to our proactive moderation efforts, Reddit regularly receives and processes reports and requests to remove content from the platform.

From July to December 2023, 3.7% of the total content created on Reddit was removed across all content types (1.9% by mods and 1.8% by admins). These figures include removals performed through automation by a scaled community moderation tool called AutoMod, as well as bespoke moderation bots built by community moderators and internal automated tooling used by Reddit admins. It's worth noting that these removal rates have stayed consistent with prior reporting periods, including January to June 2023 (3.8%) and January to December 2022 (3.7%).

Chart 1: Content created on Reddit (July-December 2023)

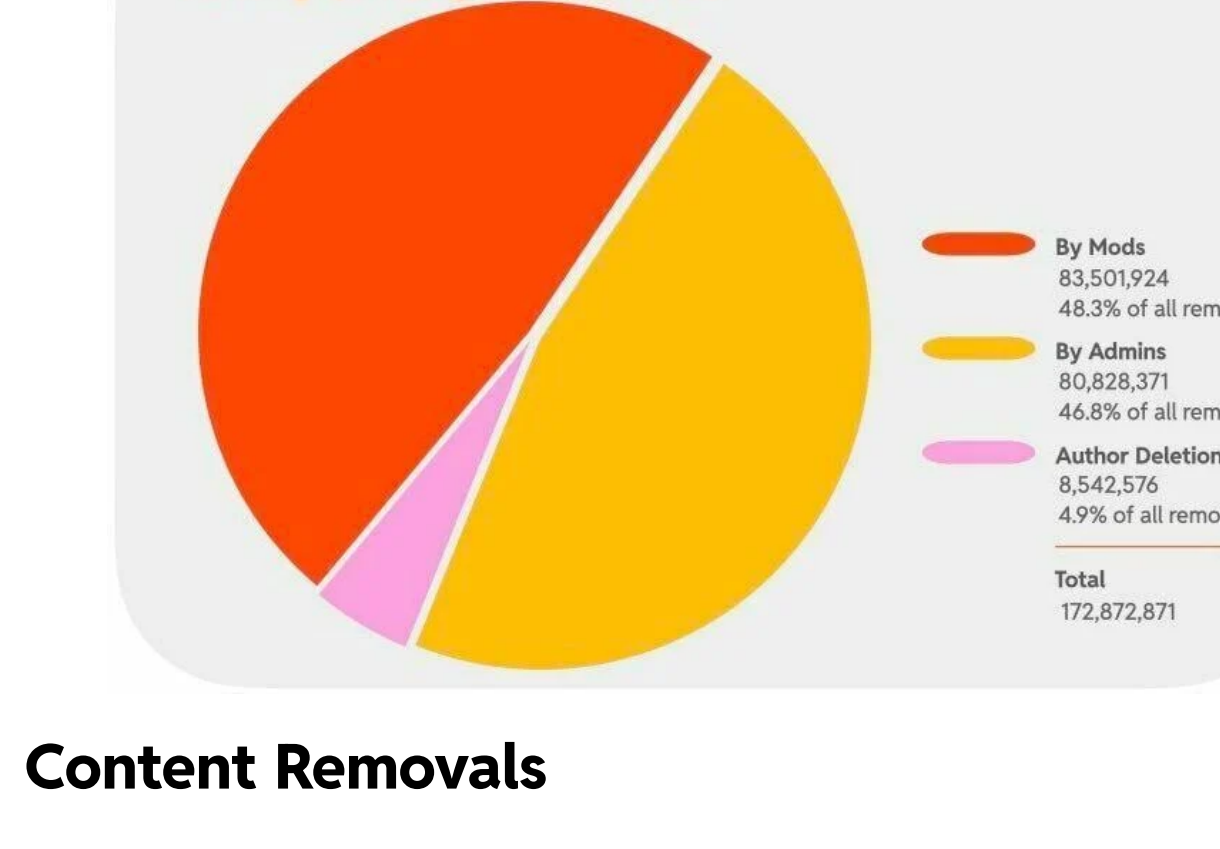
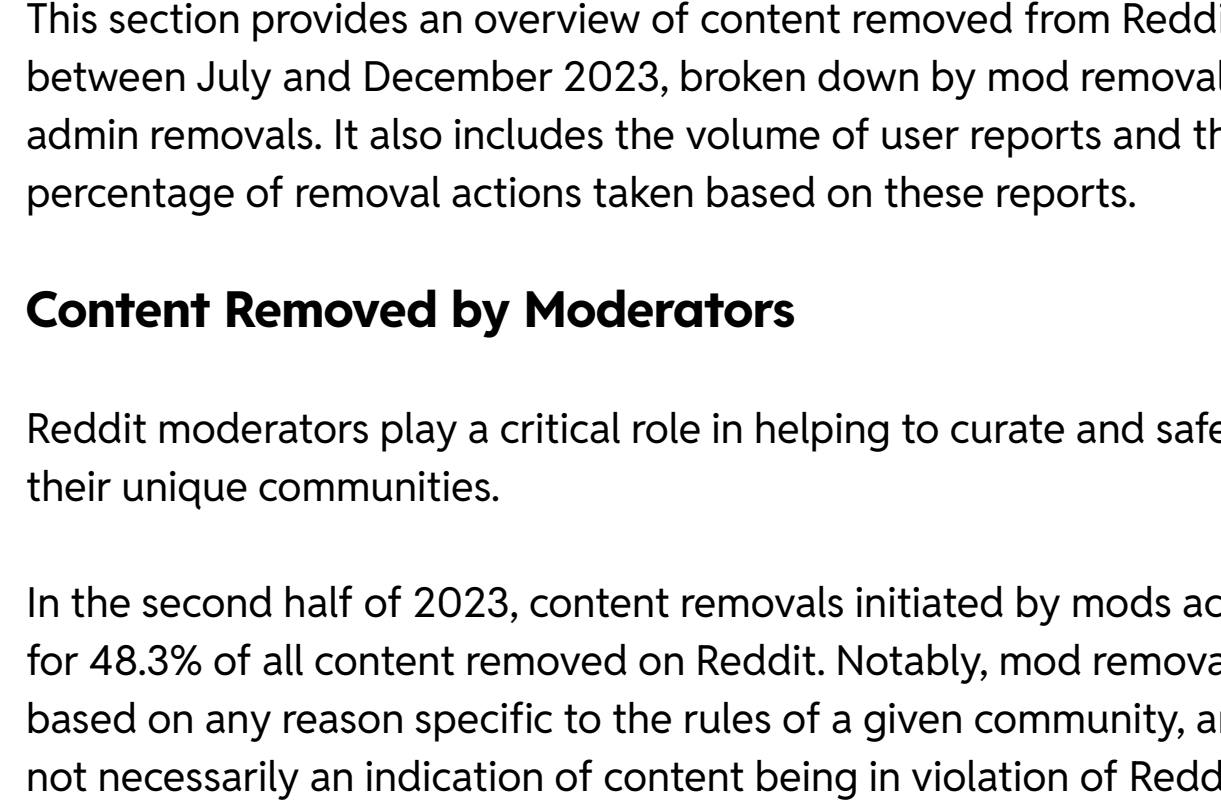


Chart 2 : Pieces of content removed from Reddit for any reason including Spam (July-December 2023)



Content Removals

This section provides an overview of content removed from Reddit between July and December 2023, broken down by mod removals and admin removals. It also includes the volume of user reports and the percentage of removal actions taken based on these reports.

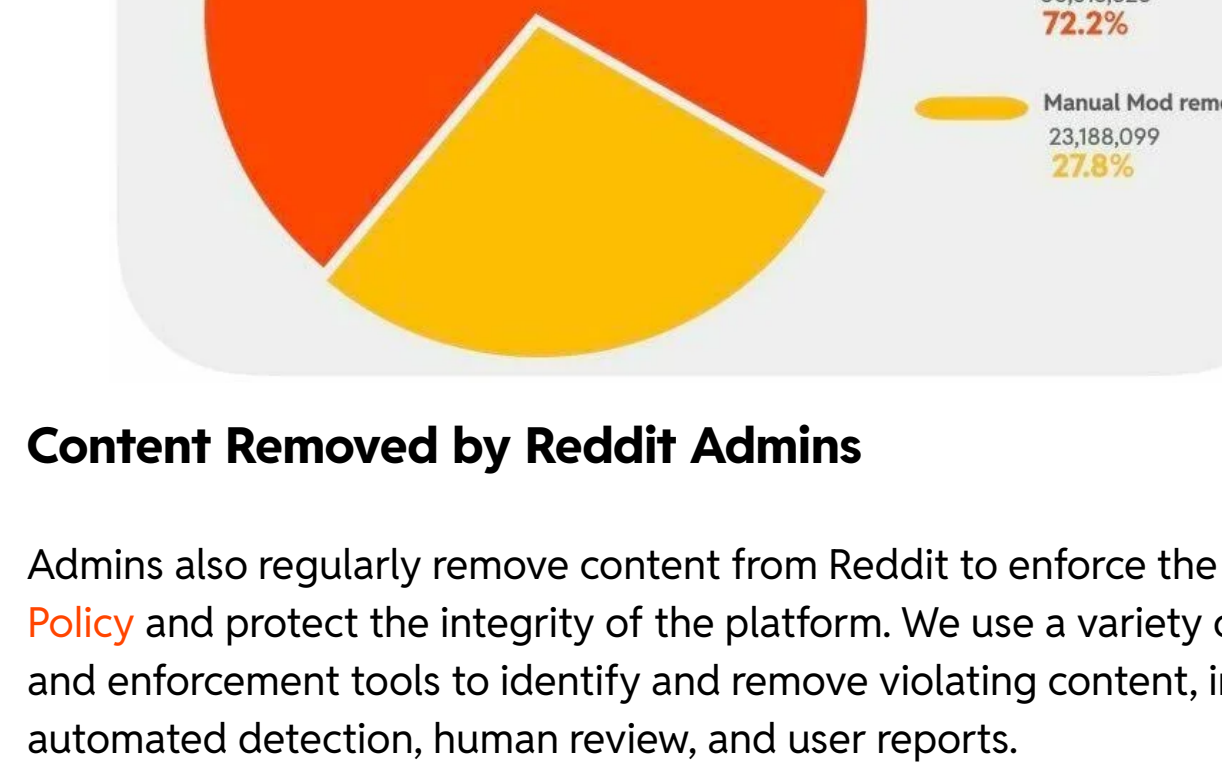
Content Removed by Moderators

Reddit moderators play a critical role in helping to curate and safeguard their unique communities.

In the second half of 2023, content removals initiated by mods accounted for 48.3% of all content removed on Reddit. Notably, mod removals can be based on any reason specific to the rules of a given community, and are not necessarily an indication of content being in violation of Reddit's Content Policy.

Mods use a combination of automated tooling and human review to keep their communities as safe and healthy as possible. The clear majority of content removal actions by mods – 72.2% – were the result of proactive Automod removals, while the total volume of Automod removals decreased by 3.2% compared to the first half of 2023. This corresponds with a 4% decrease in the total volume of mod removals during that period.

Chart 3: Content removed by moderators (July-December 2023)



Content Removed by Reddit Admins

Admins also regularly remove content from Reddit to enforce the Content Policy and protect the integrity of the platform. We use a variety of signals and enforcement tools to identify and remove violating content, including automated detection, human review, and user reports.

From July to December 2023, over 2.19 billion posts, comments, and private messages (PMs) were shared on Reddit, while 164,330,295 (7.5%) of them were removed. Admins performed approximately 49.2% of these removals (a slight 2.5% increase compared to the first half of the year), and were exclusively responsible for removals of violating PMs.

As in previous reporting periods, the vast majority of admin removals were for content manipulation, which includes spam (accounting for 67.7% of these removals), and issues like community interference (i.e., "brigading"), vote manipulation (attempts to interfere with Reddit's upvote/downvote tallies), and other attempts to artificially promote content (collectively making up 2.7% of these removals). The remaining share of admin removals (29.6%) were for other violations of the Content Policy.

This means that, excluding spam (and other content manipulation), admins performed close to 22.3% of all content removals, while 77.7% were performed by moderators. As discussed, moderator removals also include removals for violations of their individual community rules, whereas admin removals only include violations of our sitewide policies. Compared to the last reporting period, we saw a 43.8% increase in admin removal actions. As Reddit's tools and enforcement capabilities keep evolving, we continue to see a trend of admins gradually taking on more of the Content Policy moderation actions from moderators.

For a more detailed breakdown of admin removal actions by rule violation, please refer to the "Content Types" section below.

Note: In the graphs below, "content removed" includes posts, comments, and private messages (PMs) – chats are *not* included, as sanctions for policy violations in chat are applied at the user account level.

Chart 4: Content removed by admins (not including spam and other content manipulation) vs. content removed by mods (July-December 2023)

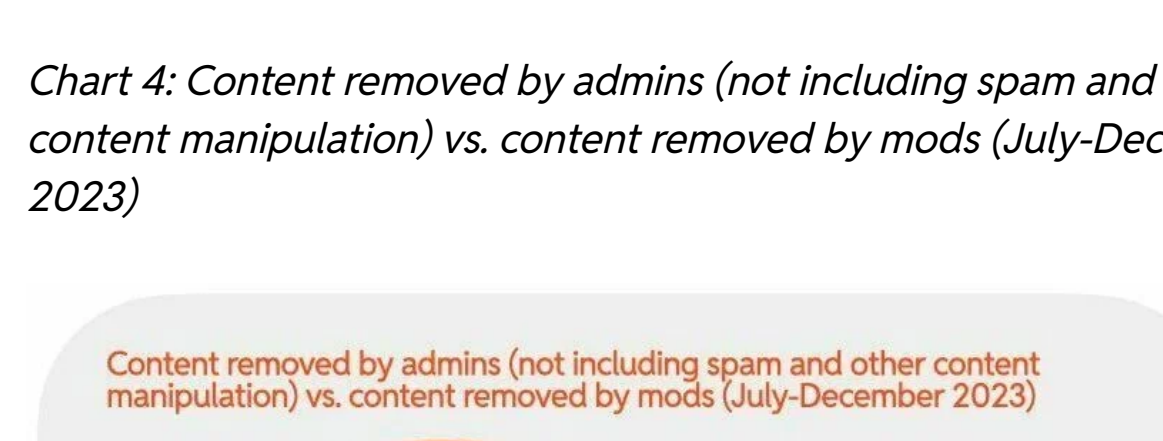
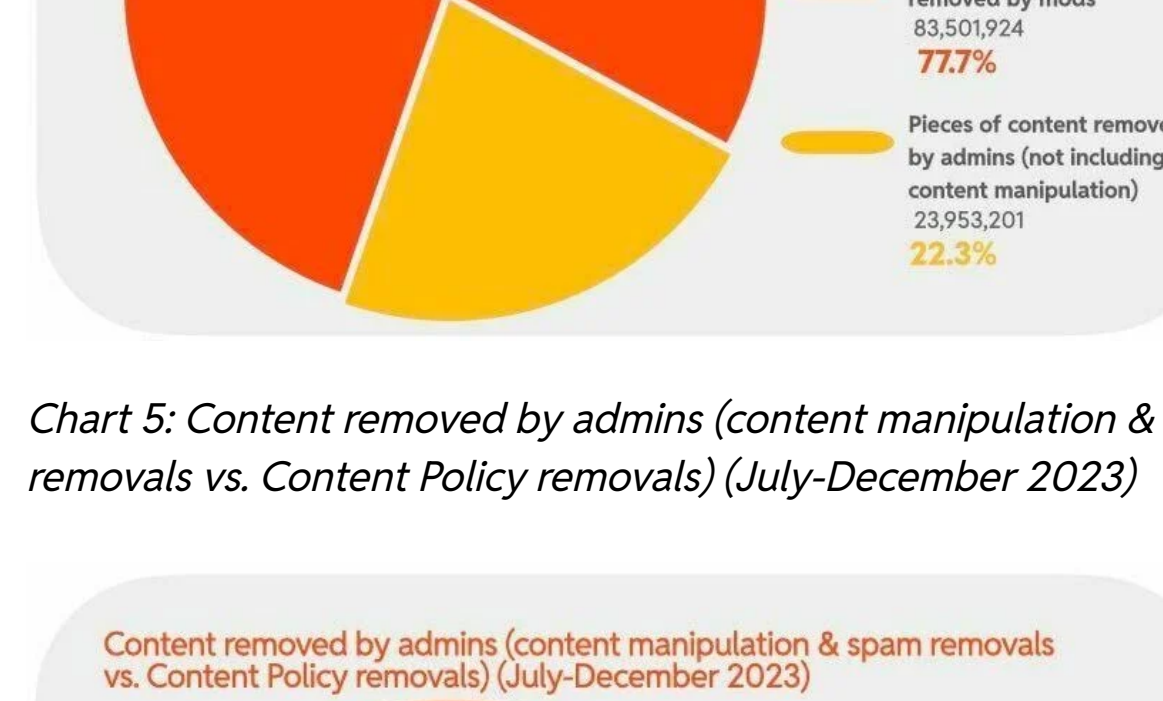


Chart 5: Content removed by admins (content manipulation & spam removals vs. Content Policy removals) (July-December 2023)



User Reports

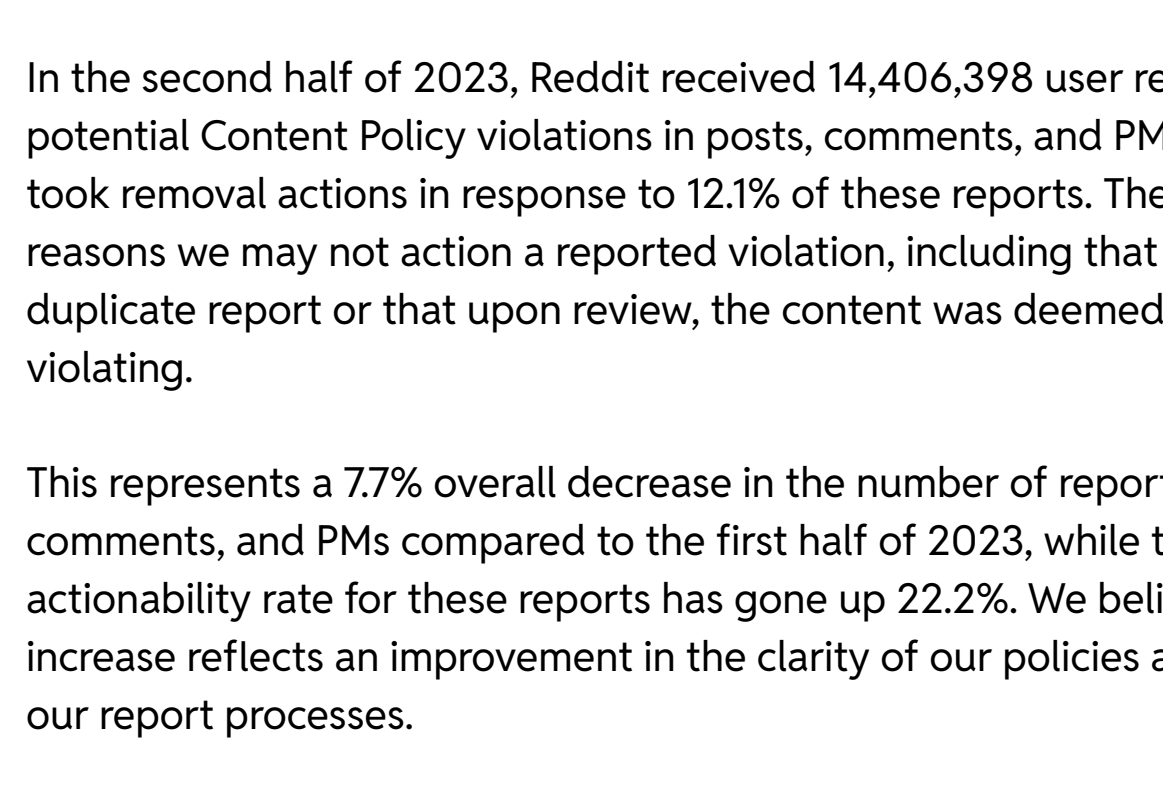
Users may report content on Reddit via our Reddit Help Center, reddit.com/report, or by using the "Report" button directly on a post or comment. By submitting a report, users can anonymously alert a community's team of moderators and/or Reddit administrators to something that potentially violates either a particular community's rules or Reddit's Content Policy.

In the second half of 2023, Reddit received 14,406,398 user reports for potential Content Policy violations in posts, comments, and PMs. Admins took removal actions in response to 12.1% of these reports. There are many reasons we may not action a reported violation, including that it is a duplicate report or that upon review, the content was deemed non-violating.

This represents a 7.7% overall decrease in the number of reported posts, comments, and PMs compared to the first half of 2023, while the actionability rate for these reports has gone up 22.2%. We believe this increase reflects an improvement in the clarity of our policies as well as our report processes.

Note: These numbers do not include user reports from chats as those are actioned with account-level sanctions. Please refer to the "Chats" section below.

Chart 6 : User reports - Posts, comments, PMs (July-December 2023)



Content Types

This section breaks down admin removals, from July to December 2023, by content type, source of the report or flag (i.e., whether it was reported by users or flagged by Reddit's automated systems), and, where possible, by violation of the sitewide Content Policy.

Starting with this report, this section will exclusively focus on posts, comments, private messages, and chats. We've added a new section below (called "Communities") that reflects admin enforcement actions applicable to subreddits and mods.

Posts & Comments

Reddit admins remove posts and comments that violate our Content Policy. The numbers below include posts and comments removed by Reddit teams in the second half of 2023, broken out by rule violation, volume of user reports or automated flags, and actionability rate.

Chart 7 : Post & comments created vs. reported/flagged vs. removed (July-December 2023)

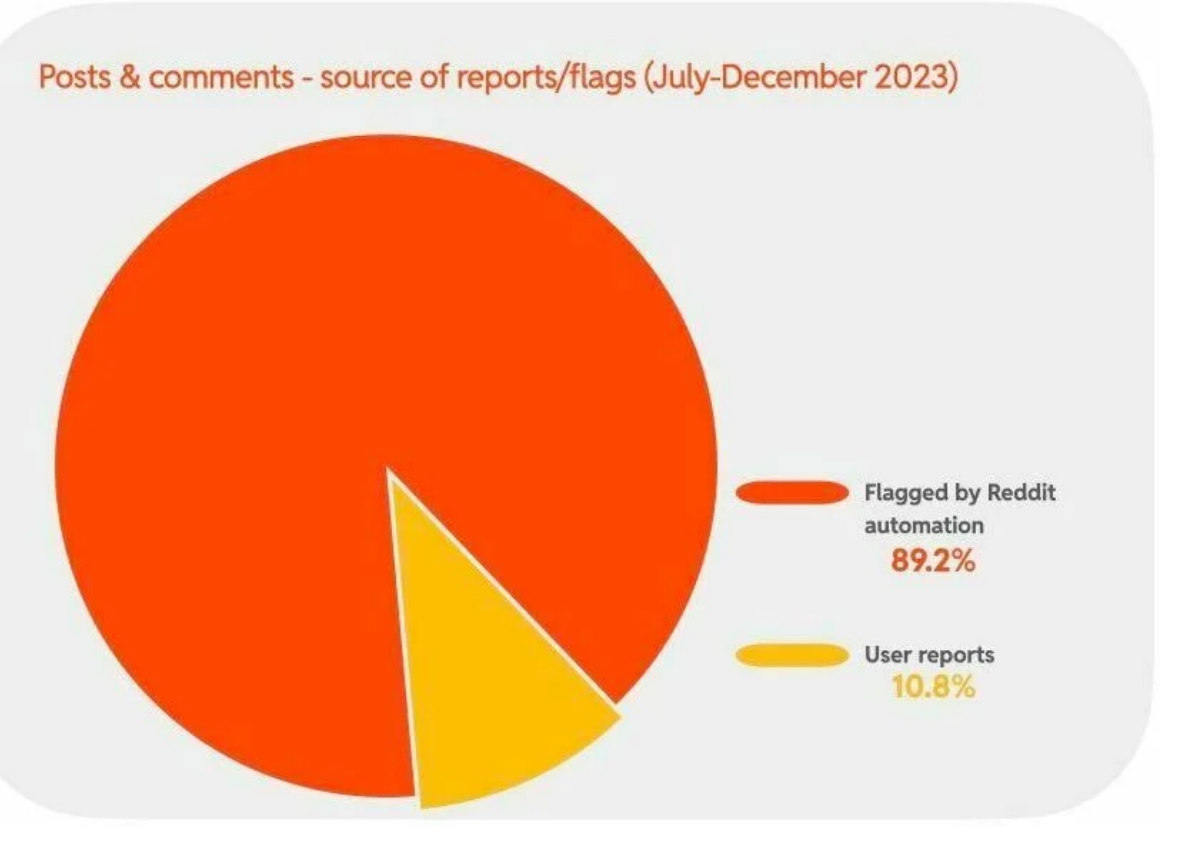


Chart 8 : Posts & comments - source of reports/flags (July-December 2023)

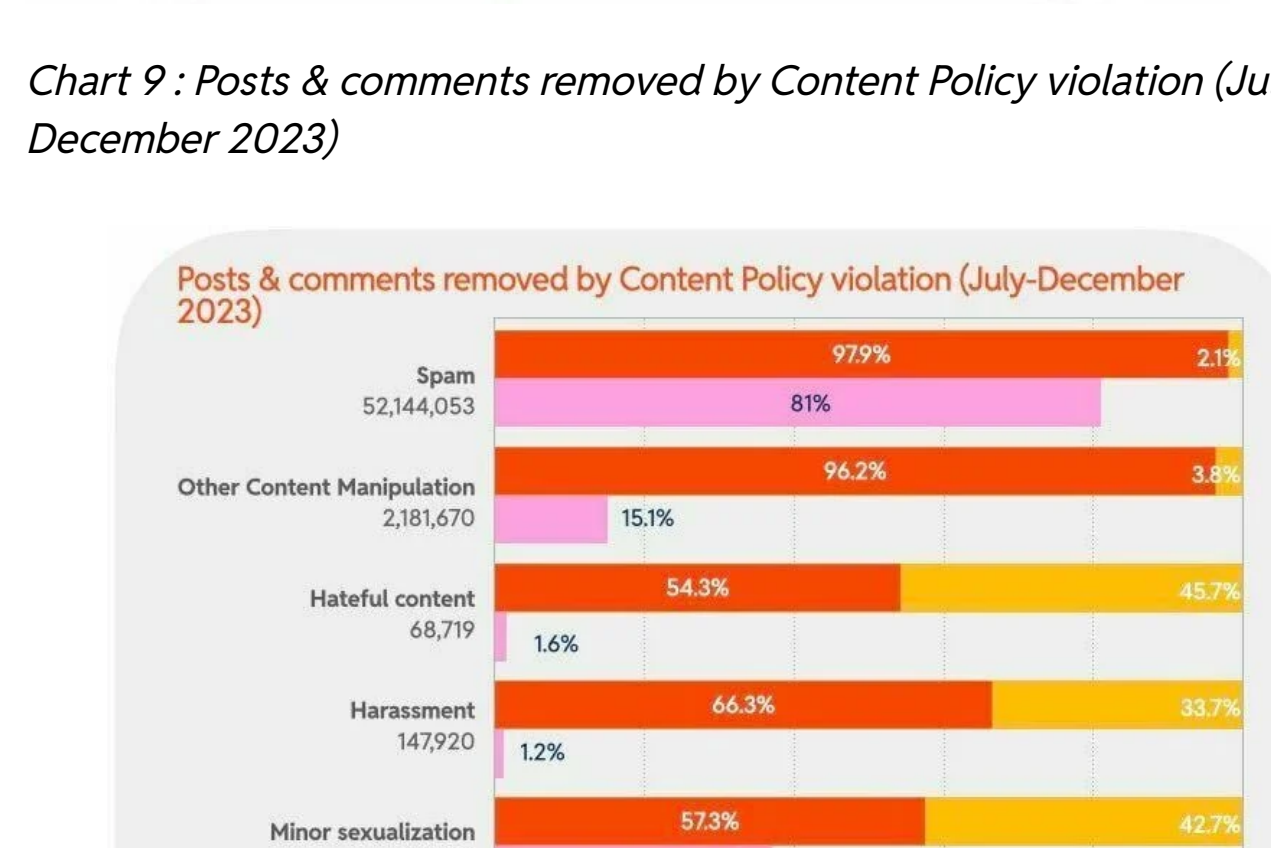
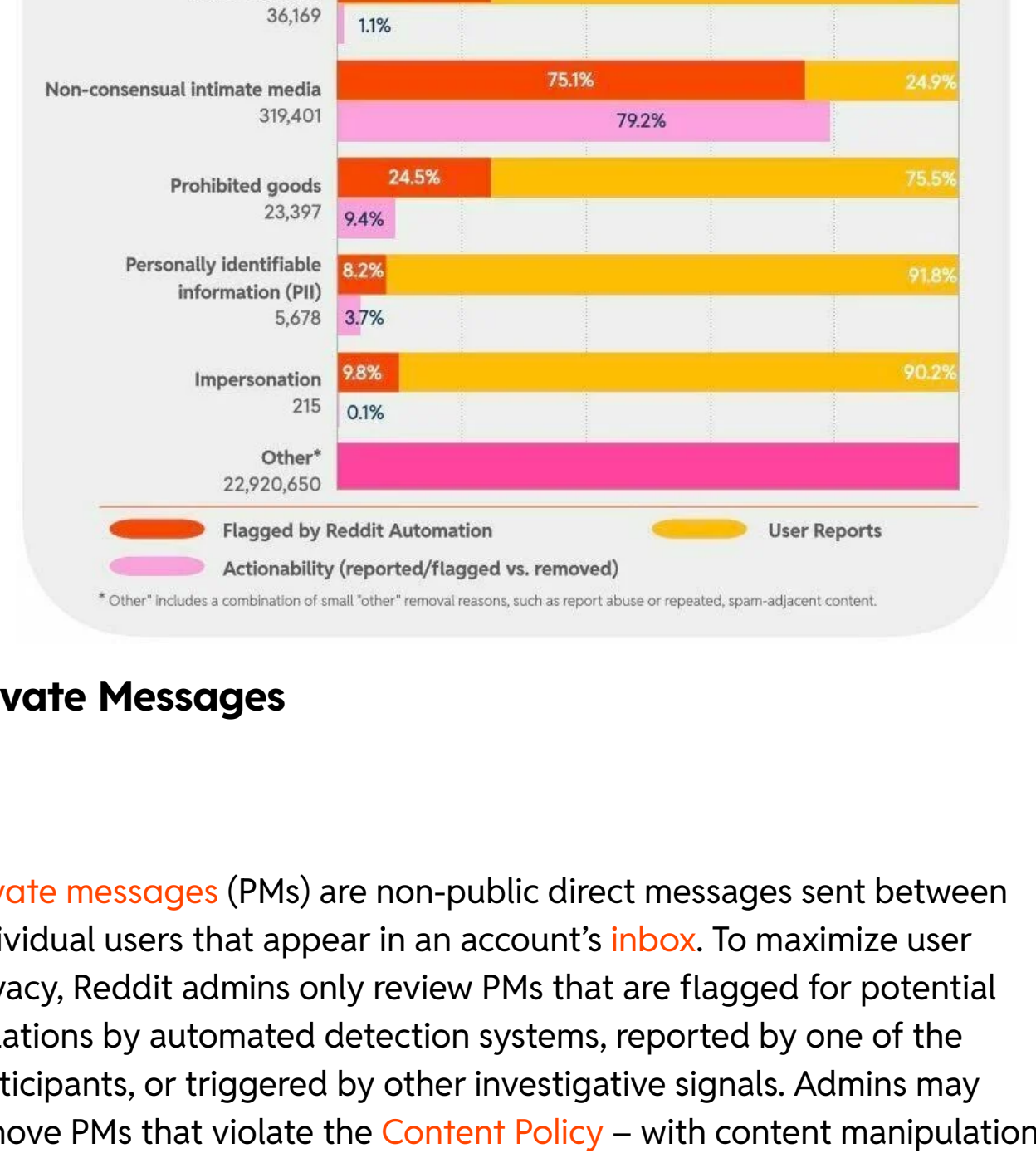


Chart 9 : Posts & comments removed by Content Policy violation (July-December 2023)



Private Messages

Private messages (PMs) are non-public direct messages sent between individual users that appear in an account's inbox. To maximize user privacy, Reddit admins only review PMs that are flagged for potential violations by automated detection systems, reported by one of the participants, or triggered by other investigative signals. Admins may remove PMs that violate the Content Policy – with content manipulation (primarily spam), harassment, and violence being the most common violation categories.

Between July and December 2023, 393,044,687 PMs were sent on Reddit, with 2,631,221 removed by admins for Content Policy violations. The vast majority of violating PMs were initially flagged by Reddit's automated detection systems (98.9%), and the primary violation category was Spam (2,543,406 removals).

Chart 10 : PMs sent vs. reported/flagged vs. removed (July-December 2023)

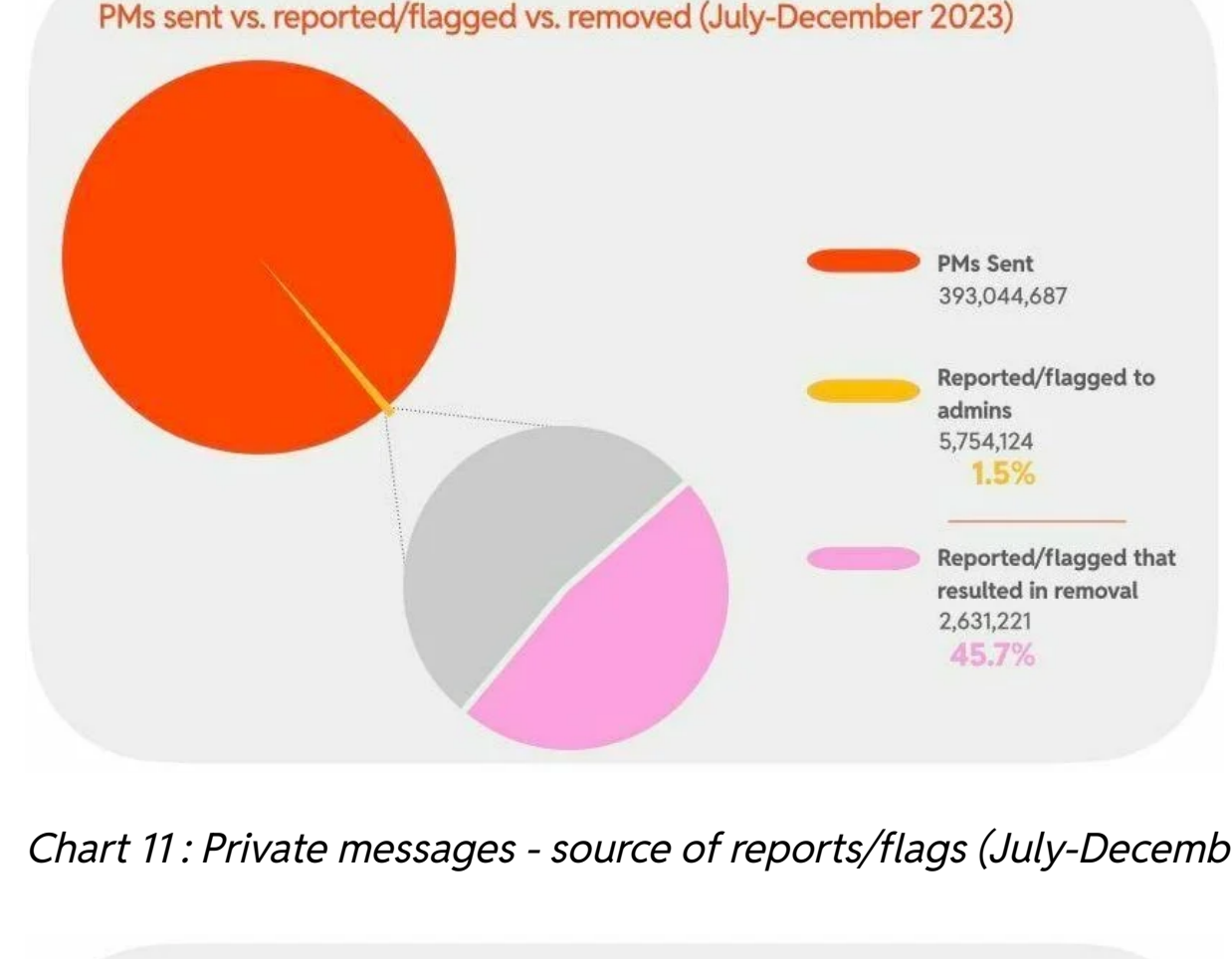


Chart 11 : Private messages - source of reports/flags (July-December 2023)

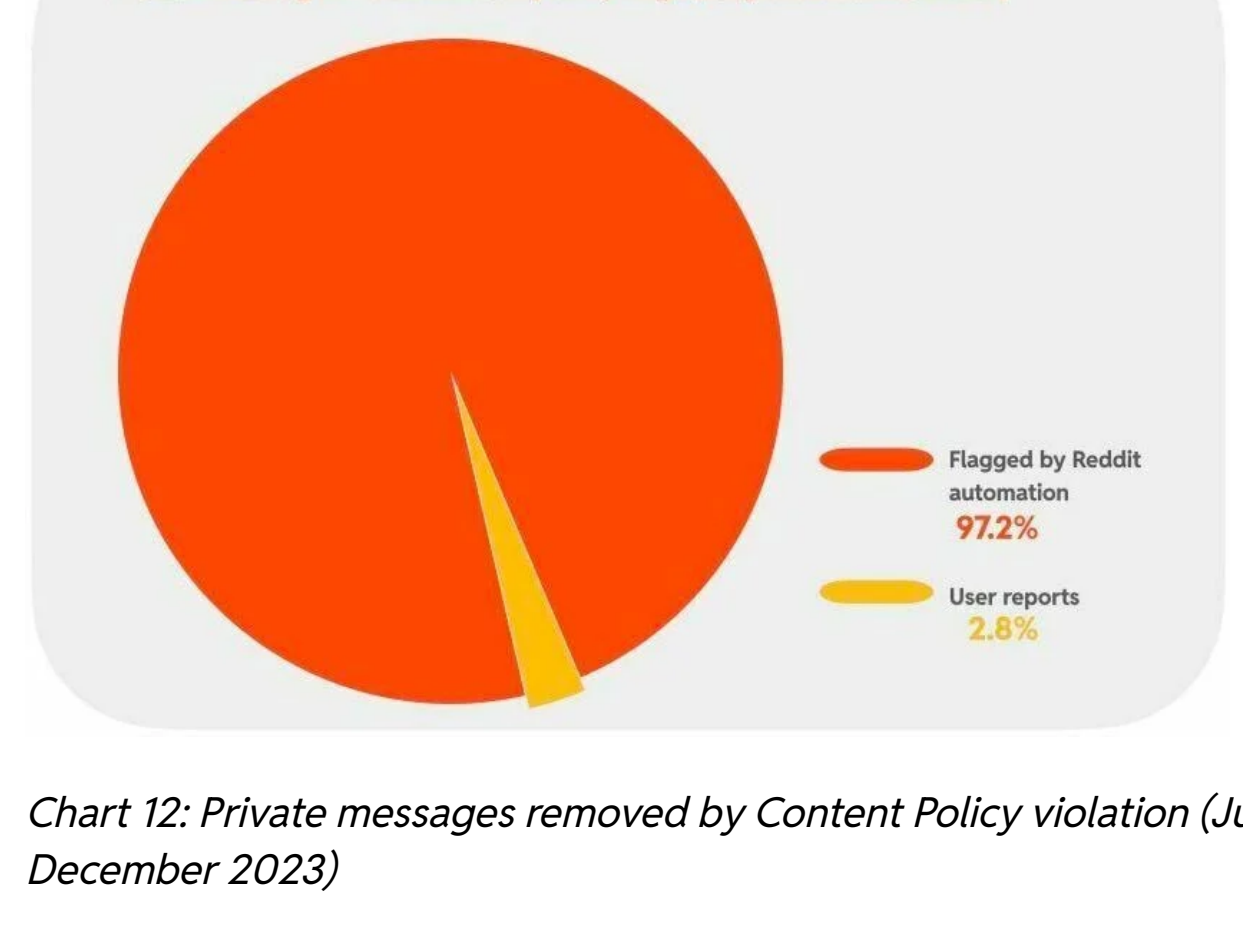
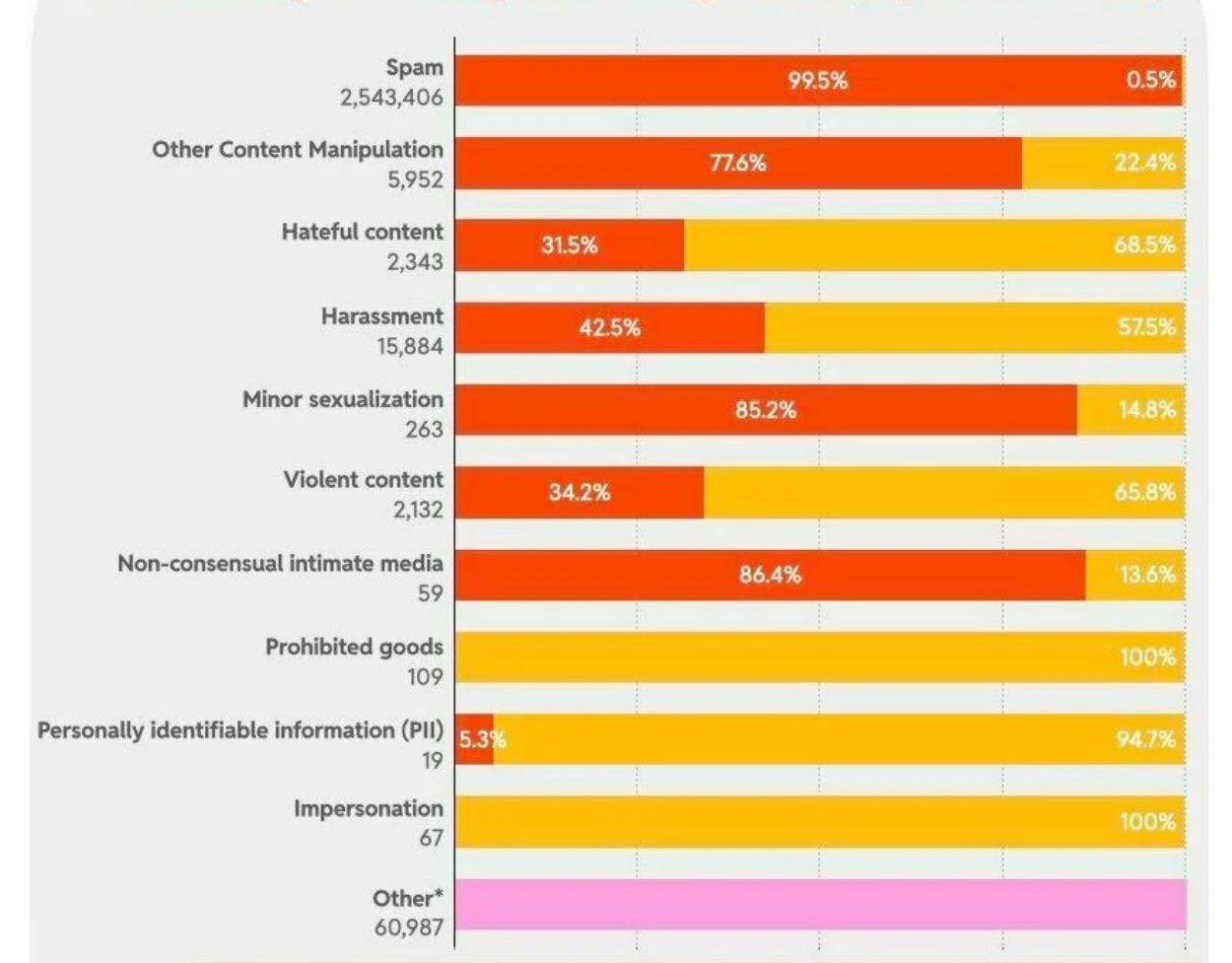


Chart 12: Private messages removed by Content Policy violation (July-December 2023)



Total
2,631,221
Flagged by Reddit Automation
User Reports
* "Other" includes a combination of removal reasons that usually target repeated, spam-adjacent content.

Chats

Redditors can send requests to other users to start real-time conversations in group chats at any time. From July to December 2023, a total of 2,233,352,871 chat messages were exchanged.

During the same period, 165,497,342 chat messages were flagged by Reddit automation, while 541,696 were reported by users for potential violations. These automated flags and user reports resulted in 1,817,414 accounts being temporarily and/or permanently suspended by admins for violating Reddit's Content Policy. For more information, please refer to the "Account Sanctions" section below.

Chart 13: Chat messages sent vs. reported/flagged vs. account-level sanctions (July-December 2023)

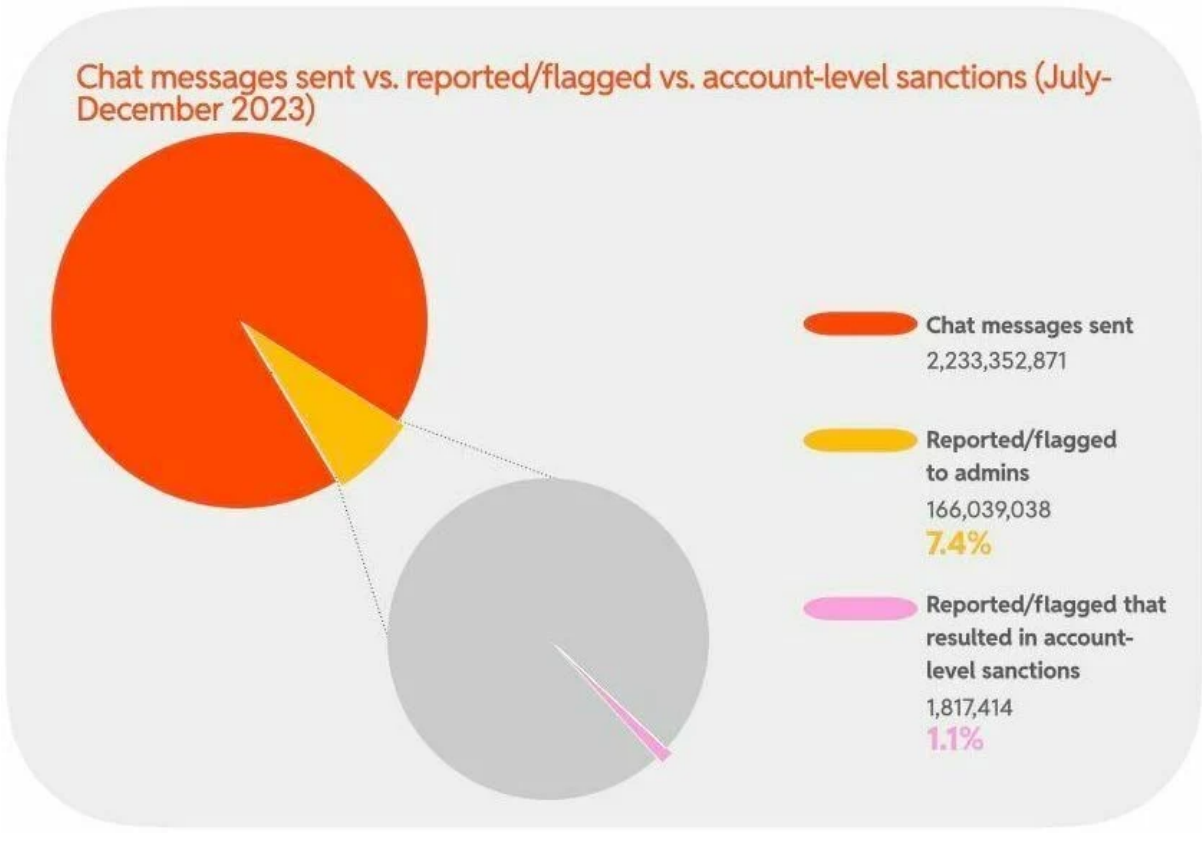
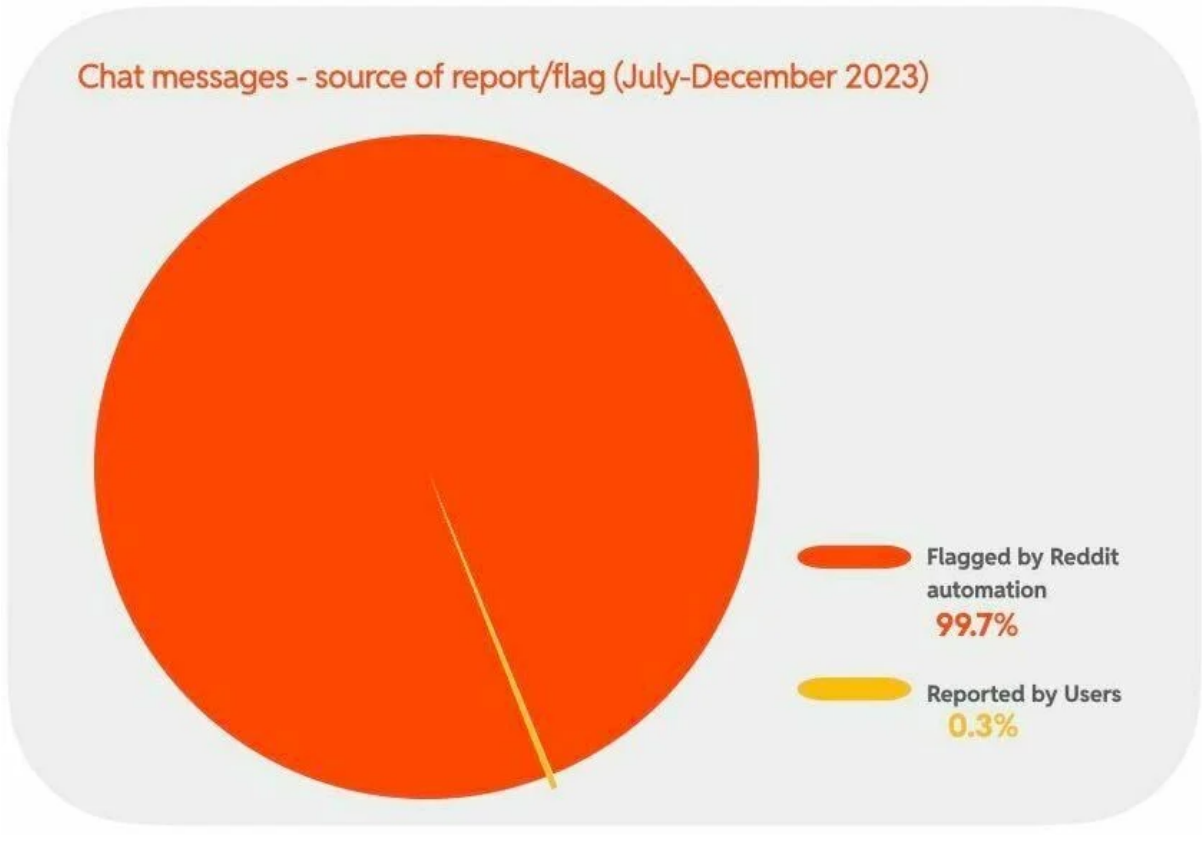


Chart 14 : Chat messages - source of report/flag (July-December 2023)



Communities

Reddit is powered by a vast network of communities, aka subreddits. In the second half of 2023, there were 1,013,223 new communities created on Reddit – more than a 15% increase compared to the last reporting period.

Reddit communities are created, run, and populated by Reddit users – some of these users help manage these subreddits as community moderators, and play an important role in shaping each community's culture and norms.

In this new section, we're bringing our approach to community-level enforcement into focus. This includes sharing metrics and insights into Reddit admin actions taken to ensure that subreddits and moderators adhere to the Content Policy and abide by expectations laid out in the Moderator Code of Conduct.

Subreddits

Bans

While many Reddit communities are valuable spaces for redditors to engage on any number of niche topics, Reddit admins ban communities that are found to be spam-related, in violation of other rules, or lack active moderation. We work hard to quickly detect and ban inherently abusive communities; however, the decision to ban more established communities is never taken lightly, and can only be carried out by Reddit admins.

From July to December 2023, admins banned 640,685 communities (newly created and existing) for Content Policy violations, representing close to a 31% increase compared to the number of bans issued over the preceding 6-month period.

Notably, year over year, it's not uncommon to observe a pattern of holiday-related spam campaigns in the month of December, and we incorporated additional user signals to detect and action violating communities more quickly. As a result, spam-related bans constitute close to two-thirds of the overall number of bans in this period, and the number of communities banned by admins for non-spam related violations is 183,836. These bans were largely due to communities being unmoderated (92%).

Chart 15 : Subreddits created vs. banned (not including spam-related bans) (July-December 2023)

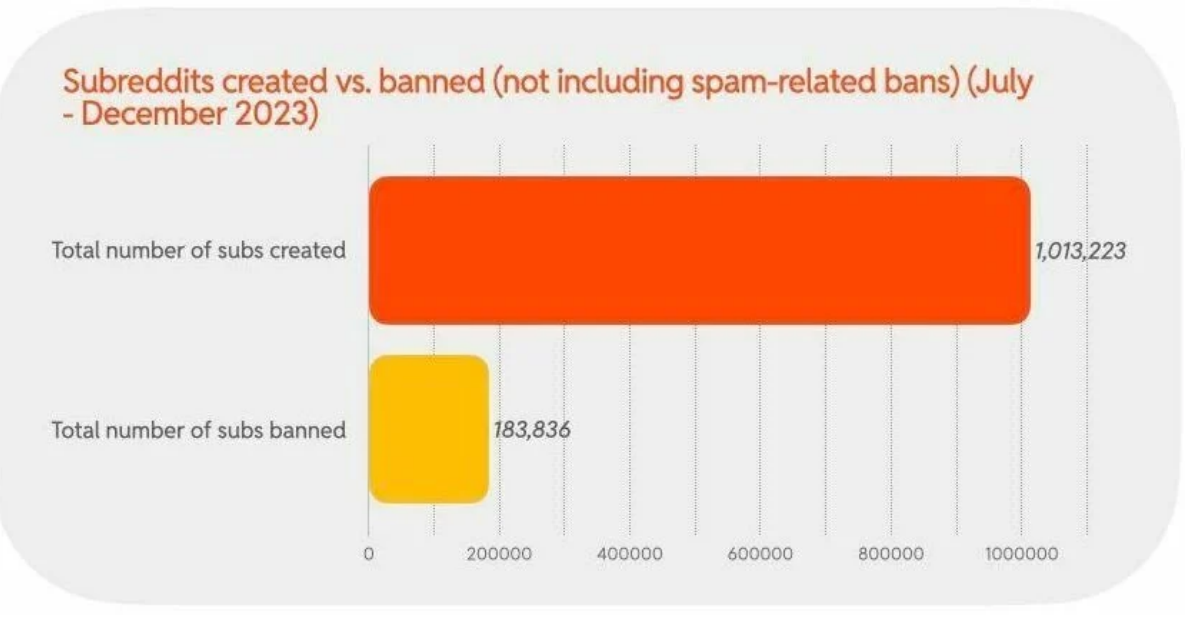
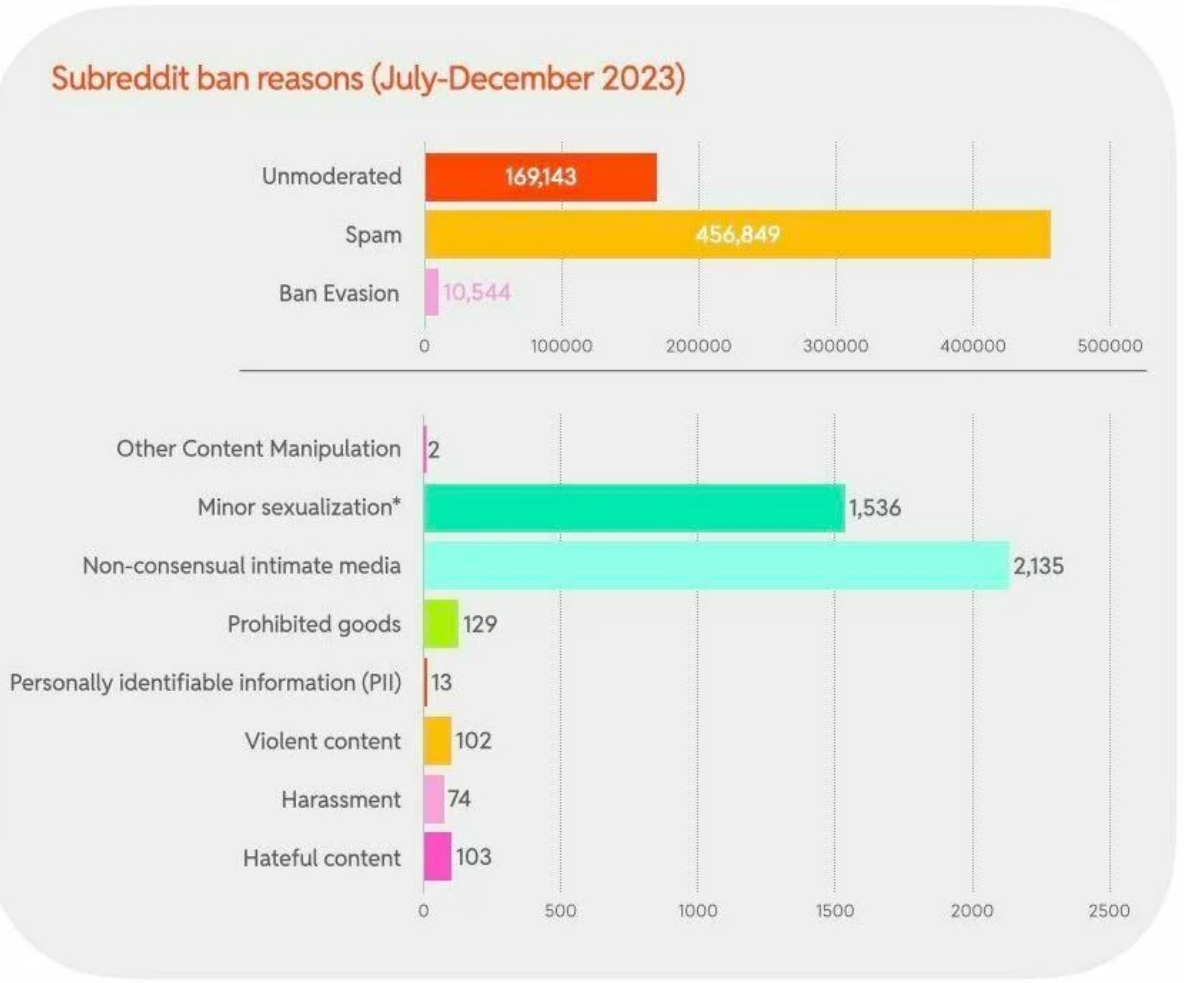


Chart 16 : Subreddit ban reasons (July-December 2023)



Moderator Code of Conduct

The Moderator Code of Conduct outlines our expectations for community moderators. Redditors can flag to admins instances in which moderators and/or subreddits might be in violation of the Code.

Admins conduct outreach when we determine that a moderator or moderator team has violated the Moderator Code of Conduct––whether it be for allowing policy-violating content, interfering or encouraging interference with other communities, inactive moderation, or other issues. The intent of the outreach is to educate and rehabilitate and, when that doesn't work, we may take actions which are outlined below.

From July through December 2023, Reddit investigated 434 potential violations of the Moderator Code of Conduct, leading to a 92.3% actionability rate. As a result of these investigations, Reddit admins sent 1,711 educational outreach messages and took 7,118 enforcement-related actions, including 92 community bans. We detail the breakdown of outreach and enforcement actions in Chart 19 below, which range from sending educational resources, to removing one or more mods, temporarily restricting a community, limiting posting functionality within a community, etc.

Chart 17 : Mod Code of Conduct Investigations by Rule (July-December 2023)

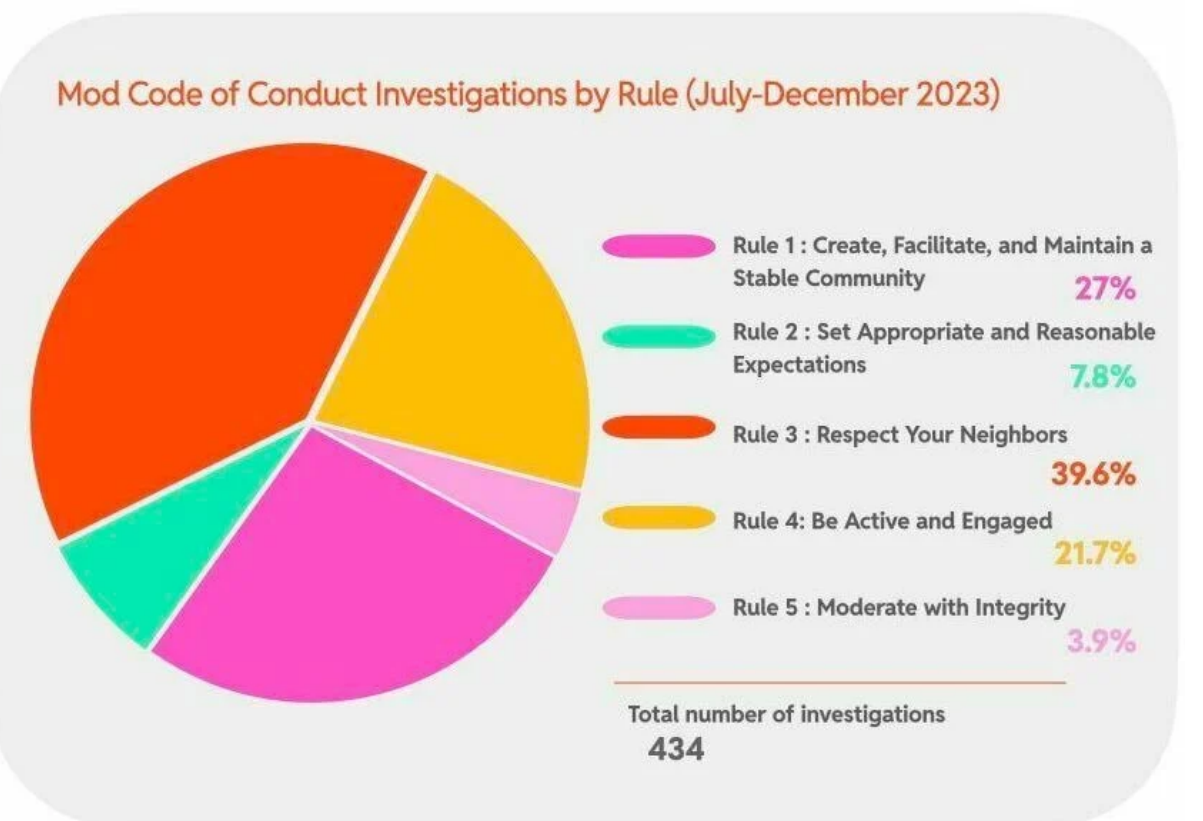


Chart 18 : Geographic Breakdown of Mod Code of Conduct Investigations (July-December 2023)*

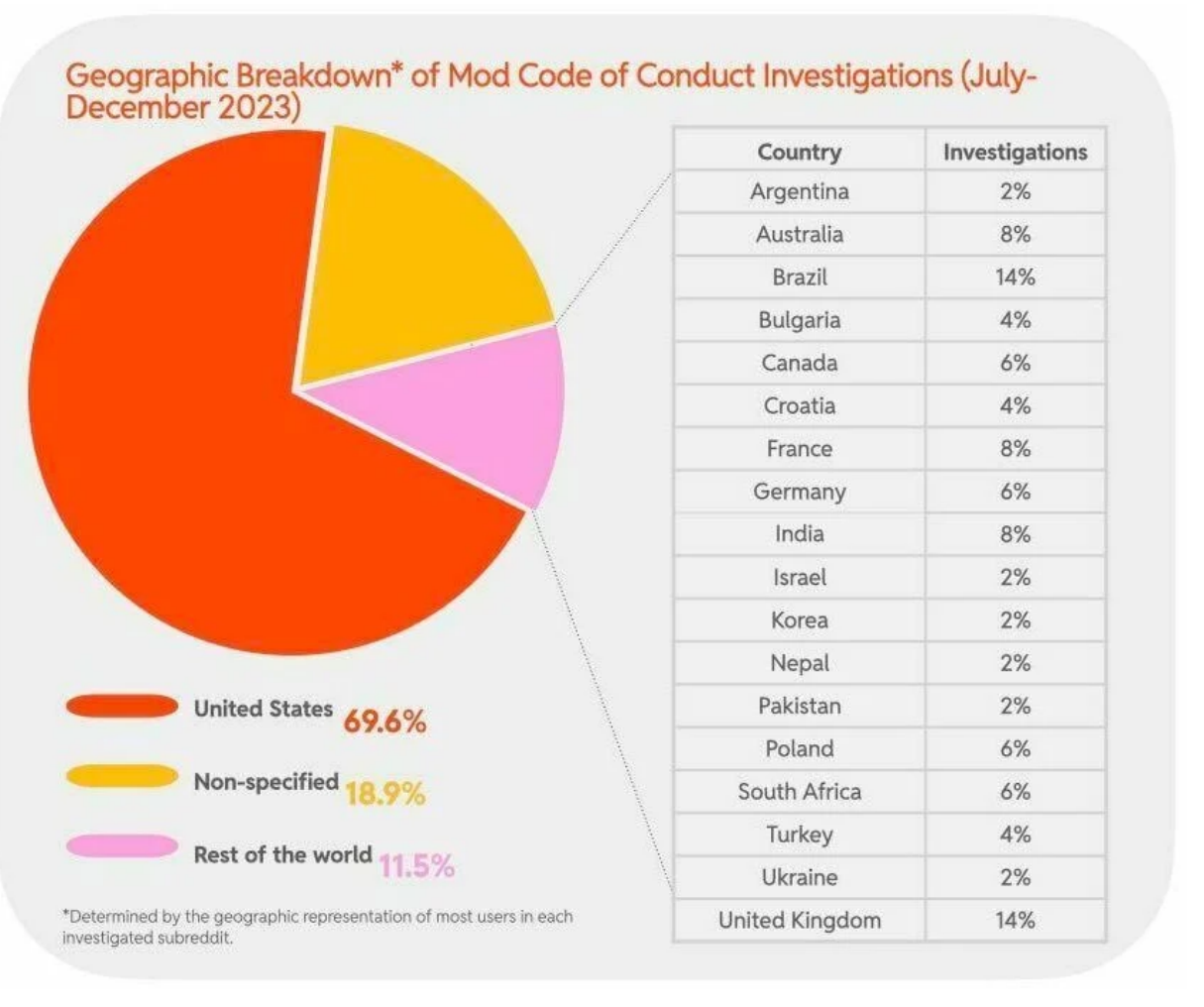
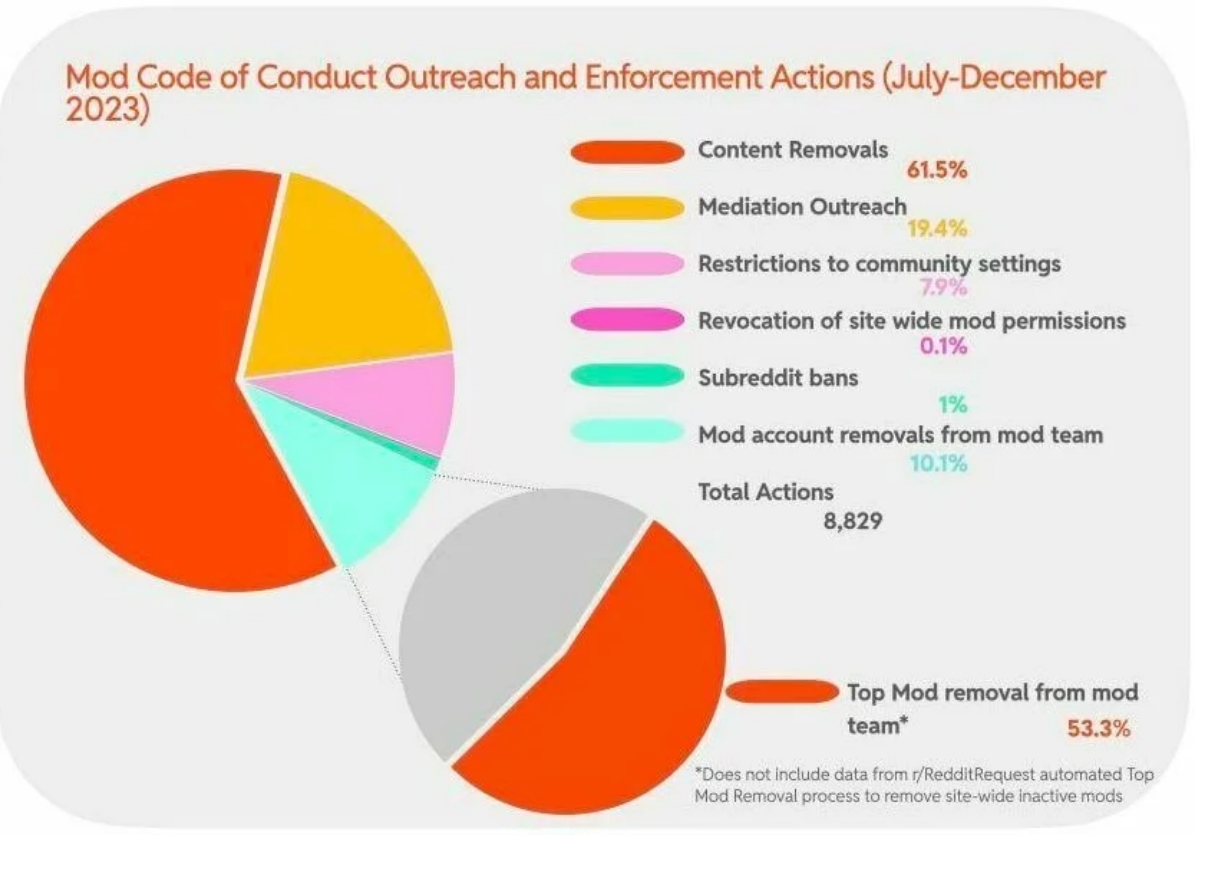


Chart 19 : Mod Code of Conduct Outreach and Enforcement Actions (July-December 2023)



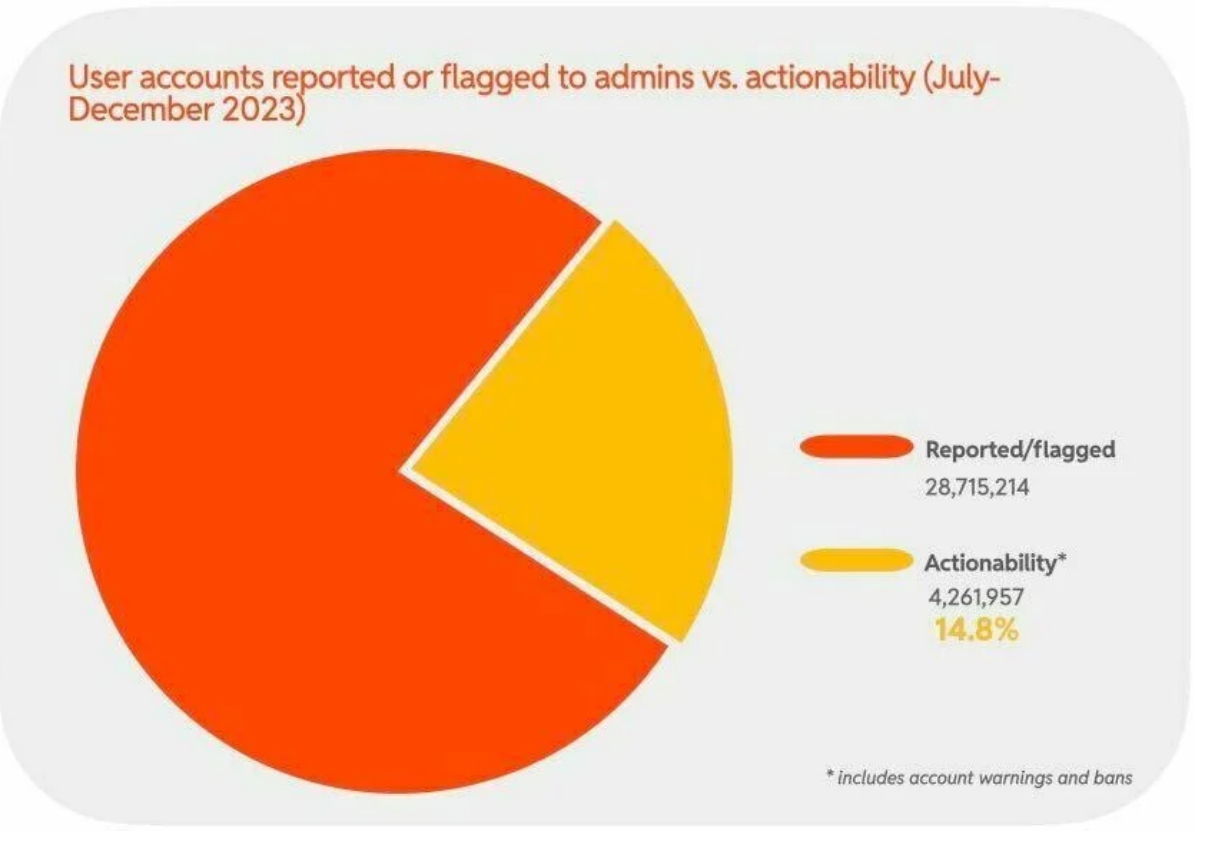
User Accounts

Account Sanctions by Reddit Admins

Reddit admins are responsible for ensuring that users adhere to Reddit's Content Policy. Different types of account sanctions are applied for behaviors that violate a given policy, including: warnings, temporary bans of 3 or 7 days, and permanent bans (depending on the severity and number of previous violations).

From July to December 2023, admins handed out 331,072 account warnings, as well as 3,930,885 temporary and permanent account bans. Note that multiple sanctions can be applied to a single account over the course of time.

Chart 20 : User accounts reported or flagged to admins vs. actionability (July-December 2023)



In the graph below, temporary and permanent account bans by Reddit admins are organized by policy violations. We exclude content manipulation and spam from the data and corresponding analysis due to their outsized impact (66.6% of all account sanctions from July to December 2023), and to allow for better representation of the other Content Policy reasons for account sanctions.

We've continued to see a steady increase (+34% average since the last reporting period) in the number of accounts temporarily or permanently banned for ban evasion, following the rollout of our Ban Evasion Filter, a mod-level tool.

In addition, after noticing similar patterns of behavior across users and communities violating our non-consensual intimate media policy, our Safety teams devised new automated enforcement strategies designed to systematically identify and take action against accounts that quickly and consistently engage in violating communities. This automation also targets users and communities attempting to evade prior bans related to non-consensual intimate media. With these changes (coupled with other trends), we observed a significant increase in overall account bans for violations of our non-consensual intimate media policy, including a 127.55% increase in permanent bans. These increases can also be tied to our efforts to detect and action these violations early (see our work on P0 Media Safety Detection), continuous investments in admin training to better spot non-consensual imagery, and our partnership with StopNCII.org, a free, online tool that supports the detection and removal non-consensual intimate media while protecting the victim's privacy. (You can read more information about how StopNCII.org works here.)

Chart 21 : Account sanctions by Content Policy violation (not including content manipulation or spam) (July-December 2023)

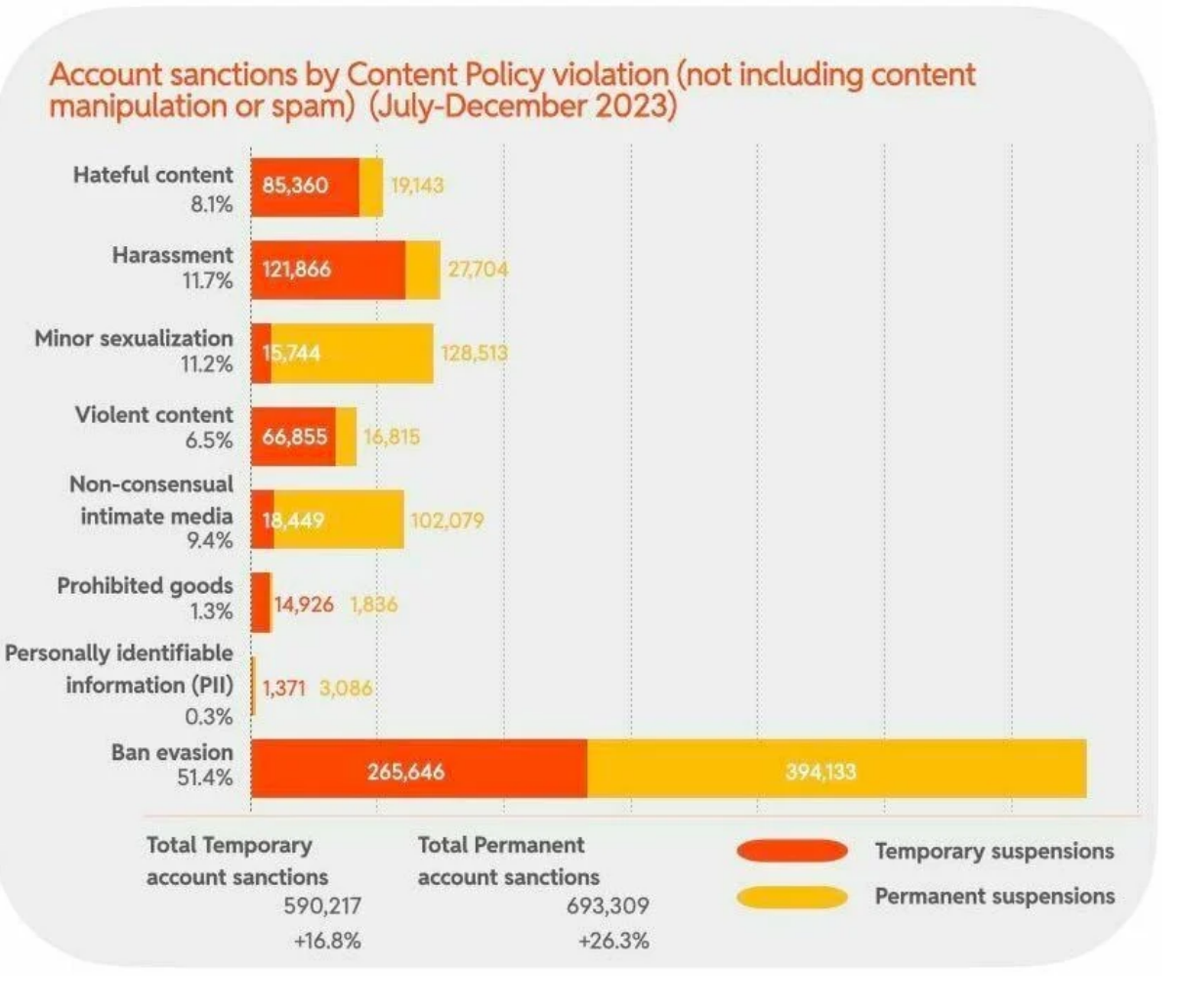
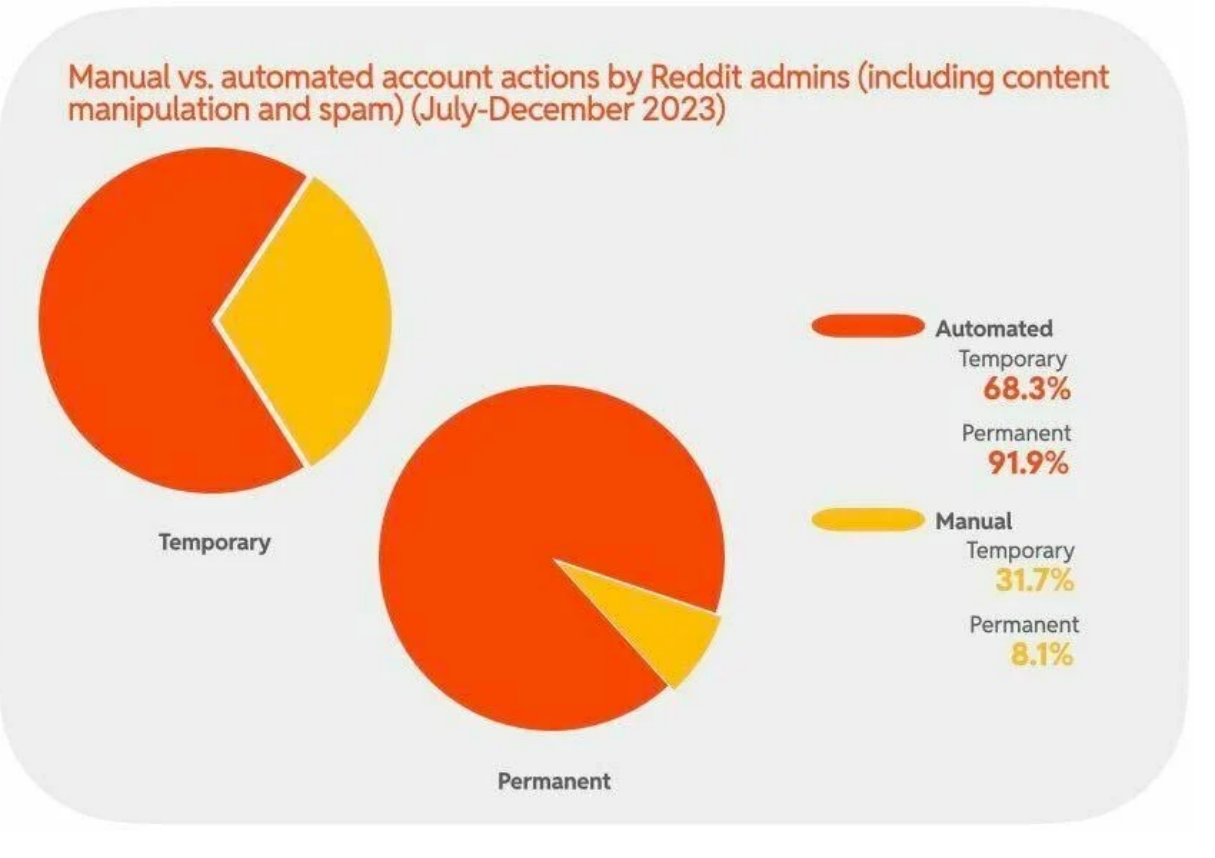


Chart 22 : Manual vs. automated account actions by Reddit admins (including content manipulation and spam) (July-December 2023)



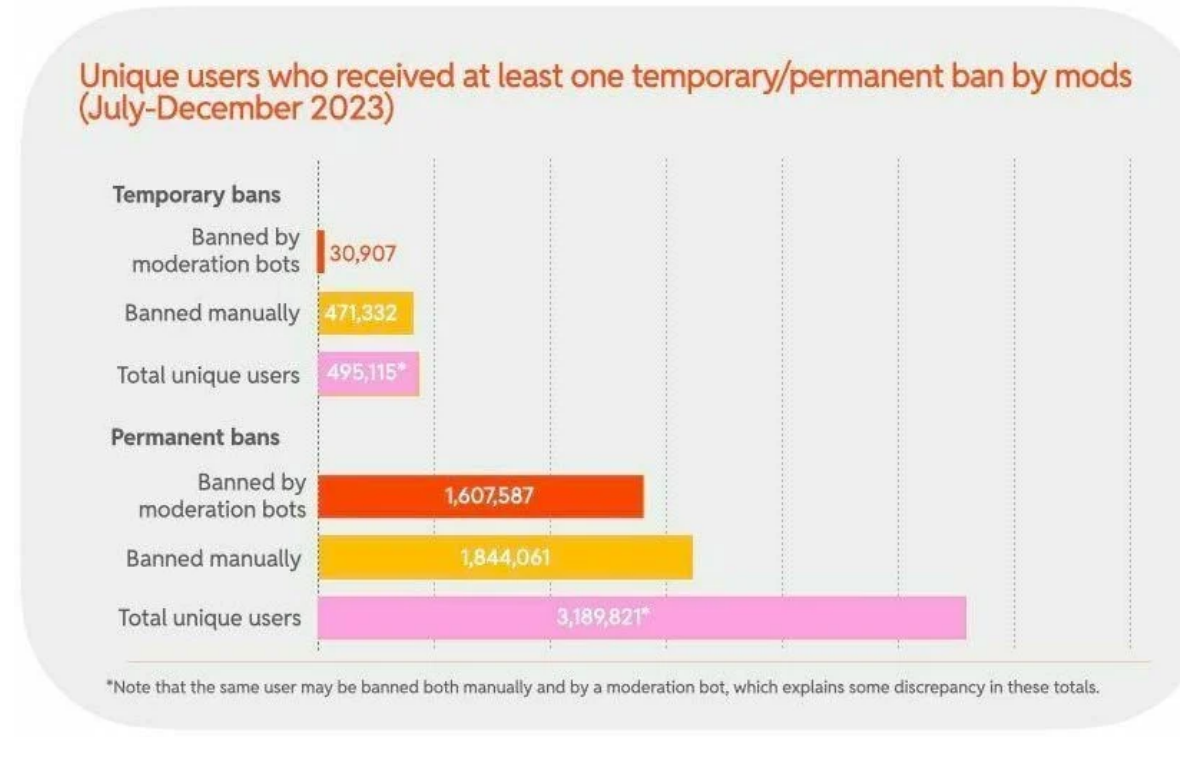
Automated permanent bans can occur for a variety of reasons, for example:

- Spam: accounts that are initially identified and temporarily actioned as spam become permanent bans when certain behavior is verified during probationary period.
- Users evading a subreddit ban: when a user evades a ban, they receive sequential 3-day / 7-day / permanent bans if they continue their behavior.
- Users evading a sitewide ban: after a user is permanently suspended for violating the Content Policy, their alternate accounts are usually suspended too.
- Vote manipulation: when users participate in "vote manipulation," they receive sequential warning / 3-day / 7-day / permanent bans if they continue their prohibited behavior.
- Users sharing content that has previously been confirmed as violating our non-consensual media policy.

Users Banned from Subreddits by Mods

Moderators can also ban users from their subreddits who are not following their community rules or are being otherwise disruptive to their communities. They can do this through automated tools or manual actions. While this type of ban can be temporary or permanent, it only applies to that specific community and not to the rest of Reddit.

Chart 23 : Unique users who received at least one temporary/permanent ban by mods (July-December 2023)



Appeals

Account-level sanctions issued by Reddit in response to Content Policy violations may be appealed. Appeals are evaluated by Reddit admins, and are either granted (resulting in the reinstatement of the account/content) or denied.

From July to December 2023, Reddit admins received 149,858 appeals of account-level sanctions issued by admins. Notably, in September 2023, we made improvements to user appeal options and launched a native appeal flow in the Reddit mobile app. Afterwards, we saw the appeal rate of all account-level sanctions increase to 1.88% (compared to less than 1% in the previous reporting period). Conversely, the account sanction reversal rate slightly decreased to 12.5% (compared to 14% in the last reporting period).

Chart 24 : Appeals of account-level sanctions issued by admins (July-December 2023)

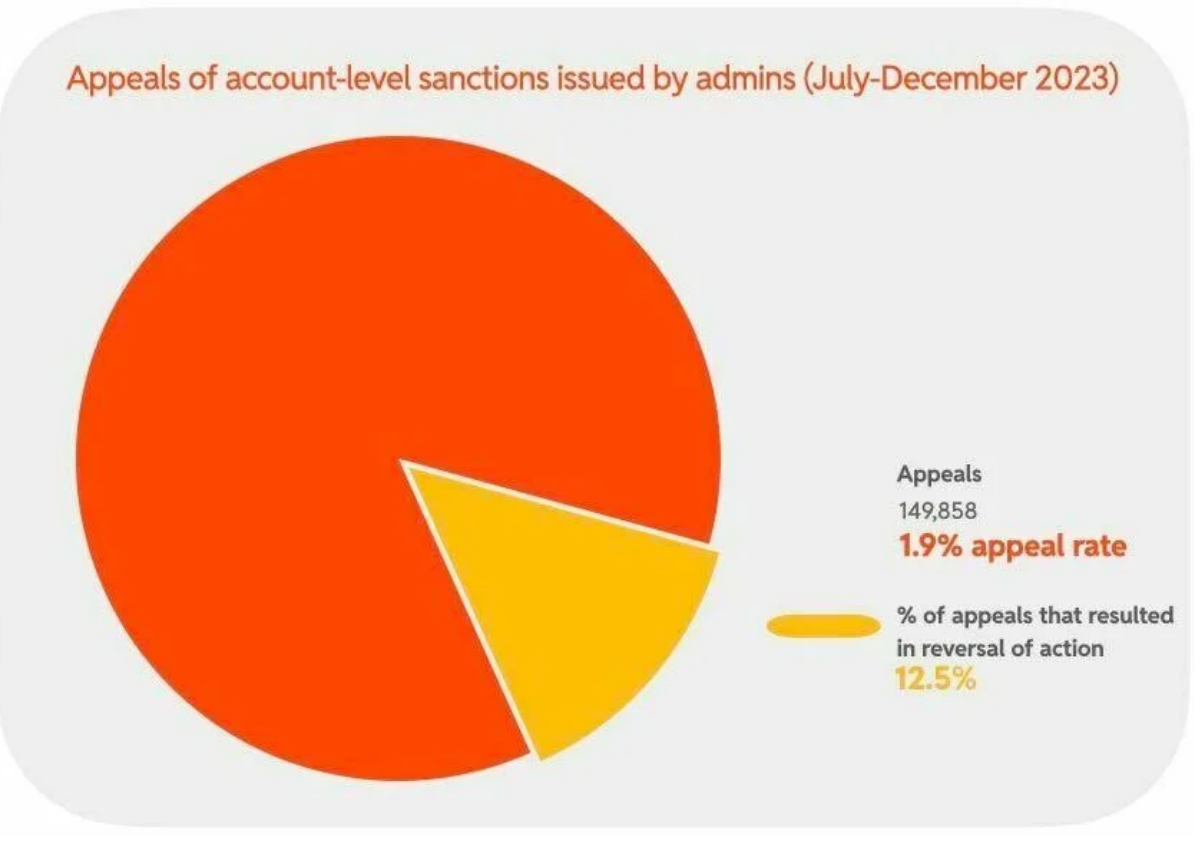
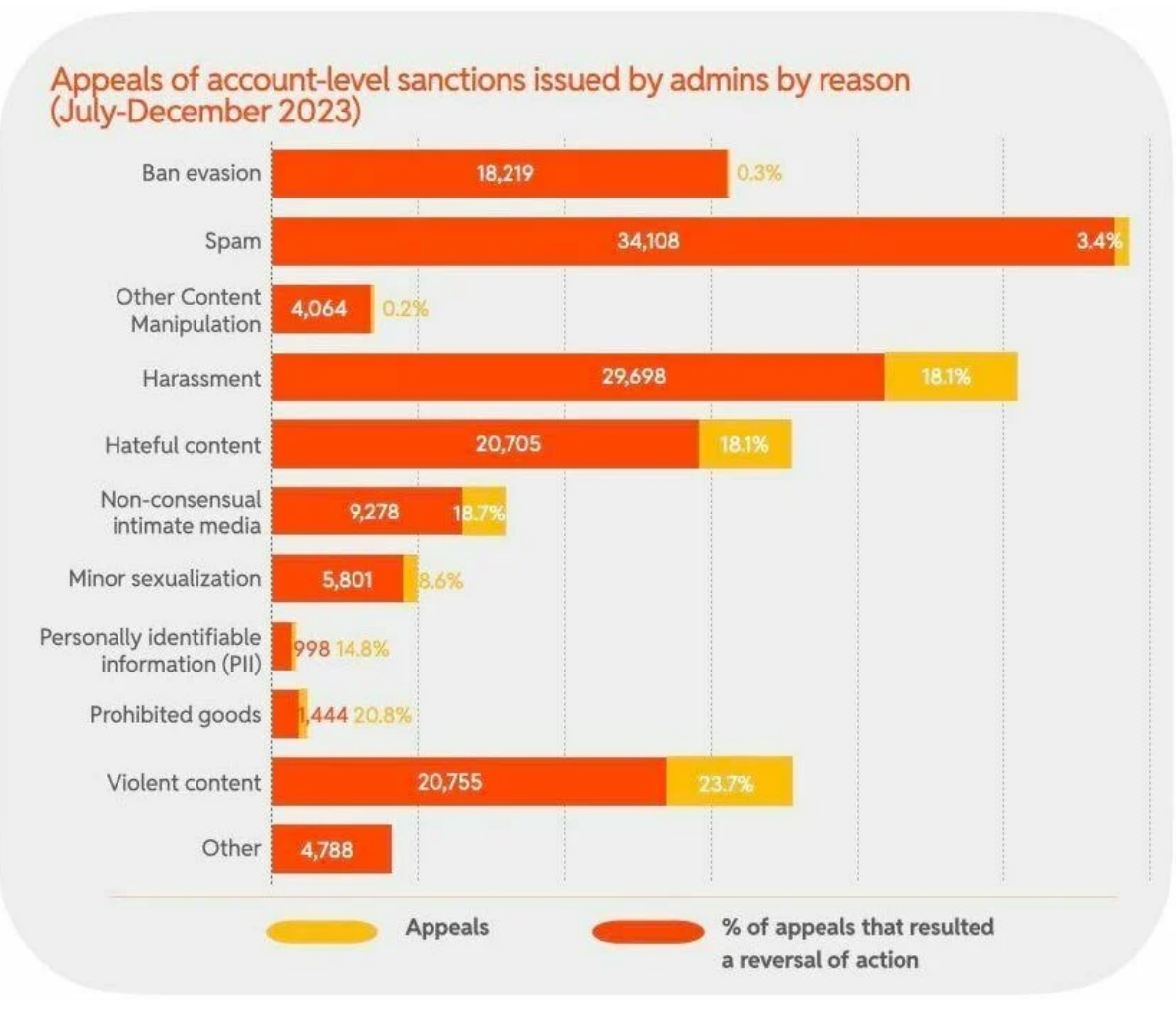


Chart 25 : Appeals of account-level sanctions issued by admins by reason (July-December 2023)



Legal Removals

This section covers legal removal requests received by Reddit from governments, law enforcement agencies, and private parties (e.g., lawyers/solicitors) around the world between July 1 - December 31, 2023.

Note: A single legal removal request may identify several pieces of content (URLs). In this section, we report both the number of requests and the total number of pieces of content identified in those requests.

Government and Law Enforcement Requests to Remove Content

This section includes legal requests submitted by government and law enforcement agencies to remove content on Reddit (either via court order or some other type of request).

Government and law enforcement officials may seek the removal of content for a variety of reasons, including alleged violations of local law. Reddit scrutinizes each request to determine its legal sufficiency, and may push back, seek more information, or deny the request in whole or in part for any number of reasons, including that the request is overbroad or inconsistent with international law.

Process-wise, all reported content is first reviewed against our Content Policy, and any violations are actioned by the appropriate team. Reddit's Content Policy is applied universally regardless of how we become aware of the violating content or who submits the report. When there are no underlying Content Policy violations, we evaluate the legal request under both local and international law, including against human rights standards. In cases where Reddit determines that the reported content appears to violate local law, Reddit may restrict access to (aka "geoblock") the content in the relevant country.

In the second half of 2023, Reddit received 121 requests from government and law enforcement agencies from 19 countries to remove content from the platform, representing a 20% decrease from the previous reporting period. The top requesting countries included Russia (25), United Arab Emirates (23), India (17), and the United Kingdom (16). Collectively, these four countries accounted for 67% of all global government and law enforcement removal requests received during this reporting period.

The majority of content identified in government and law enforcement requests (71%) was removed for Content Policy violations. A relatively small percentage of content (7%) was restricted locally in the requester's country based on violations of local law. In cases where local content restrictions have been implemented, users in that country will encounter a notice and explanation when trying to access the content. Additionally, the impacted user(s) will receive a Private Message that notifies them directly about the situation. For more information about our process please refer to this Help Center article.

Trends

Since last report:

- 6.4% decrease in our overall removal rate (a combination of Content Policy violations and geoblocking actions). Our overall removal rate has gradually decreased from a high of 95% in 2021 to 81% in 2023.
- 5.6% increase in geoblocked content

Notable Requests

- **India -** We geoblocked a post in India that discussed allegations of harassment in a public school in response to an interim order issued by the Bombay High Court.
- **Luxembourg** - We received a fraudulent court order purportedly issued by the Grand Ducal Court of Luxembourg, and declined to take action on the content identified.
- **Pakistan -** We declined to take action on a request from the Government of Pakistan identifying a post critical of government leadership. We are vigilant about government efforts to silence political speech and non-violent activism on Reddit, and strive to protect our users' rights — including the right to criticize governments, politicians, or other public figures.
- **Russia** - We received seven reports from Roskomnadzor in December identifying four communities that allegedly promoted "non-traditional sexual relations" in violation of local law. We declined to take action on these requests given the human rights implications for our users in Russia.

Insights

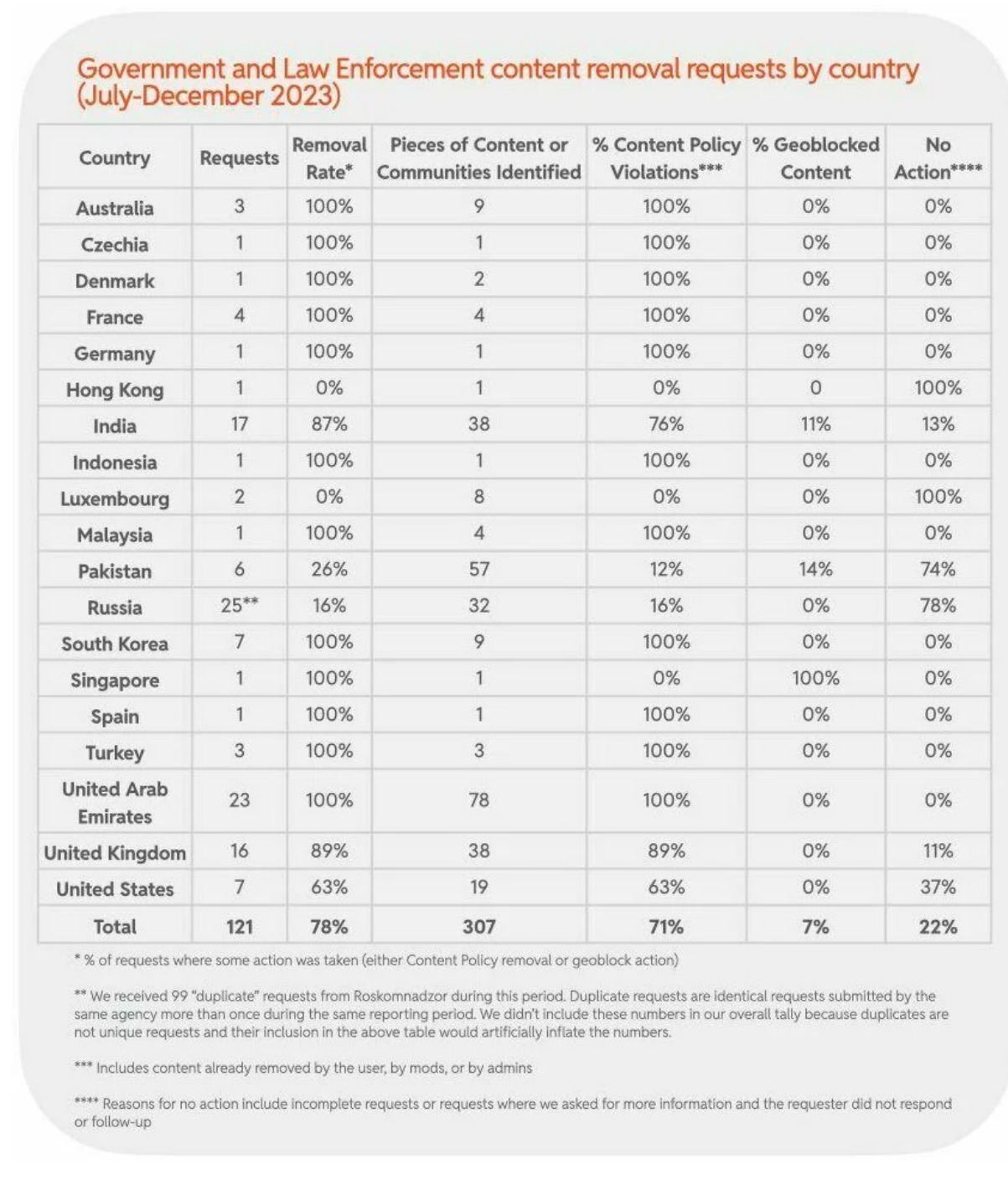
- **India** - 14% of all global removal requests from government or law enforcement agencies were from law enforcement in India, including two court orders. 75% of these were "hybrid" requests, i.e. seeking both the removal of content and the disclosure of user data. 76% of content identified was removed for violating our Content Policy (44% for violating our non-consensual intimate media policy). A further 11% of content was geoblocked in India for violations of local law. 13% of the remaining requests from India identified content that was either already removed by the time our admins reviewed the content, or failed to clearly identify the content at issue. No user data was disclosed in response to the hybrid requests received. For more information, please refer to the Information Requests section of this report.

- **Pakistan -** We received three content removal requests from law enforcement in Pakistan that collectively identified 47 pieces of content as allegedly blasphemous. We declined to take action on the vast majority of the content flagged (85%), in protection of our users' right to comment, debate, and express opinions on religion.

- **Russia** - 21% of all global removal requests from government or law enforcement agencies were from Roskomnadzor. We declined to take action on 78% of content identified in these requests; the 22% of content removed violated our Content Policy (mostly violent content). The majority of content we declined to remove included citizen journalism, political speech/commentary relating to the invasion of Ukraine, or content in support of LGBTQ+ communities.

- **UAE** - 19% of all global removal requests from government or law enforcement agencies were from a government agency in the United Arab Emirates. This represents a 40% increase in requests from the UAE in comparison with our previous reporting period. In response to these requests, 73 accounts and 5 subreddits were banned for Rule 7 violations.

Chart 26: Government and Law Enforcement content removal requests by country (July-December 2023)



Government and Law Enforcement content removal requests by country (July-December 2023)

Country	Requests	Removal Rate*	Pieces of Content or Communities Identified	% Content Policy Violations***	% Geoblocked Content	No Action****
Australia	3	100%	9	100%	0%	0%
Czechia	1	100%	1	100%	0%	0%
Denmark	1	100%	2	100%	0%	0%
France	4	100%	4	100%	0%	0%
Germany	1	100%	1	100%	0%	0%
Hong Kong	1	0%	1	0%	0	100%
India	17	87%	38	76%	11%	13%
Indonesia	1	100%	1	100%	0%	0%
Luxembourg	2	0%	8	0%	0%	100%
Malaysia	1	100%	4	100%	0%	0%
Pakistan	6	26%	57	12%	14%	74%
Russia	25**	16%	32	16%	0%	78%
South Korea	7	100%	9	100%	0%	0%
Singapore	1	100%	1	0%	100%	0%
Spain	1	100%	1	100%	0%	0%
Turkey	3	100%	3	100%	0%	0%
United Arab Emirates	23	100%	78	100%	0%	0%
United Kingdom	16	89%	38	89%	0%	11%
United States	7	63%	19	63%	0%	37%
Total	121	78%	307	71%	7%	22%

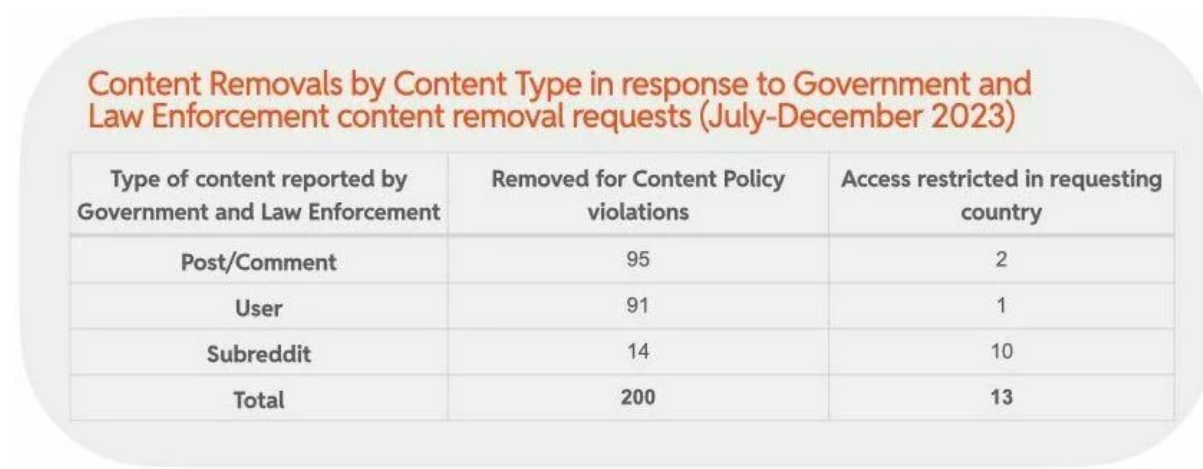
* % of requests where some action was taken (either Content Policy removal or geoblock action)

** We received 99 "duplicate" requests from Roskomnadzor during this period. Duplicate requests are identical requests submitted by the same agency more than once during the same reporting period. We didn't include these numbers in our overall tally because duplicates are not unique requests and their inclusion in the above table would artificially inflate the numbers.

*** Includes content already removed by the user, by mods, or by admins

**** Reasons for no action include incomplete requests or requests where we asked for more information and the requester did not respond or follow-up

Chart 27: Content Removals by Content Type in response to Government and Law Enforcement content removal requests (July-December 2023)



Content Removals by Content Type in response to Government and Law Enforcement content removal requests (July-December 2023)

Type of content reported by Government and Law Enforcement	Removed for Content Policy violations	Access restricted in requesting country
Post/Comment	95	2
User	91	1
Subreddit	14	10
Total	200	13

Chart 28: Reddit actions in response to Government and Law Enforcement content removal requests (July-December 2023)

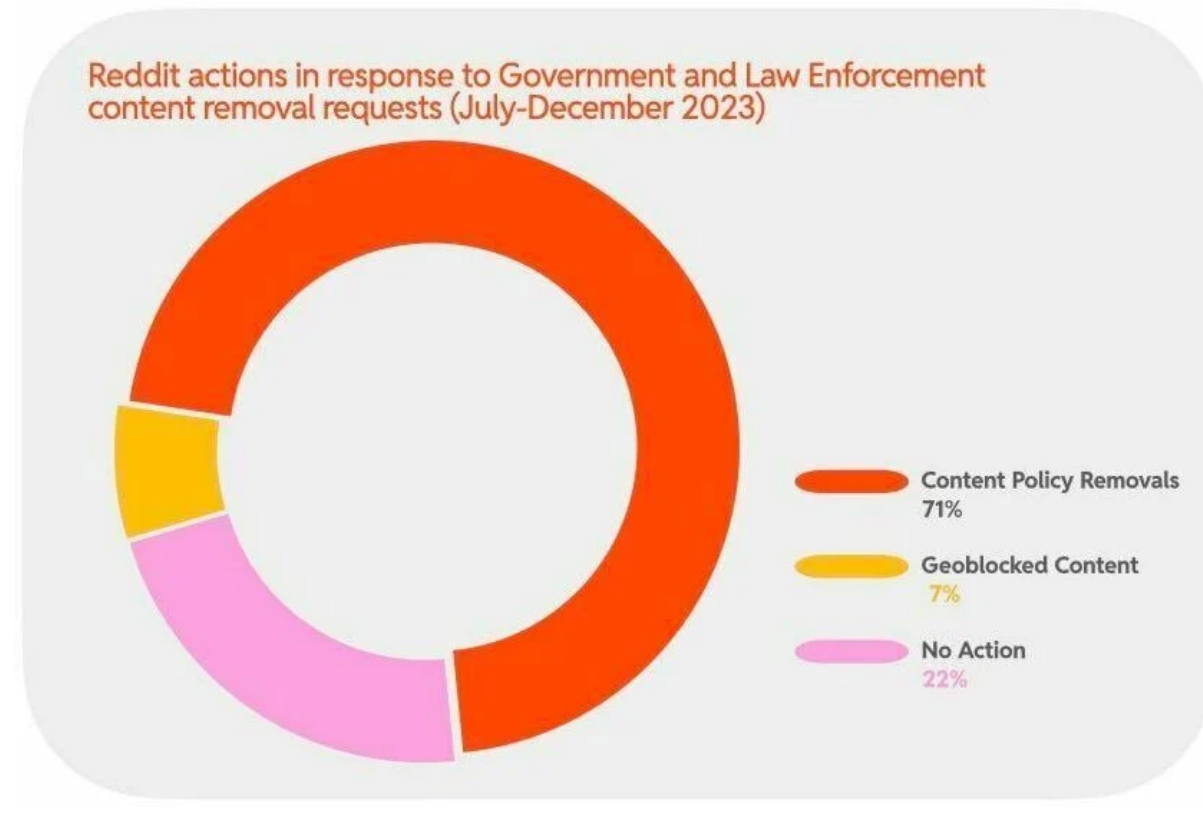


Chart 29: Government and Law Enforcement content removal requests 2022-2023

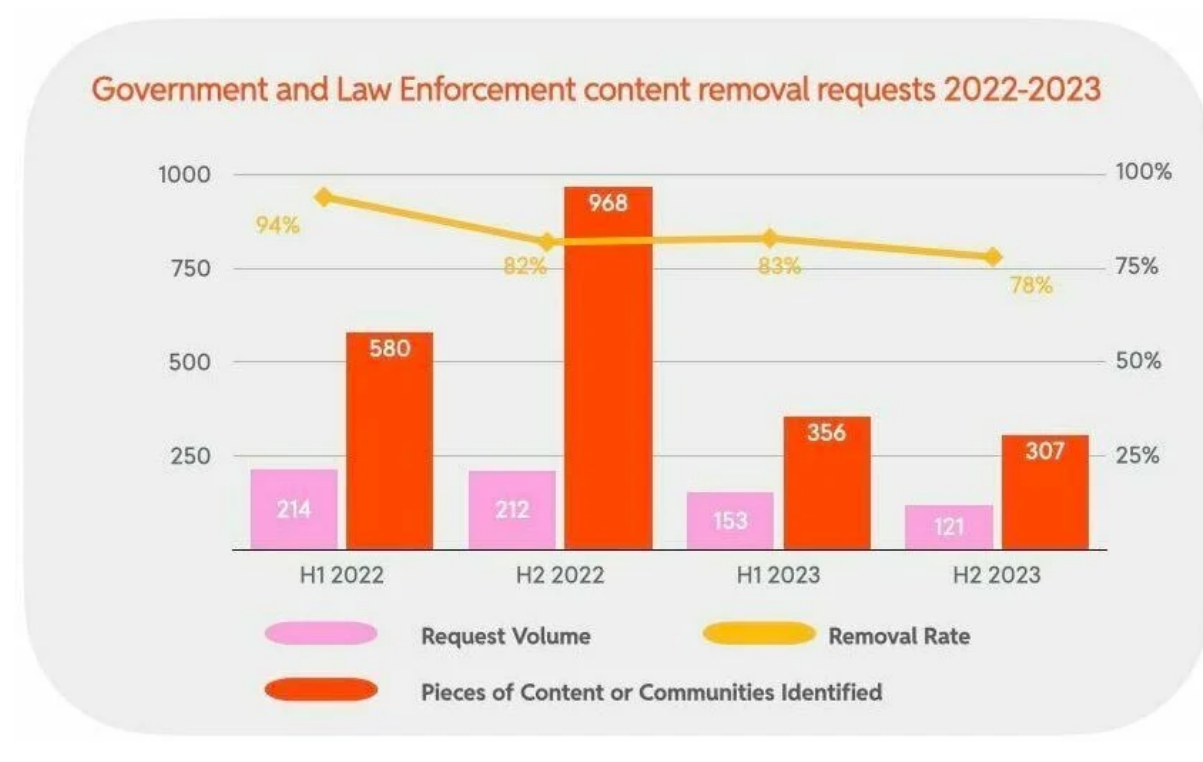
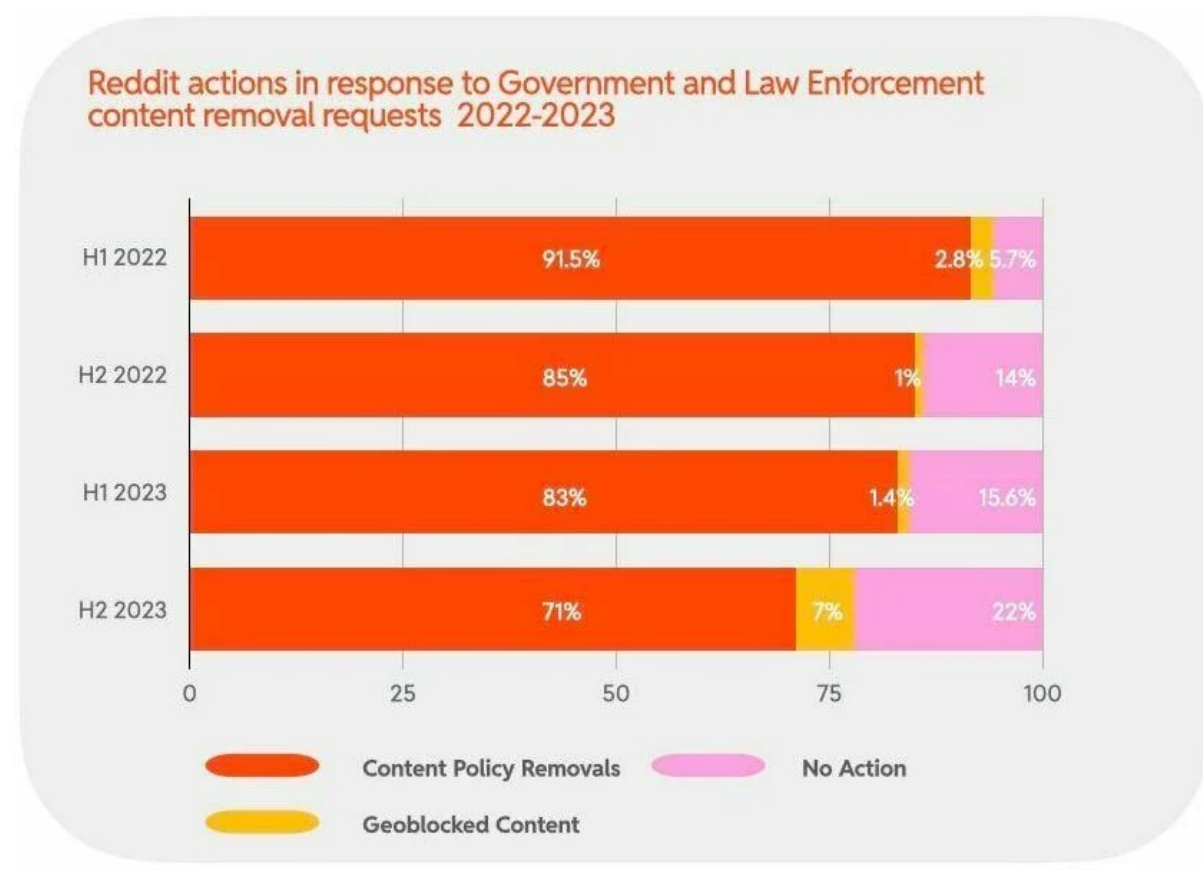


Chart 30: Reddit actions in response to Government and Law Enforcement content removal requests 2022-2023



Child Sexual Abuse Material

We have zero tolerance for content or interactions that involve the sexual exploitation of minors. We use a combination of automated methods (including hash-matching technology, which applies a unique digital fingerprint to each media file to help identify violative content uploaded to Reddit), human review, and community reports to detect activities potentially related to child sexual exploitation on Reddit. When we find child sexual abuse material ("CSAM") on the platform, it is removed immediately and the offending user is permanently suspended from Reddit. We also take the steps required by U.S. law to report the relevant users/content to the National Center for Missing and Exploited Children (NCMEC), and preserve relevant account data.

Between July and December of 2023, we submitted 133,588 CyberTipline reports to NCMEC, a decrease of 14.6% from the first half of 2023.

Reddit removed content in response to 193,332 minor sexualization reports submitted between July and December of 2023. Note: a single removal action may impact several pieces of content.

We remain steadfastly committed to preventing and disrupting the sexual exploitation of children. For more information on our efforts to combat this type of violative content, please refer to our article on How Reddit Fights Child Sexual Exploitation.

Chart 31 : CSAM Report Sources (July-December 2023)

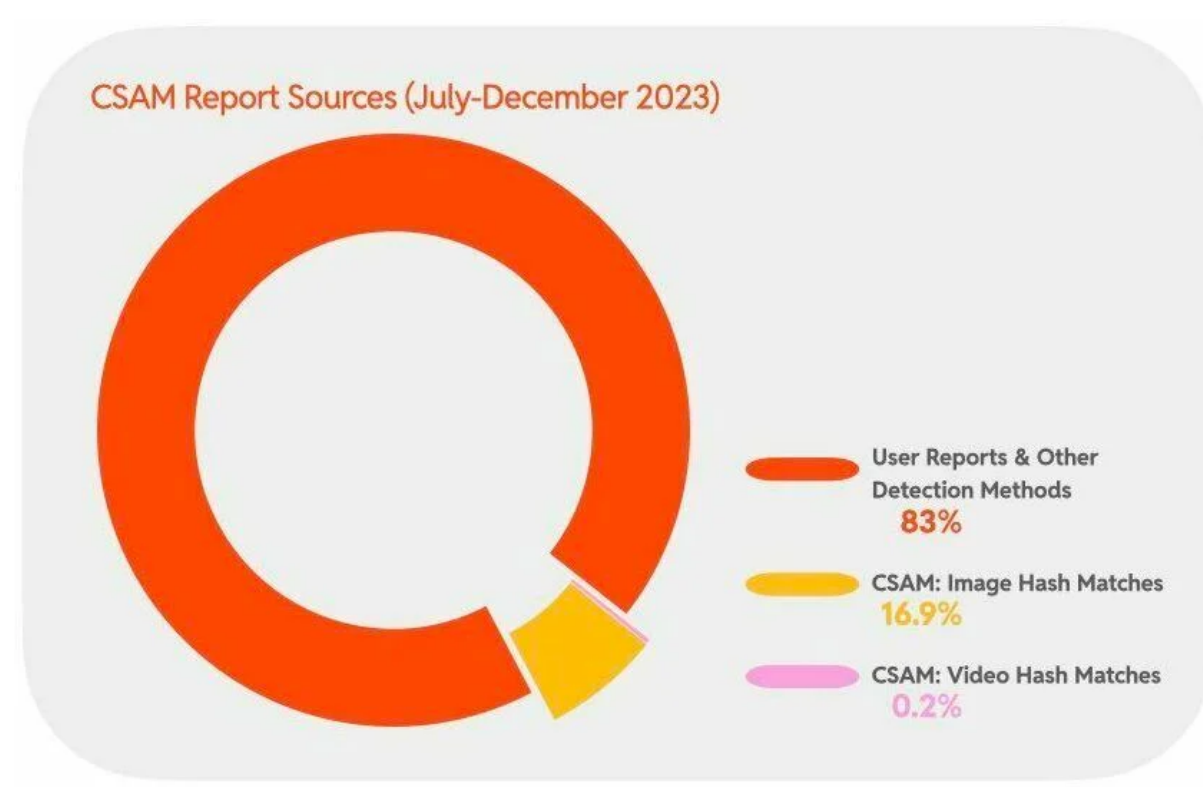
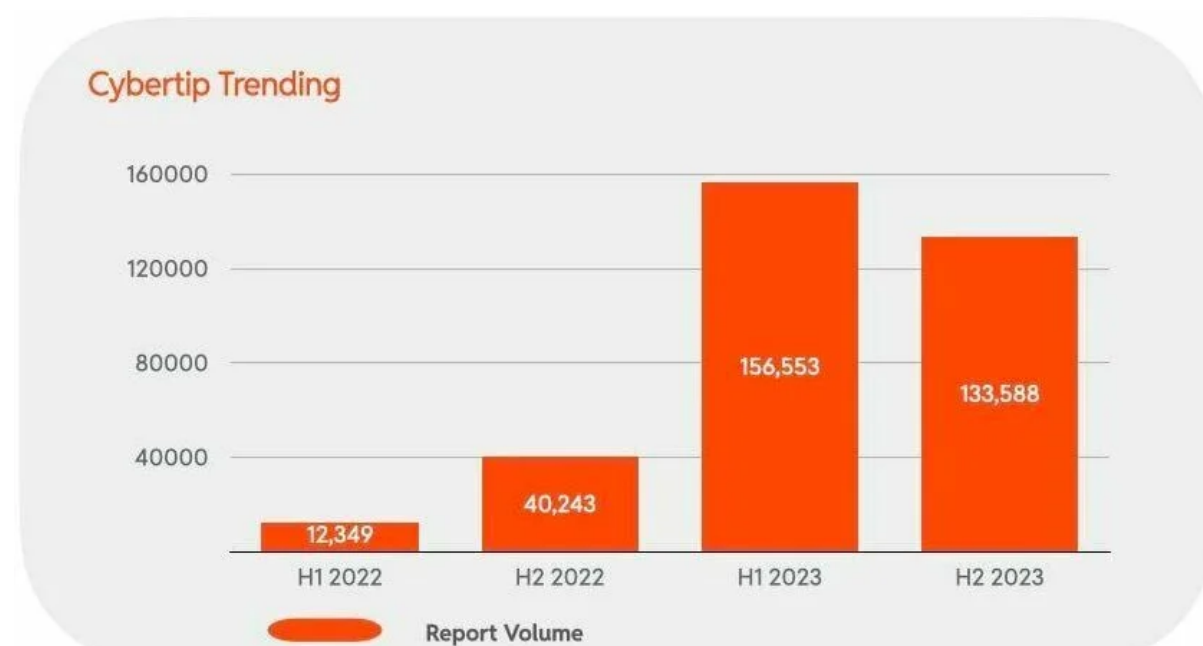


Chart 32 : Cybertip Trending



Terrorist Content Removals

Reddit has zero tolerance for the dissemination of terrorist content on our platform. When we become aware of violative content, we remove it and take appropriate action against the account that posted it.

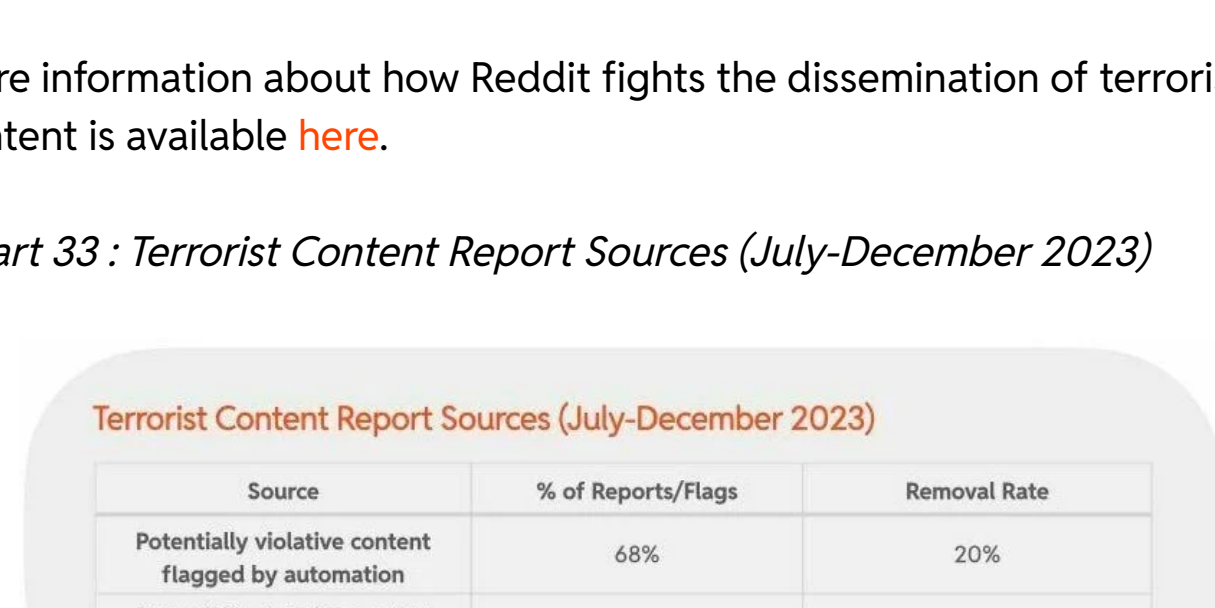
Reddit's Content Policy explicitly prohibits content that glorifies, incites or calls for violence or physical harm, including content that promotes or supports the activities of terrorists or designated terrorist organizations. Violative content includes: material posted by terrorists or designated terrorist organizations and their supporters, expressions of affiliation or support for terrorists or designated terrorist organizations, and glorification of terrorist acts. It also includes content that solicits or incites a person or group to participate in, commit, or contribute to terrorist activities.

In the second half of 2023, Reddit removed 877 pieces of terrorist content from the platform, resulting in 854 accounts being permanently suspended and seven subreddits being banned. 60% of the violative content was related to the tragic events in Israel and Gaza that started in October 2023.

Reddit utilizes a combination of automated technologies, user/community/external reports, and internal escalation processes to identify or flag potentially violative terrorist content on our platform. In the second half of 2023, 68% of potentially violative terrorist content was flagged by automation, resulting in a 20% removal rate. The vast majority of violative content was removed within 24 hours of human review.

More information about how Reddit fights the dissemination of terrorist content is available here.

Chart 33 : Terrorist Content Report Sources (July-December 2023)



Terrorist Content Report Sources (July-December 2023)

Source	% of Reports/Flags	Removal Rate
Potentially violative content flagged by automation	68%	20%
Potentially violative content flagged by human*	32%	77%

*includes content user/community/external reports and/or internal escalation processes

Legal Requests Submitted by Private Parties to Remove Content

Reddit also receives legal requests from private parties to remove content. Examples include requests from lawyers/solicitors, businesses, private individuals, and non-governmental organizations to remove content they believe is defamatory or otherwise violates private legal rights.

As described above, all content identified in these requests is first reviewed under Reddit's Content Policy, and content that violates our rules is removed. When there are no underlying Content Policy violations, but the content violates local law(s), Reddit may restrict access to the content in the country where it is alleged to be illegal. In these cases, users in that country will encounter a notice and explanation when trying to access the content.

In the second half of 2023, Reddit received 117 legal demands from private parties seeking the removal of content and citing local laws. The highest volume requesters were from the United States (53), Turkey (21), and India (13). We removed 33% of content identified in these requests for violating our Content Policy and restricted access to 2% of content locally in the requester's country. We declined to take action on 78% of content identified in these requests. Reasons for declining action include that the content identified didn't violate our Content Policy or local law, or the legal request was somehow incomplete (e.g., we asked for more information from the requester and they didn't follow-up).

Out of the 117 global legal demands, 25% of these requests attached a court order (either addressed to Reddit or attached as supporting authority) seeking the removal of Reddit content for alleged violations of local law. The vast majority (64%) of these court orders were received from Turkey; followed by India (10%), United States (10%), Canada (7%), Netherlands (3%), Singapore (3%), and the United Kingdom (3%). We removed 23 pieces of content identified in these orders for violating our Content Policy and restricted access to a further three pieces of content locally.

Note: This section does not include requests from users to remove/delete *their own* content under the EU General Data Protection Regulation, the California Consumer Privacy Act, or removal requests under Germany's Network Enforcement Act (NetzDG; see below).

Trends

Compared to the previous report:

- 18% increase in private party legal requests
- 4% decrease in geoblocked content
- 78% of content identified in these requests resulted in no action (a 32% increase from our last reporting period)

Notable Requests

- **Australia -** In response to a defamation claim, we removed two comments that identified a private individual by name in connection with allegations of sexual assault and bribery.

- **US -** We received a defamation takedown notice related to posts sharing a video of a verbal and physical altercation. While we did not remove the video posts, we did remove 136 comments across several subreddits that violated our Content Policy against inciting violence and/or harassment.

Insights

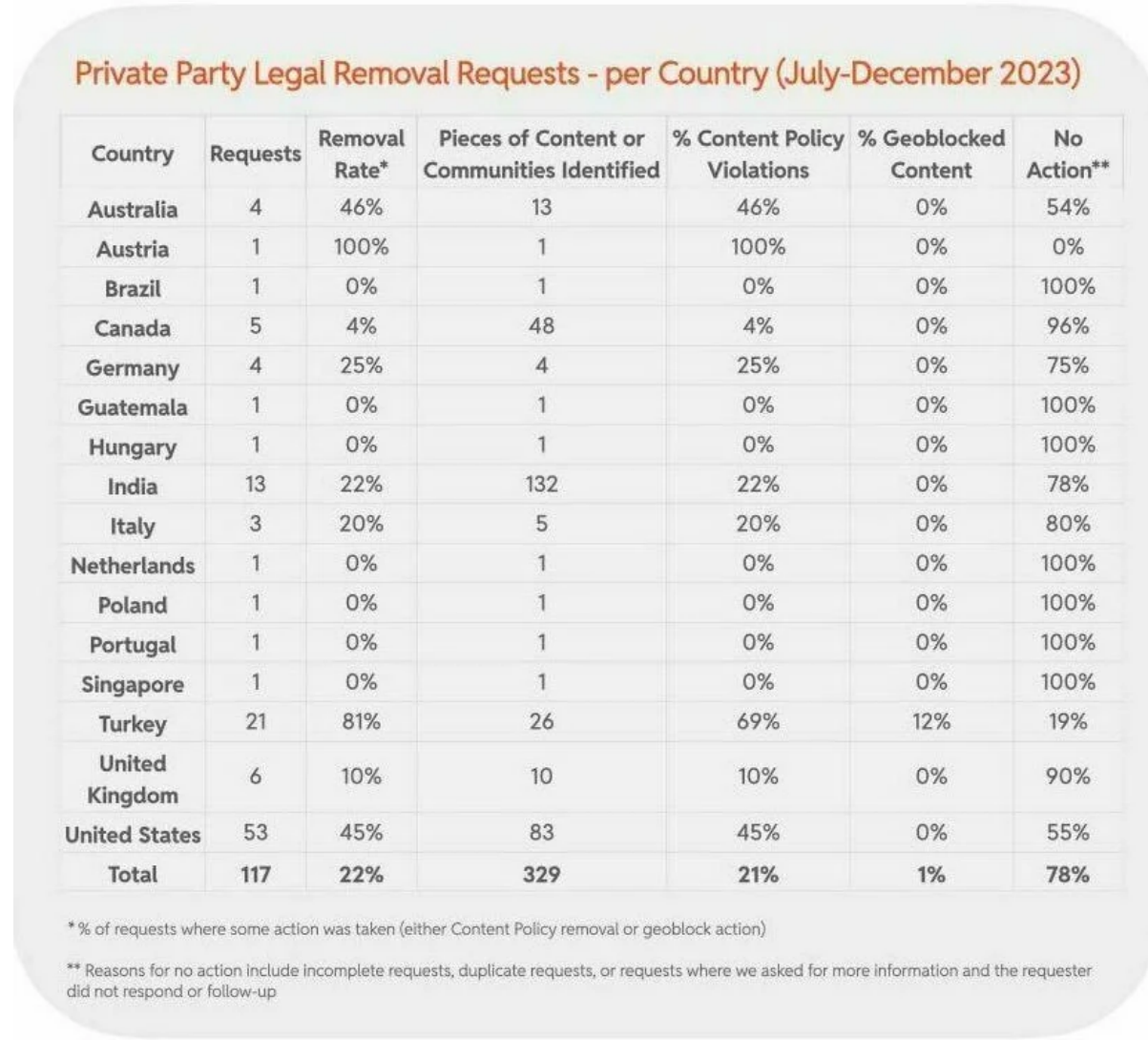
- **EU -** 8% of global private party legal requests were "notice and takedown" requests from solicitors/lawyers in EU countries citing alleged defamation in the context of negative product or business reviews. Reddit protects our users' right to engage in robust, genuine discussions about their experiences (provided they don't violate our Content Policy) -- as such, we declined to remove 95% of content identified in these requests. The remaining 5% (one post) was removed for violating our rules prohibiting harassment.

- **India -** 11% of global private party legal removal requests were from India. Six requests (46% of the total received from India) were submitted by a single online reputation management company on behalf of their clients, collectively identifying 116 pieces of allegedly defamatory and/or impersonating content. We removed 18% of content identified in these requests for violating our Content Policy (the majority of which violated our rules against non-consensual intimate imagery and harassment).

- **Turkey -** 18% of global legal private party removal requests were from Turkey. Of the 21 requests from Turkey, 20 (or 95%) were court orders seeking the removal of content under Article 9 of Law No. 5651 (violation of personal rights*)*. 68% of the items of content identified in these 20 orders were removed for Content Policy violations (for violations of our policies against non-consensual intimate imagery and posting of private information) and a further 12% were restricted in Turkey. We declined to action the remaining 20% of content, given the political and public interest nature of the speech targeted.

- **United States -** 45% of global private party legal removal requests were from the US. The majority (60%) were submitted by law firms seeking the removal of content that mentioned their clients in the context of allegedly outdated or inaccurate third party website content shared on Reddit. Whilst the numbers have increased by 5% for this type of legal request during the reporting period, our removal rate has decreased by 24%. Removal reasons include content that crossed the line into harassment or the posting of private information. The remaining content did not violate our policies.

Chart 34: Private Party Legal Removal Requests - per Country (July-December 2023)



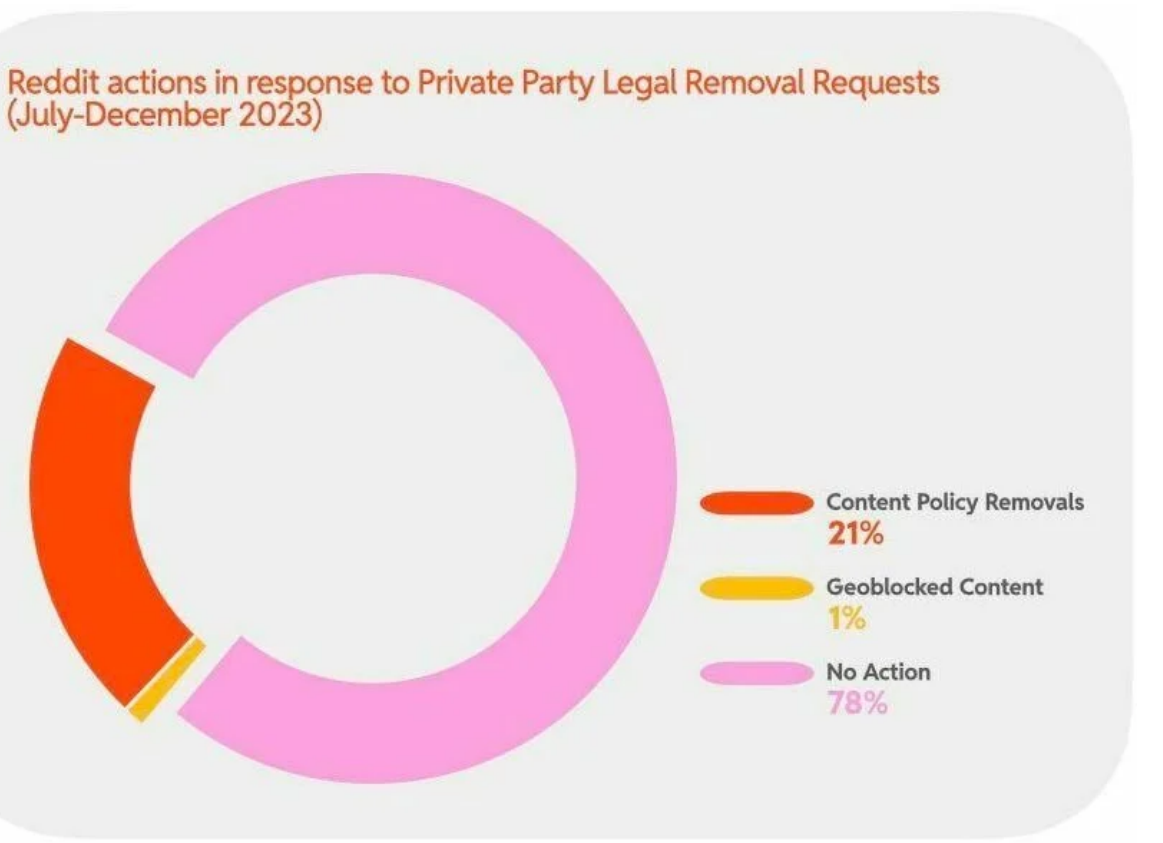
Private Party Legal Removal Requests - per Country (July-December 2023)

Country	Requests	Removal Rate*	Pieces of Content or Communities Identified	% Content Policy Violations	% Geoblocked Content	No Action**
Australia	4	46%	13	46%	0%	54%
Austria	1	100%	1	100%	0%	0%
Brazil	1	0%	1	0%	0%	100%
Canada	5	4%	48	4%	0%	96%
Germany	4	25%	4	25%	0%	75%
Guatemala	1	0%	1	0%	0%	100%
Hungary	1	0%	1	0%	0%	100%
India	13	22%	132	22%	0%	78%
Italy	3	20%	5	20%	0%	80%
Netherlands	1	0%	1	0%	0%	100%
Poland	1	0%	1	0%	0%	100%
Portugal	1	0%	1	0%	0%	100%
Singapore	1	0%	1	0%	0%	100%
Turkey	21	81%	26	69%	12%	19%
United Kingdom	6	10%	10	10%	0%	90%
United States	53	45%	83	45%	0%	55%
Total	117	22%	329	21%	1%	78%

* % of requests where some action was taken (either Content Policy removal or geoblock action)

** Reasons for no action include incomplete requests, duplicate requests, or requests where we asked for more information and the requester did not respond or follow-up

Chart 35 : Reddit actions in response to Private Party Legal Removal Requests (July-December 2023)



NetzDG

The Network Enforcement Act ("NetzDG") is a German law that requires social networks with more than 2 million registered users in Germany to provide a complaint procedure for reporting content under specific sections of the German Criminal Code ("StGB").

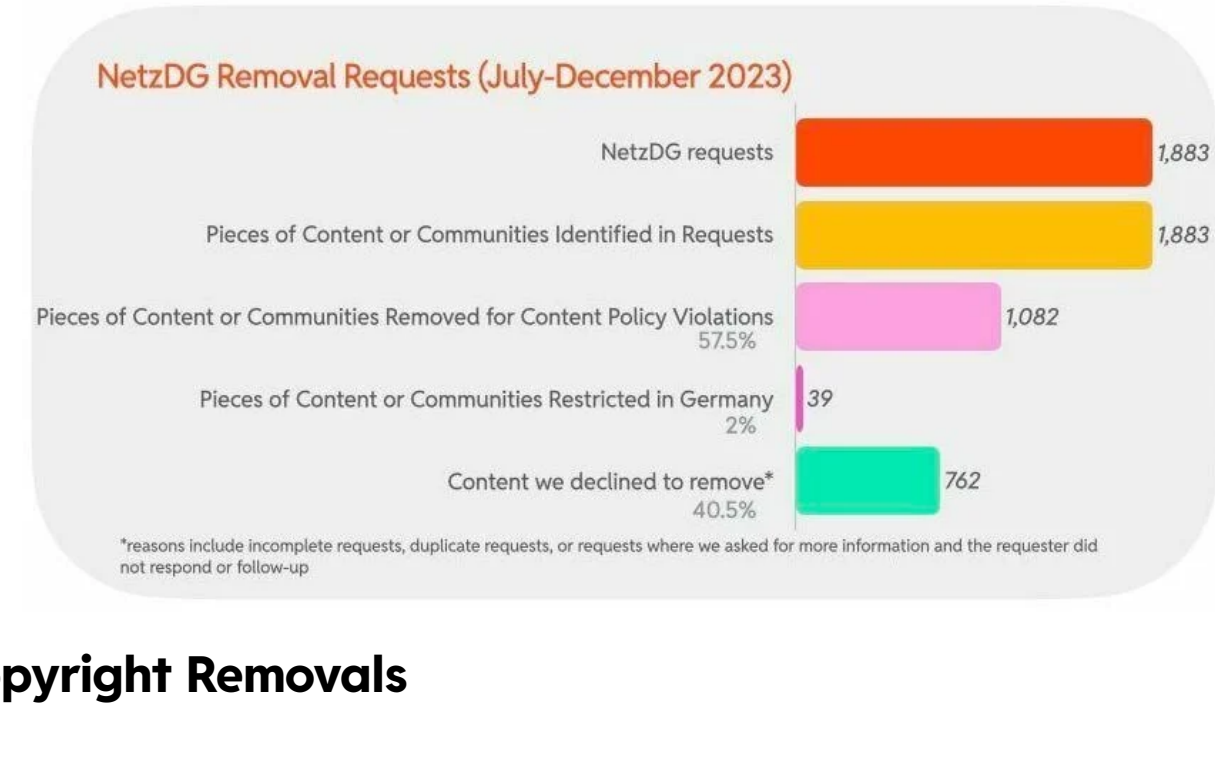
During the reporting period we received 1,883 requests from Germany citing alleged NetzDG violations. This represents an 49% increase in the volume of requests received compared to the previous reporting period (January - June 2023).

We removed 57.5% of content identified in NetzDG reports during this period for violating our Content Policy and we restricted access to a further 2% of content in Germany for violating local law. We declined to take action on 40.5% of content. The removal rate has decreased by 10% in comparison to our previous reporting period.

For a more in-depth look at these requests, please refer to our bi-annual NetzDG report here (under "More information about Reddit's handling of NetzDG reports").

Please note: This will be the final time we include a NetzDG section in our transparency report, given that the EU Digital Services Act (DSA) is now in effect. For information on how European Union users may submit reports of content they believe to be illegal in the EU, please refer to this Help Center article.

Chart 36: NetzDG Removal Requests (July-December 2023)



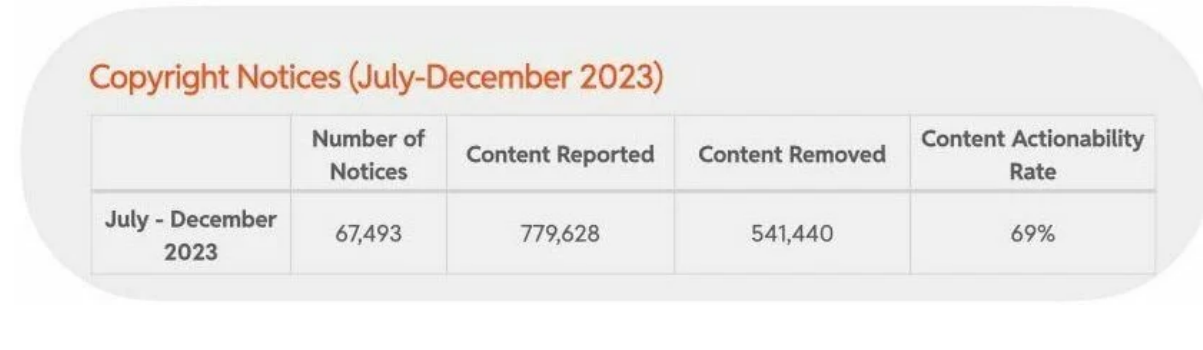
Copyright Removals

This section covers the volume of content removed from Reddit in response to valid copyright takedown notices, as well as the volume of content we declined to remove because the notices were invalid. We also include data about content we reinstated after the original poster submitted a valid copyright counter notice or the rightsholder withdrew its copyright takedown notice.

When Reddit receives a valid copyright takedown notice, we remove the violative content identified in the notice and notify the account holder where appropriate. We process copyright takedown notices that are consistent with the U.S. Digital Millennium Copyright Act. For more information, please visit our Copyright Help Center.

From July to December of 2023, we received 67,493 copyright takedown notices requesting the removal of 779,628 pieces of content. We removed 541,440 pieces of content in response to those notices (a 69% actionability rate).

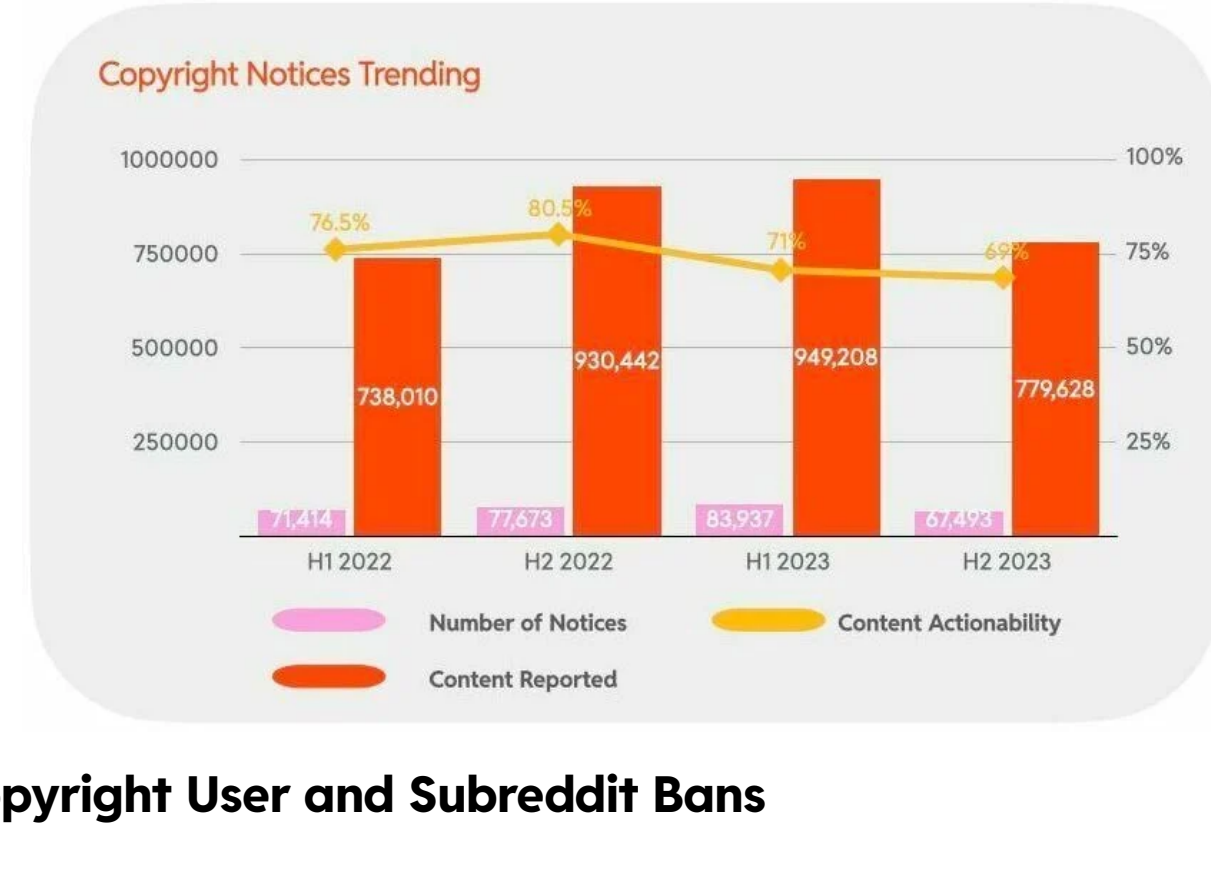
Chart 37: Copyright Notices (July-December 2023)



Copyright Notices (July-December 2023)

	Number of Notices	Content Reported	Content Removed	Content Actionability Rate
July - December 2023	67,493	779,628	541,440	69%

Chart 38: Copyright Notices Trending



Copyright User and Subreddit Bans

Under certain circumstances, Reddit may ban users who repeatedly violate our Copyright Policy. Reddit may also ban subreddits after multiple removals of violative content.

From July to December of 2023, Reddit banned 792 users for repeat Copyright Policy violations, an increase of 258% compared to the first half of 2023. This large increase is a result of improvements to our detection methods and increased operational capacity. Reddit also banned 452 subreddits, a decrease of 20% compared to the first half of 2023.

Invalid Copyright Notices

When Reddit receives an invalid copyright takedown notice, we reject the notice and decline to remove the identified content.

A copyright takedown notice may be invalid for many reasons, including:

- Failing to include all the required elements of a takedown notice
- Confusing other policy issues for copyright infringement, such as privacy violations or harassment
- Targeting content that makes a "fair use" of the requester's work, as allowed by copyright law

From July to December of 2023, Reddit rejected 20,998 copyright takedown notices (a 31% notice rejection rate) and declined to remove 238,188 pieces of content because the notices were invalid.

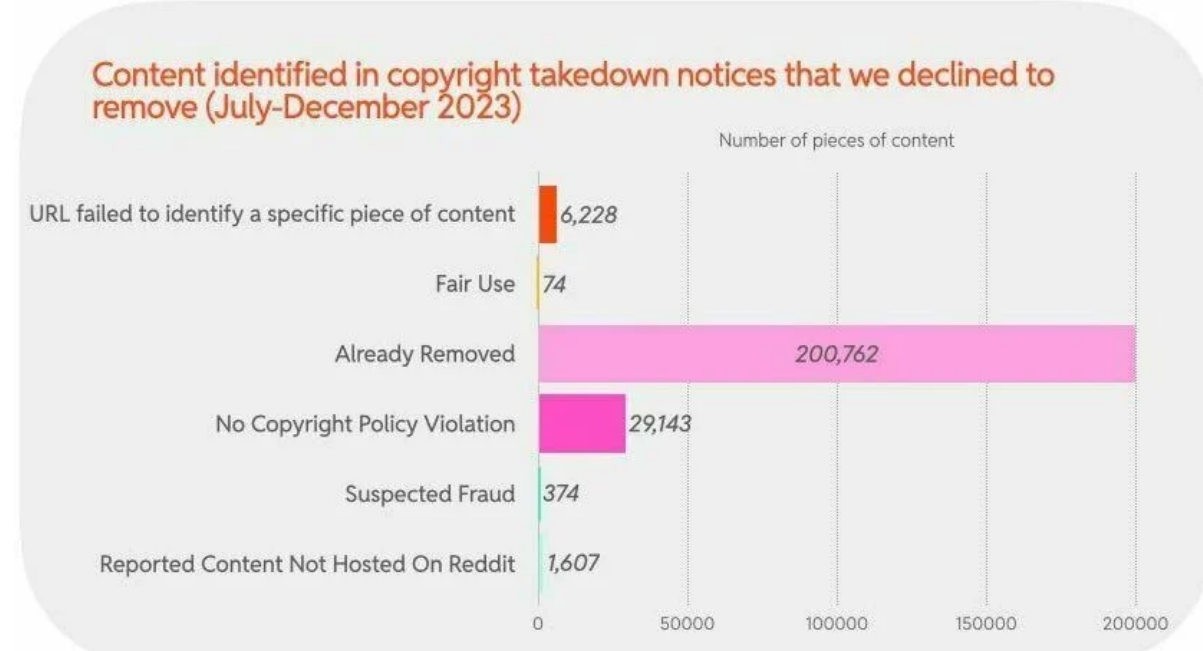
For more information about copyright takedown notices, please visit our Copyright Help Center.

Notable Examples:

- Fair Use - A furniture company submitted a copyright notice seeking the removal of a post that showed the company's copyrighted advertisement images. The original poster also shared their negative review of the company's business practices and their customer experience when the business delayed delivery of their item for several months. In certain circumstances, copyrighted works may be used without the rightsholder's permission - this concept is known as fair use. We declined to remove the content from Reddit based on the principles set forth under the fair use doctrine.

- Not a Copyright Issue - A business that sells e-commerce website development packages and training services submitted a copyright notice regarding a Reddit post that stated the business was a "scam." The post described a negative experience where the original poster paid the business to help them set up an e-commerce website, but received limited, unsatisfactory support. The business' notice failed to identify a copyrighted work, but instead claimed that the information shared in the post violated a confidentiality and non-disparagement agreement. Based on the information provided in the notice, it appeared that the business' issue did not concern copyright, so we rejected the notice and declined to remove the content.

Chart 39 : Content identified in copyright takedown notices that we declined to remove (July-December 2023)



Counter Notices and Withdrawals

Reddit receives counter notices from users whose content has been removed in response to a copyright takedown notice, following a procedure consistent with the U.S. Digital Millennium Copyright Act. A valid counter notice usually results in the reinstatement of the content to Reddit. More information on counter notices can be found here.

Reddit may also restore content that was removed as a result of a valid copyright takedown notice if the party who submitted the notice withdraws their claim of copyright infringement.

Reddit complies with counter notices and withdrawal requests that are complete, and rejects those that are invalid.

From July to December of 2023, Reddit received 397 counter notices (up nearly 32% since last report) and 17 withdrawal requests. 216 counter notices were valid and processed (an increase of more than 86% since last report, due to increased operational capacity), resulting in the restoration of 1,331 pieces of content to Reddit. All 17 withdrawal requests were processed, resulting in the restoration of 162 pieces of content.

Trademark Removals

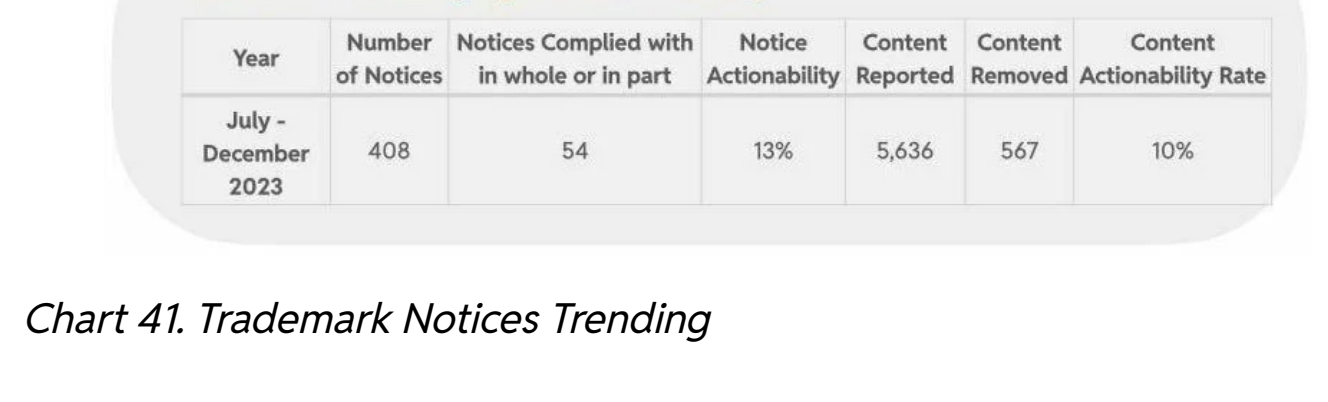
Reddit's Trademark Policy prohibits users from making unauthorized use of another's trademark in a way that may confuse or mislead others about the source of goods or services, or affiliation with the trademark owner. We process trademark takedown notices following a notice-and-takedown procedure. When Reddit receives a valid trademark takedown notice, we remove the violative content identified in the notice and notify the account holder where appropriate.

This section provides data regarding trademark takedown notices received by Reddit and the actions taken in response to these notices.

From July to December of 2023, Reddit received 408 trademark takedown notices (an increase of almost 14% since last report) requesting the removal of 5,636 pieces of content (an increase of 4.5%). Reddit complied either in whole or in part with 54 notices, and removed 567 pieces of content resulting in a 10% content actionability rate.

The increase in our content actionability rate (up from 1.2% in the last report) was due to a spike of valid trademark takedown notices reporting large volumes of violative content per notice. However, our notice actionability rate (the percentage of notices we complied with in part or in whole) remained relatively consistent with the previous reporting period at 13%, compared to 14% in the last report.

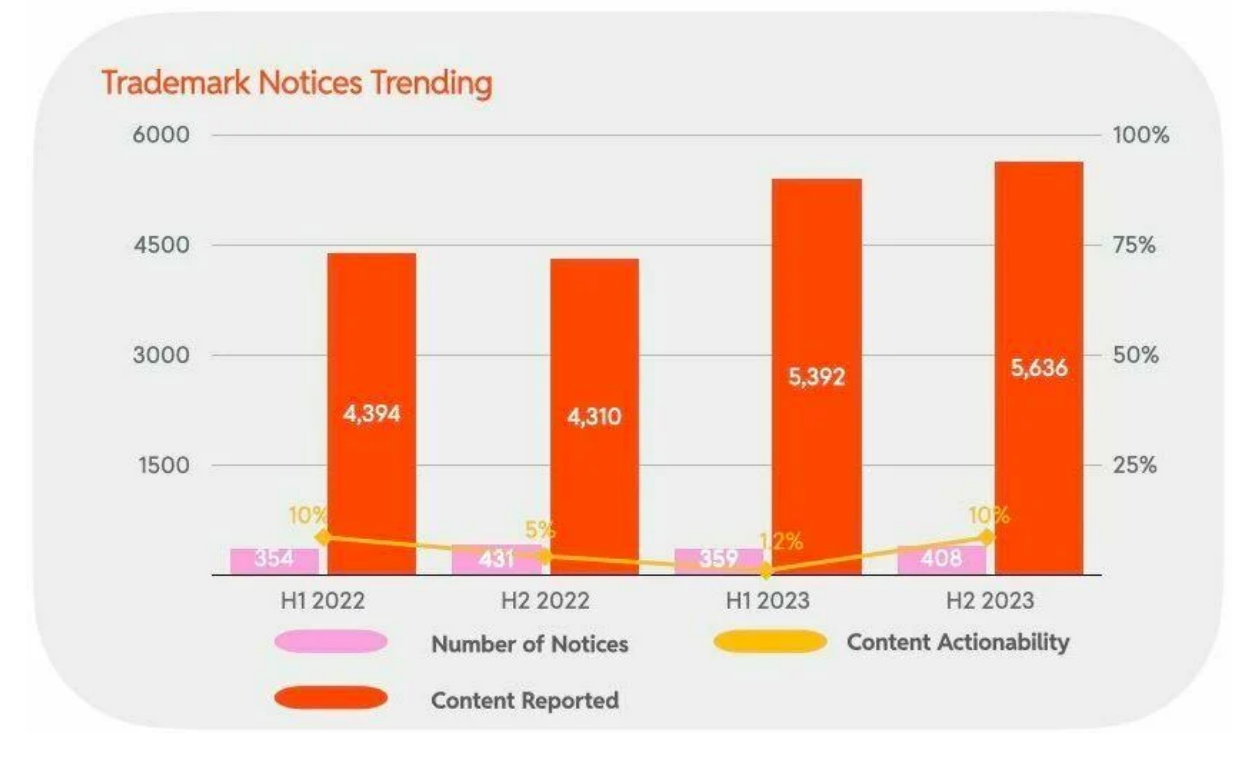
Chart 40 : Trademark Notices (July-December 2023)



Trademark Notices (July-December 2023)

Year	Number of Notices	Notices Complied with in whole or in part	Notice Actionability	Content Reported	Content Removed	Content Actionability Rate
July - December 2023	408	54	13%	5,636	567	10%

Chart 41. Trademark Notices Trending



Trademark User and Subreddit Bans

Under certain circumstances, Reddit may ban users who repeatedly violate Reddit's Trademark Policy. We may also ban subreddits after multiple removals of violative content or where it is clear that the subreddit is dedicated to violative content.

From July to December of 2023, Reddit banned 19 users and 5 subreddits for repeat violations of our Trademark Policy.

Invalid Trademark Notices

When Reddit receives an invalid trademark takedown notice, we reject the notice and decline to remove the reported content.

From July to December of 2023, we rejected 354 trademark takedown notices and declined to remove 5,069 pieces of content that did not qualify for removal because of invalid notices.

A notice may be invalid for many reasons, including:

- Failing to include information sufficient to assess whether or not a trademark policy violation has occurred, such as failing to identify a valid, registered trademark
- Reporting content that does not make use of the trademark
- Targeting content that makes a "fair use" of the claimant's trademark, as allowed by trademark law
- Reporting content from a different jurisdiction or for a different class of goods/services than the trademark is registered to protect
- Confusing other policy issues for trademark, such as copyright infringement, privacy, or harassment

Notable Examples:

- Fair Use: A grocery company submitted a trademark takedown notice about a Reddit post containing an image that featured the company's trademarked logo. The image was styled like a political advertisement, and the logo was paired with a snarky comment about the company's alleged campaign donations to a certain political candidate and that candidate's support of a restrictive state abortion ban. We declined to remove the content based on the principles set forth under the trademark fair use doctrine, as the logo was featured in the post for the sole purpose of providing social criticism/commentary.
- Different Goods/Services: A business training consultant submitted a trademark takedown notice regarding a Reddit post containing a link to an online strategy game. The game shares the same name as the consultant's business. Trademarks are specific to the registered type of goods/services they protect, so the use of the consultant's trademark was not likely to cause consumer confusion as to the source or affiliation of the reported content. We rejected the notice and declined to remove the content.

Information Requests

This section covers the volume of global information requests received during the second half of 2023, along with our rate of disclosure and other insights.

At Reddit, we believe that privacy is a right. By default, we collect and retain limited information for most accounts as outlined in our privacy policy.

Reddit receives a variety of requests for account information, including legal process (e.g., a warrant or court order) related to government and law enforcement investigations, private party legal requests related to civil litigation or criminal defense, and user requests for their own data under applicable privacy regulations.

Legal Requests for Account Information

Reddit may disclose specific account information in response to valid legal requests from government and law enforcement agencies or private parties (e.g., civil litigants and criminal defendants) when required by law and in certain emergency situations. A specialized Reddit team carefully reviews every information request for procedural validity and legal sufficiency, and objects when appropriate.

User Notice

To promote due process and maximize transparency, Reddit attempts to notify our users when their account data is subject to legal information requests before any disclosures are made (i.e. pre-production notice), unless we are legally prohibited from doing so, or under certain other counterproductive circumstances (e.g., exigent emergency situations, child safety matters).

If Reddit is legally prohibited from providing pre-production notice of an information request, Reddit will attempt to notify the user upon expiration of the legally enforced non-disclosure period (i.e. post-production notice).

For more information regarding user notice, please refer to the Reddit Guidelines for Law Enforcement.

Government and Law Enforcement Agency Requests for Account Information

Reddit receives legal requests for the disclosure of account information from global government and law enforcement agencies on a regular basis. These requests are typically one of two varieties: non-emergency disclosure requests or exigent emergency disclosure requests.

- Non-emergency information requests require the issuance of formal legal process, such as a warrant or court order, which is then submitted to Reddit for processing.
- Emergency disclosure requests involving threats of imminent death or serious bodily harm do not require formal legal process due to their exigent nature, but must be submitted in accordance with applicable law (e.g. 18 USC § 2702(c)(4)).

Non-emergency Government and Law Enforcement Agency Requests for Account Information

Reddit carefully reviews each request for compliance with applicable laws. If we determine that a request is not legally valid (e.g., missing legal requirements; seeking information outside the scope of the issued legal process), Reddit will challenge or reject it. If we consider the request to be overbroad or unclear, we will ask the requesting entity to modify or refine the request.

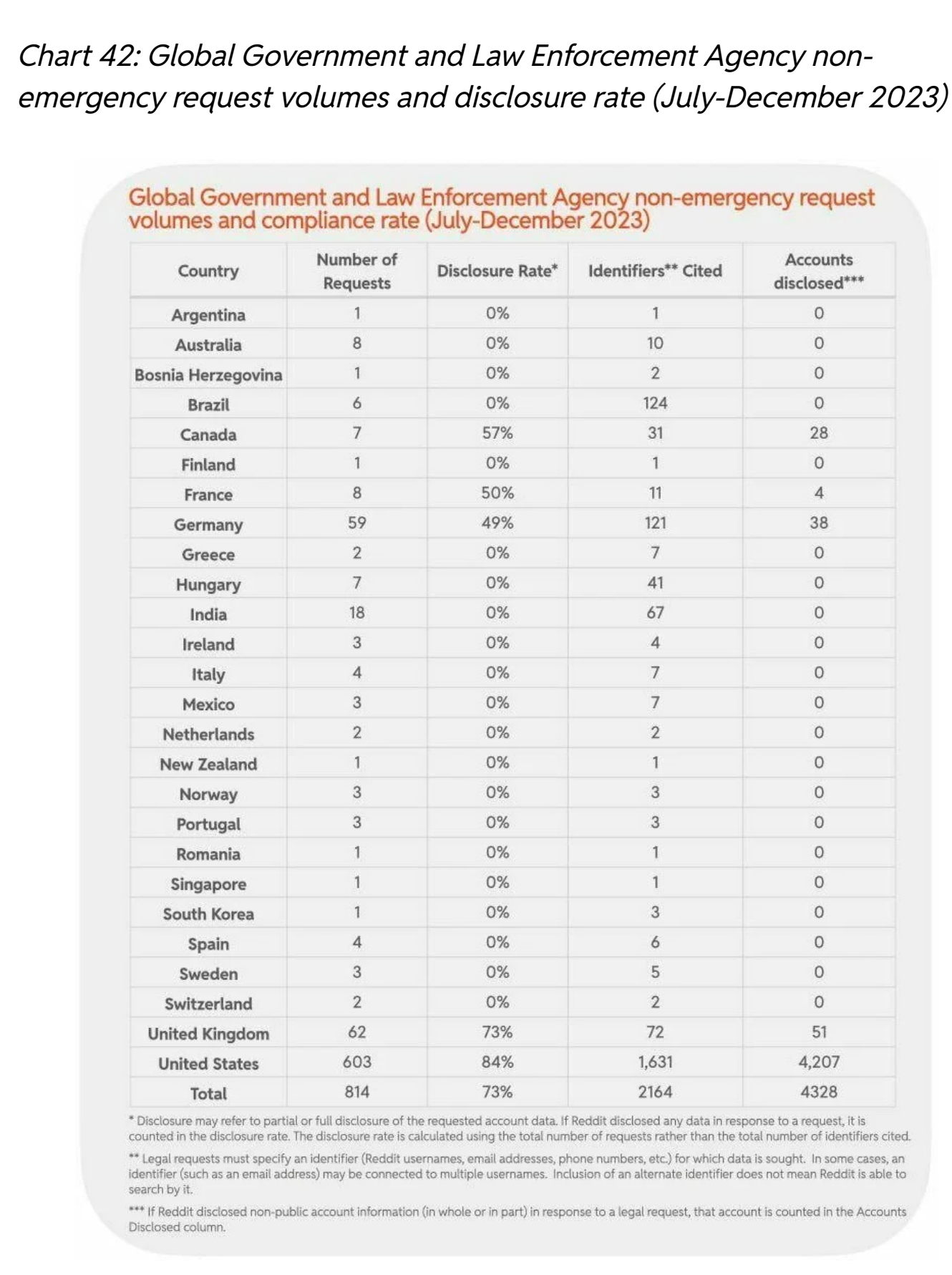
All requests for account information must be narrowly tailored, identify the account(s) at issue (e.g., u/name or email address), and specify the information sought (e.g., IP addresses).

Between July and December 2023, Reddit received 814 non-emergency legal requests for account information from global government and law enforcement agencies. Reddit disclosed account information in response to 591 of these global legal requests (73%), which related to 4328 accounts.

The U.S. accounted for 603 requests (74%) of global volume, and Reddit disclosed data (in whole or in part) in response to 509 (84.4%) of them.

Compared to the first half of 2023, non-emergency information requests decreased by 8% during this reporting period. Reddit's disclosure rate decreased to 73%, compared to 75% for the first half of 2023.

Chart 42: Global Government and Law Enforcement Agency non-emergency request volumes and disclosure rate (July-December 2023)



Global Government and Law Enforcement Agency non-emergency request volumes and compliance rate (July-December 2023)

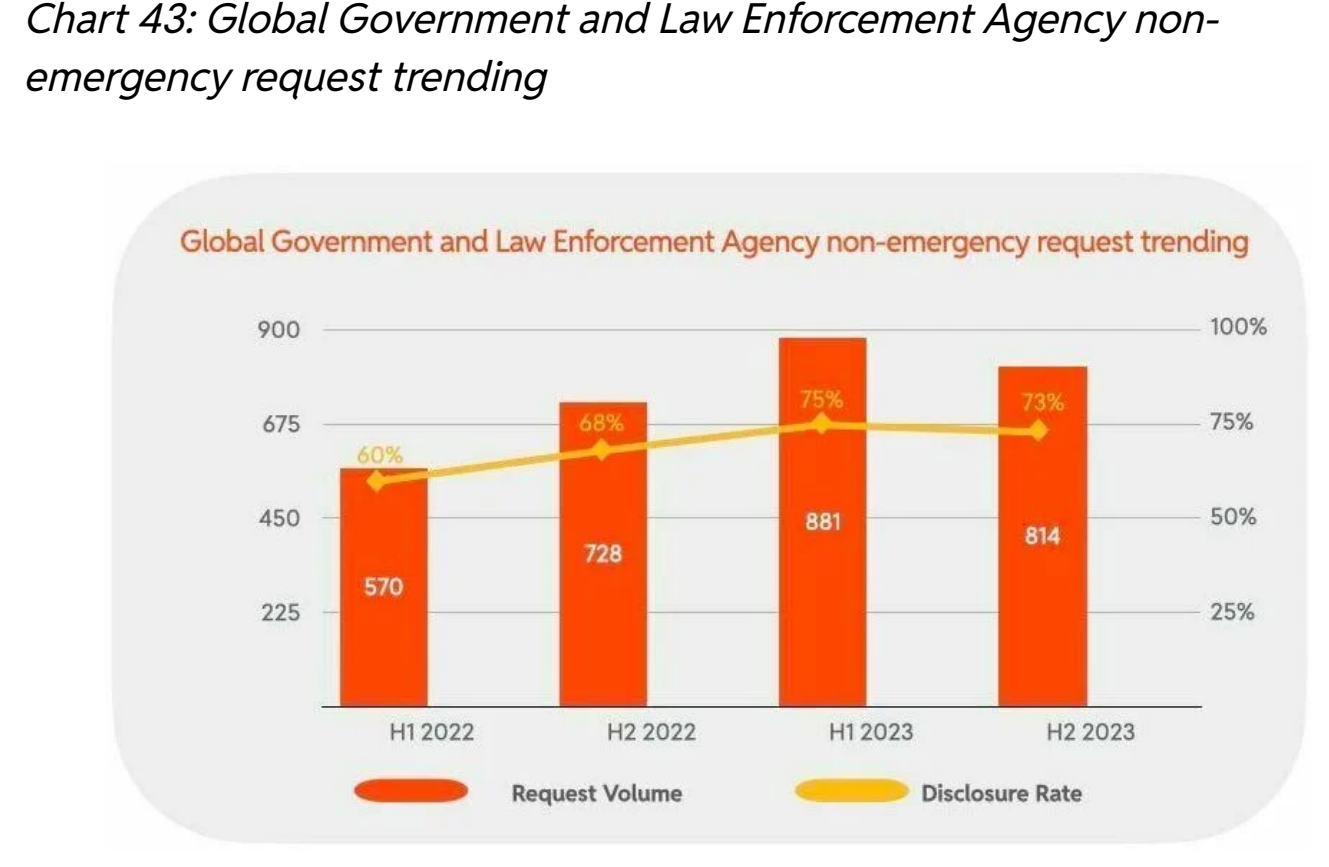
Country	Number of Requests	Disclosure Rate*	Identifiers** Cited	Accounts disclosed***
Argentina	1	0%	1	0
Australia	8	0%	10	0
Bosnia Herzegovina	1	0%	2	0
Brazil	6	0%	124	0
Canada	7	57%	31	28
Finland	1	0%	1	0
France	8	50%	11	4
Germany	59	49%	121	38
Greece	2	0%	7	0
Hungary	7	0%	41	0
India	18	0%	67	0
Ireland	3	0%	4	0
Italy	4	0%	7	0
Mexico	3	0%	7	0
Netherlands	2	0%	2	0
New Zealand	1	0%	1	0
Norway	3	0%	3	0
Portugal	3	0%	3	0
Romania	1	0%	1	0
Singapore	1	0%	1	0
South Korea	1	0%	3	0
Spain	4	0%	6	0
Sweden	3	0%	5	0
Switzerland	2	0%	2	0
United Kingdom	62	73%	72	51
United States	603	84%	1,631	4,207
Total	814	73%	2164	4328

* Disclosure may refer to partial or full disclosure of the requested account data. If Reddit disclosed any data in response to a request, it is counted in the disclosure rate. The disclosure rate is calculated using the total number of requests rather than the total number of identifiers cited.

** Legal requests must specify an identifier (Reddit usernames, email addresses, phone numbers, etc.) for which data is sought. In some cases, an identifier (such as an email address) may be connected to multiple usernames. Inclusion of an alternate identifier does not mean Reddit is able to search by it.

*** If Reddit disclosed non-public account information (in whole or in part) in response to a legal request, that account is counted in the Accounts Disclosed column.

Chart 43: Global Government and Law Enforcement Agency non-emergency request trending



Fraudulent Global Requests

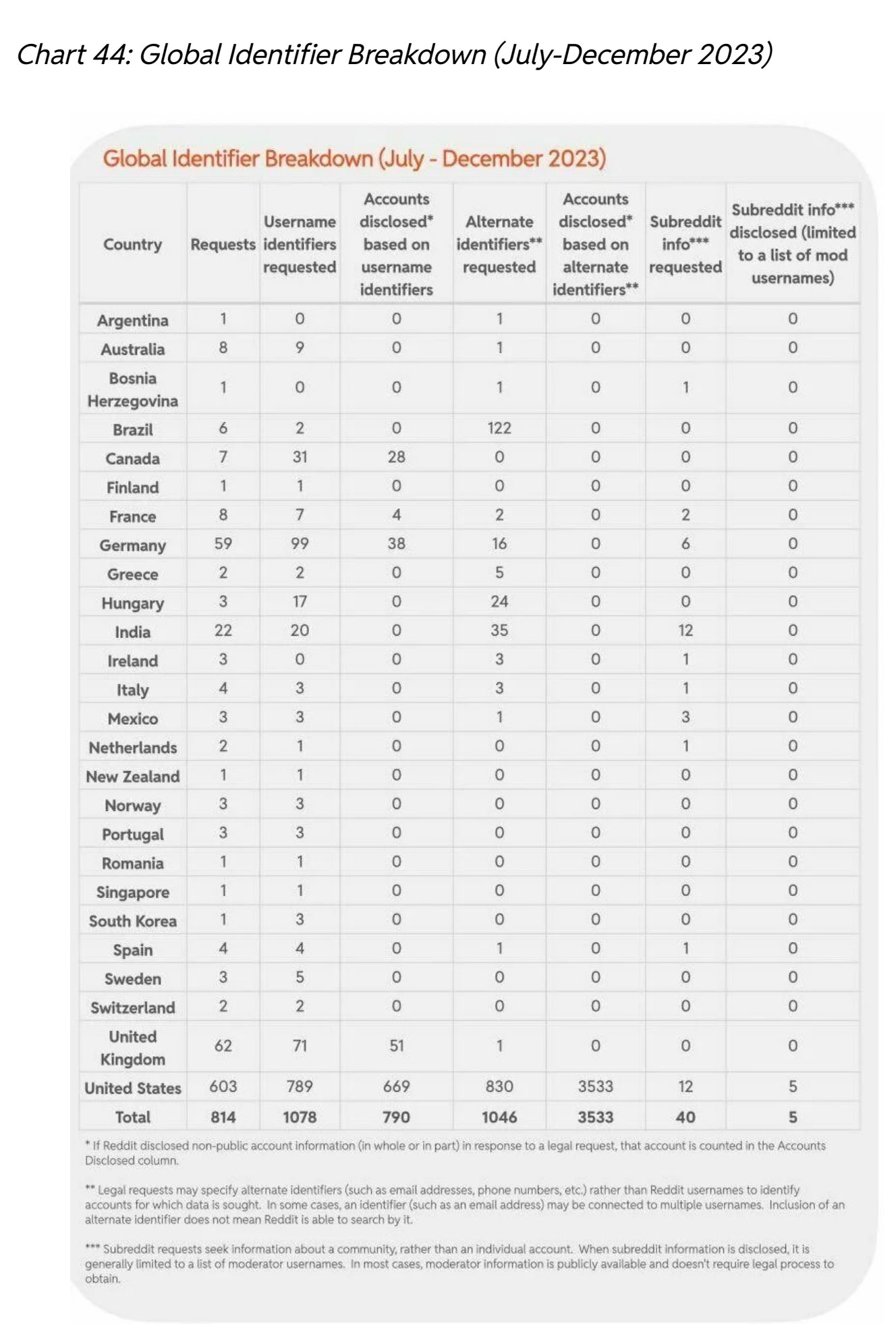
As noted above, Reddit carefully reviews all legal requests for account information to ensure that, among other things, they are properly issued and submitted by legitimate law enforcement agencies. If we identify fraudulent requests, we reject them and notify the appropriate authorities.

Reddit did not identify any fraudulent global requests for data disclosure during this reporting period.

Global Identifier Breakdown

To provide more detailed insights into global requests for account information, we are including a breakdown of the types of identifiers specified in global requests, along with the number of accounts for which information was disclosed for each identifier type.

Chart 44: Global Identifier Breakdown (July-December 2023)



Global Identifier Breakdown (July - December 2023)

Country	Requests	Username identifiers requested	Accounts disclosed* based on username identifiers	Alternate identifiers** requested	Accounts disclosed* based on alternate identifiers**	Subreddit info*** requested	Subreddit info*** disclosed (limited to a list of mod usernames)
Argentina	1	0	0	1	0	0	0
Australia	8	9	0	1	0	0	0
Bosnia Herzegovina	1	0	0	1	0	1	0
Brazil	6	2	0	122	0	0	0
Canada	7	31	28	0	0	0	0
Finland	1	1	0	0	0	0	0
France	8	7	4	2	0	2	0
Germany	59	99	38	16	0	6	0
Greece	2	2	0	5	0	0	0
Hungary	3	17	0	24	0	0	0
India	22	20	0	35	0	12	0
Ireland	3	0	0	3	0	1	0
Italy	4	3	0	3	0	1	0
Mexico	3	3	0	1	0	3	0
Netherlands	2	1	0	0	0	1	0
New Zealand	1	1	0	0	0	0	0
Norway	3	3	0	0	0	0	0
Portugal	3	3	0	0	0	0	0
Romania	1	1	0	0	0	0	0
Singapore	1	1	0	0	0	0	0
South Korea	1	3	0	0	0	0	0
Spain	4	4	0	1	0	1	0
Sweden	3	5	0	0	0	0	0
Switzerland	2	2	0	0	0	0	0
United Kingdom	62	71	51	1	0	0	0
United States	603	789	669	830	3533	12	5
Total	814	1078	790	1046	3533	40	5

* If Reddit disclosed non-public account information (in whole or in part) in response to a legal request, that account is counted in the Accounts Disclosed column.

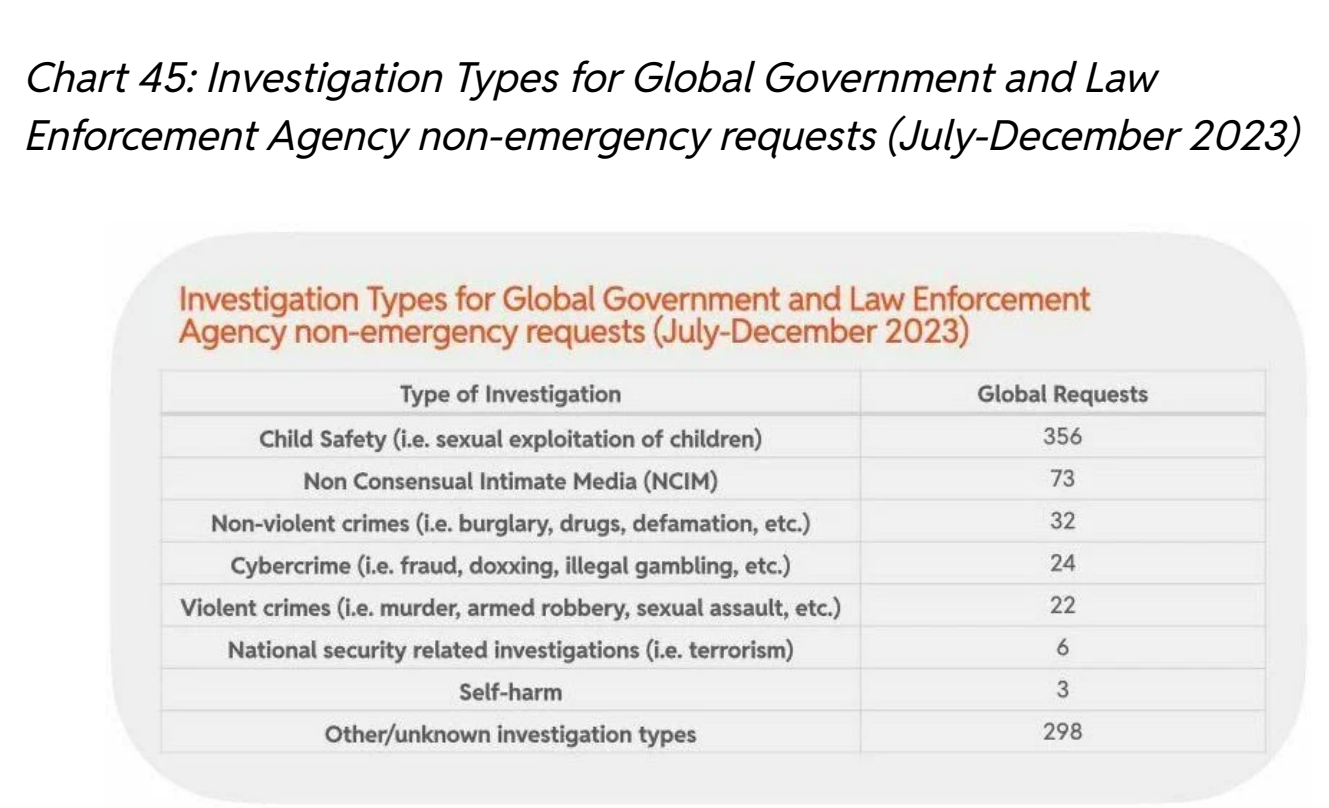
** Legal requests may specify alternate identifiers (such as email addresses, phone numbers, etc.) rather than Reddit usernames to identify accounts for which data is sought. In some cases, an identifier (such as an email address) may be connected to multiple usernames. Inclusion of an alternate identifier does not mean Reddit is able to search by it.

*** Subreddit requests seek information about a community, rather than an individual account. When subreddit information is disclosed, it is generally limited to a list of moderator usernames. In most cases, moderator information is publicly available and doesn't require legal process to obtain.

Types of Investigations

To provide more detailed insights into global requests for account information, we are continuing to include details about the types of investigations associated with these requests as noted by law enforcement.

Chart 45: Investigation Types for Global Government and Law Enforcement Agency non-emergency requests (July-December 2023)



Investigation Types for Global Government and Law Enforcement Agency non-emergency requests (July-December 2023)

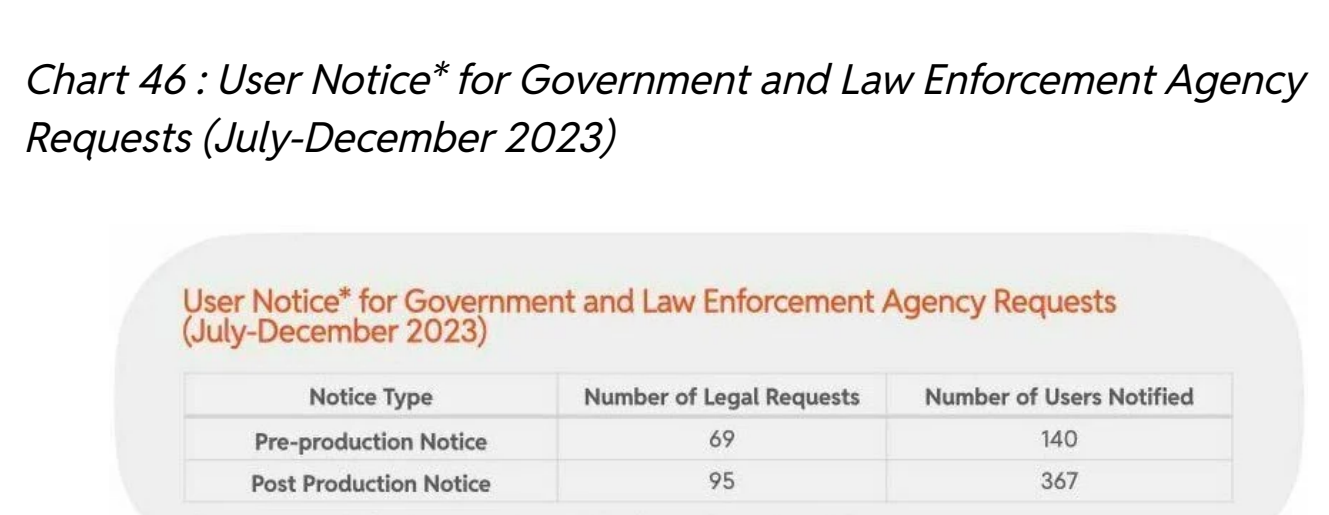
Type of Investigation	Global Requests
Child Safety (i.e. sexual exploitation of children)	356
Non Consensual Intimate Media (NCIM)	73
Non-violent crimes (i.e. burglary, drugs, defamation, etc.)	32
Cybercrime (i.e. fraud, doxxing, illegal gambling, etc.)	24
Violent crimes (i.e. murder, armed robbery, sexual assault, etc.)	22
National security related investigations (i.e. terrorism)	6
Self-harm	3
Other/unknown investigation types	298

User Notice about Government and Law Enforcement Agency Requests

Reddit attempts to notify users about legal requests seeking disclosure of their account information unless prohibited from doing so by law, or under limited exceptions where notice would be counterproductive. With that said, government and law enforcement requests are often subject to non-disclosure orders (NDOs) or other prohibitions that stop or delay user notice. In those cases, we pushback when an NDO does not specify an expiration or otherwise impedes on Redditors' rights.

Reddit provided pre-production user notice for 11% of global government and law enforcement requests received between July and December 2023.

Chart 46 : User Notice for Government and Law Enforcement Agency Requests (July-December 2023)*



User Notice* for Government and Law Enforcement Agency Requests (July-December 2023)

Notice Type	Number of Legal Requests	Number of Users Notified
Pre-production Notice	69	140
Post Production Notice	95	367

*User notice may apply to legal process received outside of the current reporting period.

Non-emergency U.S. Legal Process Types

The overwhelming majority of global requests to disclose account information continue to originate from U.S. government and law enforcement authorities.

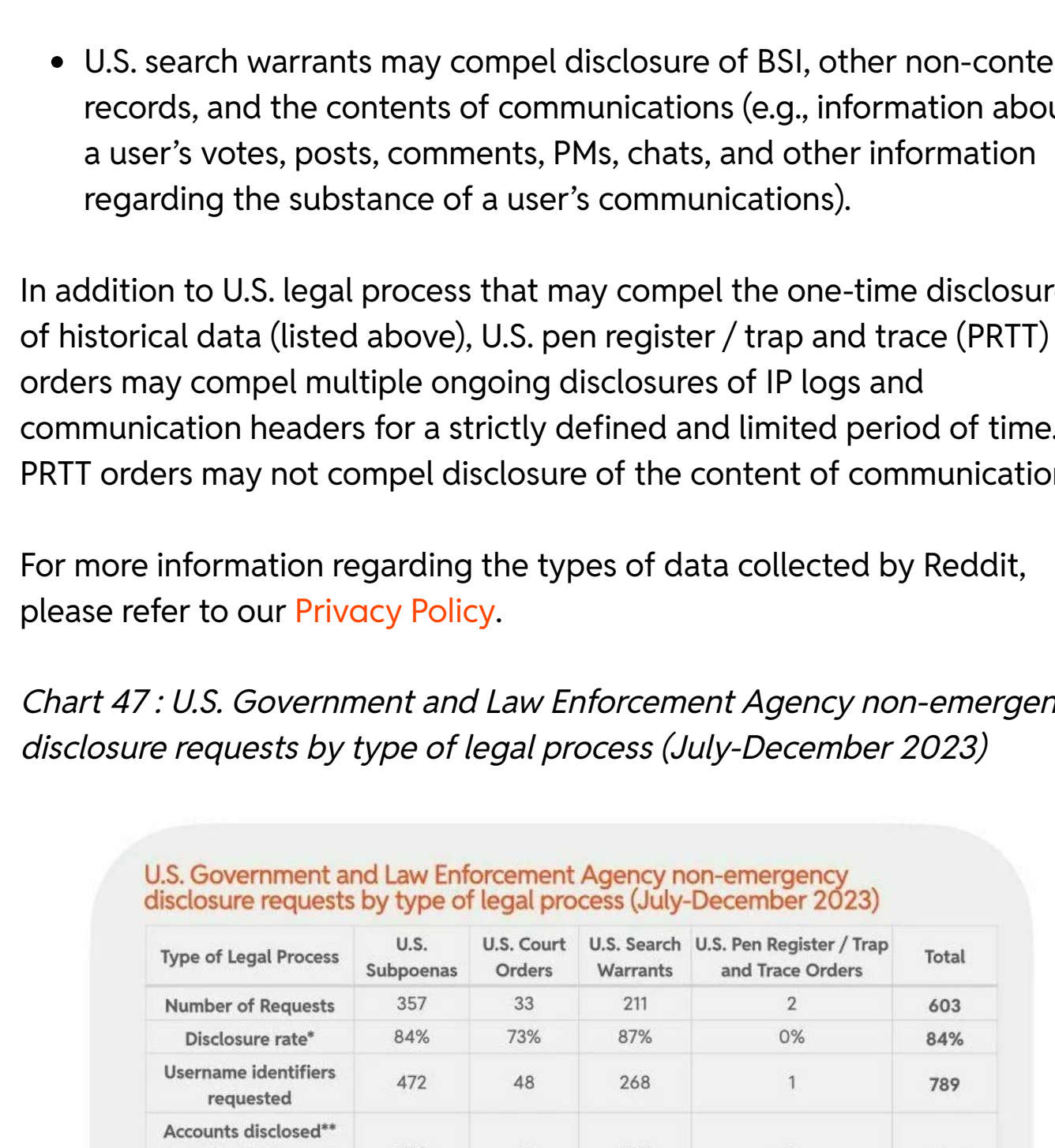
The type of U.S. legal process served on Reddit determines the categories of historical data that Reddit may be compelled to disclose. In general:

- U.S. subpoenas may compel disclosure of basic subscriber information (BSI): IP logs (including registration IP), the account holder's email address (if any), and phone number (if any).
- U.S. court orders may compel disclosure of BSI and other non-content records about the account, such as account preferences and communication header information (e.g., the to/from fields of a Private Message or the participant list for a chat discussion).
- U.S. search warrants may compel disclosure of BSI, other non-content records, and the contents of communications (e.g., information about a user's votes, posts, comments, PMs, chats, and other information regarding the substance of a user's communications).

In addition to U.S. legal process that may compel the one-time disclosure of historical data (listed above), U.S. pen register / trap and trace (PRTT) orders may compel multiple ongoing disclosures of IP logs and communication headers for a strictly defined and limited period of time. PRTT orders may not compel disclosure of the content of communications.

For more information regarding the types of data collected by Reddit, please refer to our Privacy Policy.

Chart 47 : U.S. Government and Law Enforcement Agency non-emergency disclosure requests by type of legal process (July-December 2023)



U.S. Government and Law Enforcement Agency non-emergency disclosure requests by type of legal process (July-December 2023)

Type of Legal Process	U.S. Subpoenas	U.S. Court Orders	U.S. Search Warrants	U.S. Pen Register / Trap and Trace Orders	Total
Number of Requests	357	33	211	2	603
Disclosure rate*	84%	73%	87%	0%	84%
Username identifiers requested	472	48	268	1	789
Accounts disclosed** based on username identifiers	393	41	235	0	669
Alternate identifiers*** requested	429	106	294	1	830
Accounts disclosed** based on alternate identifiers***	426	202	2905	0	3533
Subreddit info**** requested	9	2	1	0	12
Subreddit info**** disclosed(limited to a list of mod usernames)	4	0	1	0	5

* Disclosure may refer to partial or full disclosure of the requested account data. If Reddit disclosed any data in response to a request, it is counted in the disclosure rate. The disclosure rate is calculated using the total number of requests rather than the total number of identifiers cited.

** If Reddit disclosed non-public account information (in whole or in part) in response to a legal request, that account is counted in the Accounts Disclosed column.

*** Legal requests may specify alternate identifiers (such as email addresses, phone numbers, etc.) rather than Reddit usernames to identify accounts for which data is south. In some cases, an identifier (such as an email address) may be connected to multiple usernames. Inclusion of an alternate identifier does not mean Reddit is able to search by it.

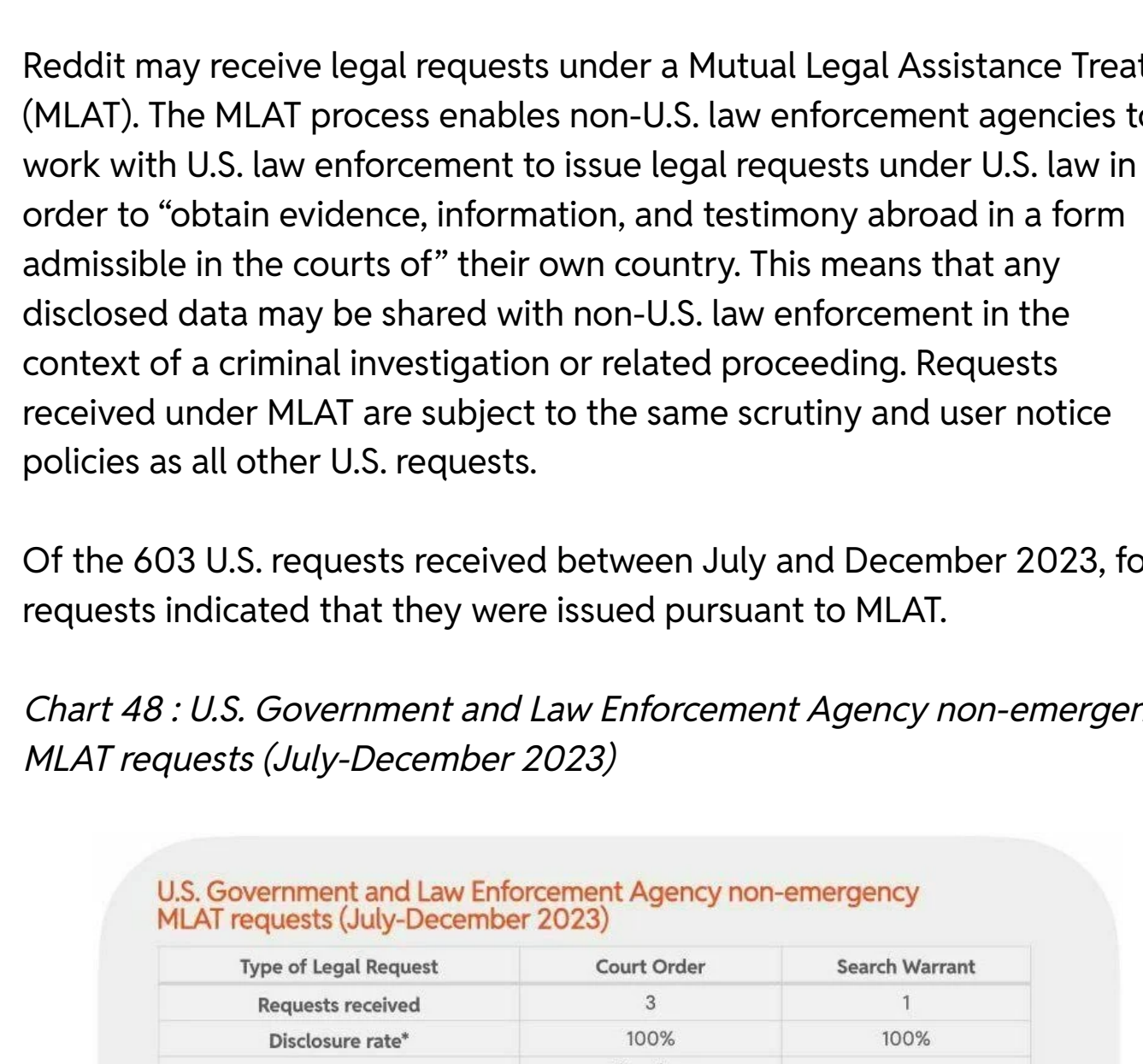
**** Subreddit requests seek information about a community, rather than an individual account. When subreddit information is disclosed, it is generally limited to a list of moderator usernames. In most cases, moderator information is publicly available and doesn't require legal process to obtain.

U.S. Requests under a Mutual Legal Assistance Treaty (MLAT)

Reddit may receive legal requests under a Mutual Legal Assistance Treaty (MLAT). The MLAT process enables non-U.S. law enforcement agencies to work with U.S. law enforcement to issue legal requests under U.S. law in order to "obtain evidence, information, and testimony abroad in a form admissible in the courts of" their own country. This means that any disclosed data may be shared with non-U.S. law enforcement in the context of a criminal investigation or related proceeding. Requests received under MLAT are subject to the same scrutiny and user notice policies as all other U.S. requests.

Of the 603 U.S. requests received between July and December 2023, four requests indicated that they were issued pursuant to MLAT.

Chart 48 : U.S. Government and Law Enforcement Agency non-emergency MLAT requests (July-December 2023)



U.S. Government and Law Enforcement Agency non-emergency MLAT requests (July-December 2023)

Type of Legal Request	Court Order	Search Warrant
Requests received	3	1
Disclosure rate*	100%	100%
MLAT Countries	Sweden Republic of Ireland Poland	Denmark
Username identifiers requested	3	1
Accounts disclosed** based on username identifiers	3	1
Alternate identifiers*** requested	1	0
Accounts disclosed** based on alternate identifiers***	2	0
Subreddit info**** requested	0	0
Subreddit info**** disclosed	0	0

* Disclosure may refer to partial or full disclosure of the requested account data. If Reddit disclosed any data in response to a request, it is counted in the disclosure rate. The disclosure rate is calculated using the total number of requests rather than the total number of identifiers cited.

** If Reddit disclosed non-public account information (in whole or in part) in response to a legal request, that account is counted in the Accounts Disclosed column.

*** Legal requests may specify alternate identifiers (such as email addresses, phone numbers, etc.) rather than Reddit usernames to identify accounts for which data is south. In some cases, an identifier (such as an email address) may be connected to multiple usernames. Inclusion of an alternate identifier does not mean Reddit is able to search by it.

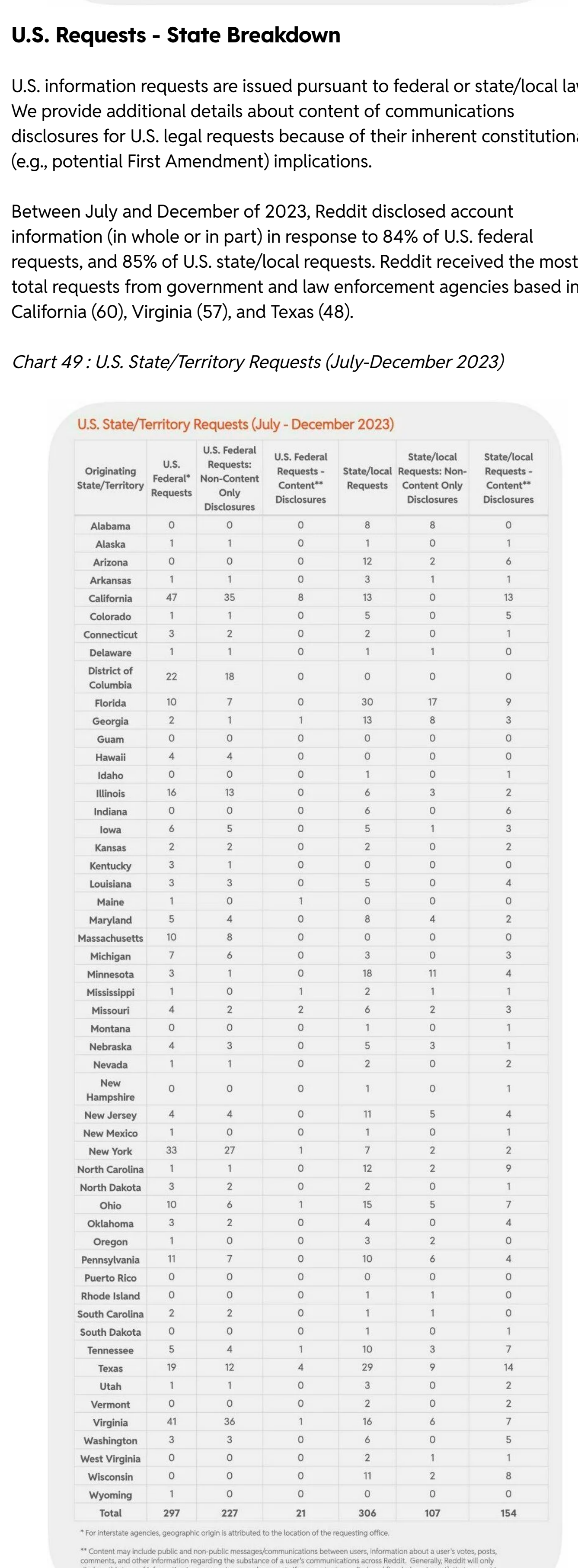
**** Subreddit requests seek information about a community, rather than an individual account. When subreddit information is disclosed, it is generally limited to a list of moderator usernames. In most cases, moderator information is publicly available and doesn't require legal process to obtain.

U.S. Requests - State Breakdown

U.S. information requests are issued pursuant to federal or state/local law. We provide additional details about content of communications disclosures for U.S. legal requests because of their inherent constitutional (e.g., potential First Amendment) implications.

Between July and December of 2023, Reddit disclosed account information (in whole or in part) in response to 84% of U.S. federal requests, and 85% of U.S. state/local requests. Reddit received the most total requests from government and law enforcement agencies based in California (60), Virginia (57), and Texas (48).

Chart 49 : U.S. State/Territory Requests (July-December 2023)



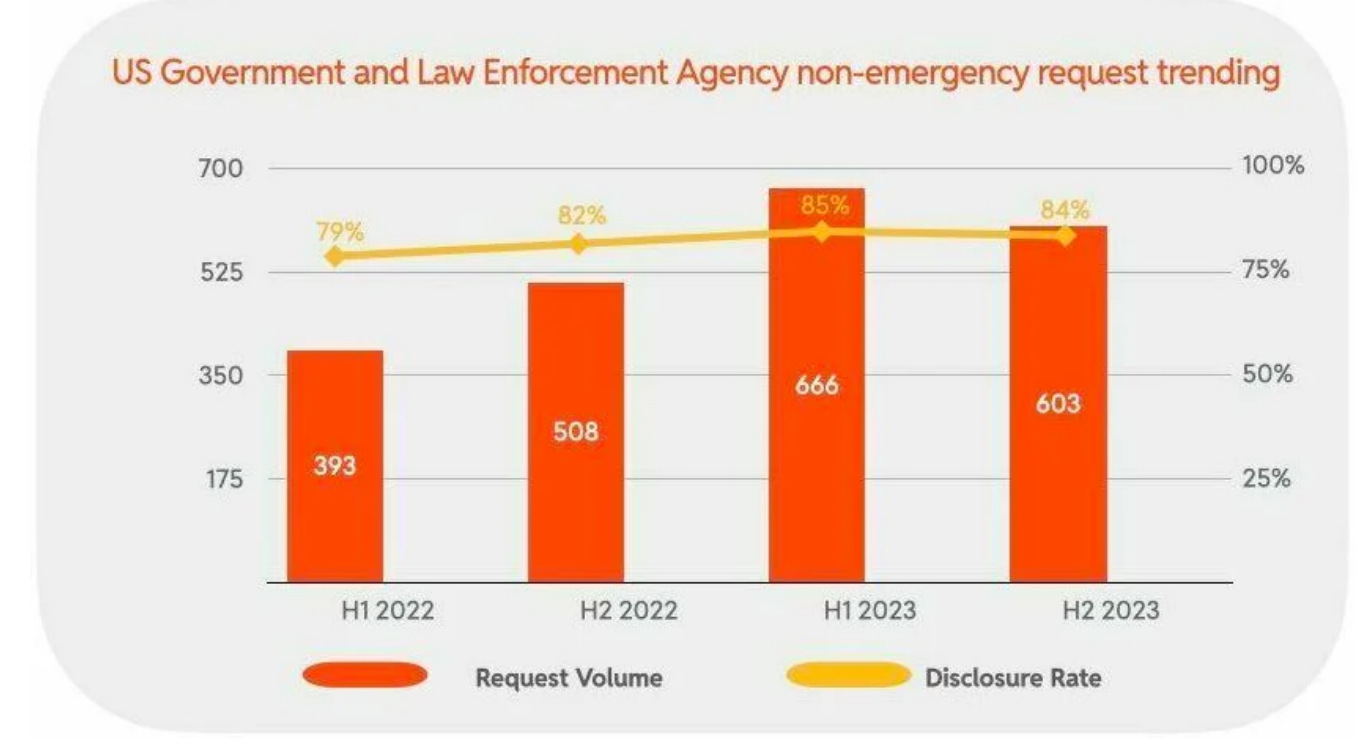
U.S. State/Territory Requests (July - December 2023)

Originating State/Territory	U.S. Federal* Requests	U.S. Federal Requests: Non-Content Only Disclosures	U.S. Federal Requests - Content** Disclosures	State/local Requests	State/local Requests: Non-Content Only Disclosures	State/local Requests - Content** Disclosures
Alabama	0	0	0	8	8	0
Alaska	1	1	0	1	0	1
Arizona	0	0	0	12	2	6
Arkansas	1	1	0	3	1	1
California	47	35	8	13	0	13
Colorado	1	1	0	5	0	5
Connecticut	3	2	0	2	0	1
Delaware	1	1	0	1	1	0
District of Columbia	22	18	0	0	0	0
Florida	10	7	0	30	17	9
Georgia	2	1	1	13	8	3
Guam	0	0	0	0	0	0
Hawaii	4	4	0	0	0	0
Idaho	0	0	0	1	0	1
Illinois	16	13	0	6	3	2
Indiana	0	0	0	6	0	6
Iowa	6	5	0	5	1	3
Kansas	2	2	0	2	0	2
Kentucky	3	1	0	0	0	0
Louisiana	3	3	0	5	0	4
Maine	1	0	1	0	0	0
Maryland	5	4	0	8	4	2
Massachusetts	10	8	0	0	0	0
Michigan	7	6	0	3	0	3
Minnesota	3	1	0	18	11	4
Mississippi	1	0	1	2	1	1
Missouri	4	2	2	6	2	3
Montana	0	0	0	1	0	1
Nebraska	4	3	0	5	3	1
Nevada	1	1	0	2	0	2
New Hampshire	0	0	0	1	0	1
New Jersey	4	4	0	11	5	4
New Mexico	1	0	0	1	0	1
New York	33	27	1	7	2	2
North Carolina	1	1	0	12	2	9
North Dakota	3	2	0	2	0	1
Ohio	10	6	1	15	5	7
Oklahoma	3	2	0	4	0	4
Oregon	1	0	0	3	2	0
Pennsylvania	11	7	0	10	6	4
Puerto Rico	0	0	0	0	0	0
Rhode Island	0	0	0	1	1	0
South Carolina	2	2	0	1	1	0
South Dakota	0	0	0	1	0	1
Tennessee	5	4	1	10	3	7
Texas	19	12	4	29	9	14
Utah	1	1	0	3	0	2
Vermont	0	0	0	2	0	2
Virginia	41	36	1	16	6	7
Washington	3	3	0	6	0	5
West Virginia	0	0	0	2	1	1
Wisconsin	0	0	0	11	2	8
Wyoming	1	0	0	0	0	0
Total	297	227	21	306	107	154

* For interstate agencies, geographic origin is attributed to the location of the requesting office.

** Content may include public and non-public messages/communications between users, information about a user's votes, posts, comments, and other information regarding the substance of a user's communications across Reddit. Generally, Reddit will only disclose this type of information in response to a search warrant. If any content was disclosed (in whole or in part), that request is counted in the respective Content Disclosure column.

Chart 50 : U.S. Government and Law Enforcement Agency non-emergency request trending



Notable U.S. Requests

We take pride in protecting user privacy and freedom of speech by carefully scrutinizing all information requests, and particularly in the context of legal requests to unmask anonymous account holders. The following example represents one of the most notable requests we received between July and December 2023 where we pushed back based on these principles:

LAPD Search Warrant

tl;dr - In October 2022, Reddit was served with a sealed search warrant from the Los Angeles Police Department seeking records from an account allegedly involved in the leak of a recording of a Los Angeles City Council meeting that resulted in the resignation of several prominent political leaders. We fought to notify the account holder about the warrant, and while we didn't prevail initially, we were ultimately successful in our efforts to provide user notice to the Redditor. More information about the leak can be found here.

Full background - LAPD had obtained a court order prohibiting Reddit from notifying anyone–including the user–of the search warrant. Reddit asked law enforcement to waive the order and permit user notice, given the public nature of the investigation; however, they refused, and Reddit disclosed responsive account records (as it was legally required to do so) in November 2022. Upon expiration of the first non-disclosure order, LAPD sought and obtained a new court order extending the prohibition on user notice. This was despite the fact that they had publicly confirmed details of the investigation to the press. Concerned that law enforcement was abusing secrecy rules, we filed a formal legal challenge of the non-disclosure order extension. However, the court sided with law enforcement, upholding the non-disclosure order and keeping Reddit's challenge under seal. LAPD then proceeded to apply for and obtain several additional court orders (some from different judges) extending the prohibition on user notice, the last of which was served in November 2023. Reddit again filed a motion challenging the extended non-disclosure orders and was finally successful in convincing the City Attorney and LAPD to permit user notice (which Reddit provided), and the court to enter an order unsealing both proceedings in which Reddit challenged the non-disclosure order extensions.

Fraudulent U.S. Requests

As noted above, Reddit carefully reviews all legal requests for account information to ensure that, among other things, they are properly issued and submitted by legitimate law enforcement agencies. If we identify fraudulent requests, we reject them and notify the appropriate authorities.

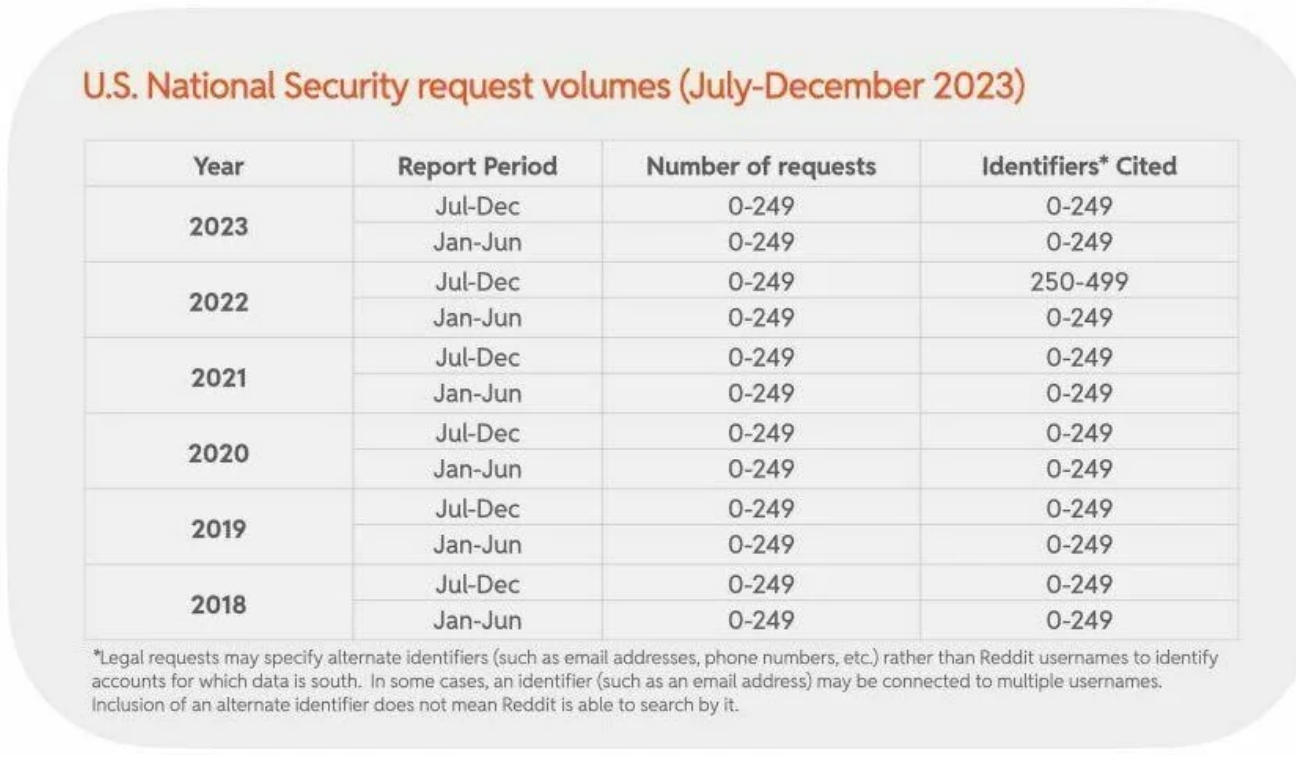
Reddit did not identify any fraudulent U.S. requests for data disclosure during this reporting period.

National Security Requests

U.S. law prohibits us from reporting exact numbers of National Security Letters (NSLs) or Foreign Intelligence Surveillance Act (FISA) orders received. The U.S. FREEDOM ACT of 2015 (50 U.S.C. §1874) sets forth large bands of numbers that a company must use if it wants to report on the receipt of national security legal requests. Furthermore, companies are required to use even larger bands to differentiate between receipt of NSLs and FISA orders.

These reporting rules may work for larger companies that receive large numbers of national security requests, but they do little to provide meaningful transparency for smaller companies like Reddit that receive few, if any, national security requests. These disclosure rules undermine the effectiveness of this transparency report and diminish the trust our communities place in us.

Chart 51 : U.S. National Security request volumes (July-December 2023)



U.S. National Security request volumes (July-December 2023)

Year	Report Period	Number of requests	Identifiers* Cited
2023	Jul-Dec	0-249	0-249
	Jan-Jun	0-249	0-249
2022	Jul-Dec	0-249	250-499
	Jan-Jun	0-249	0-249
2021	Jul-Dec	0-249	0-249
	Jan-Jun	0-249	0-249
2020	Jul-Dec	0-249	0-249
	Jan-Jun	0-249	0-249
2019	Jul-Dec	0-249	0-249
	Jan-Jun	0-249	0-249
2018	Jul-Dec	0-249	0-249
	Jan-Jun	0-249	0-249

*Legal requests may specify alternate identifiers (such as email addresses, phone numbers, etc.) rather than Reddit usernames to identify accounts for which data is south. In some cases, an identifier (such as an email address) may be connected to multiple usernames. Inclusion of an alternate identifier does not mean Reddit is able to search by it.

Emergency Disclosure Requests

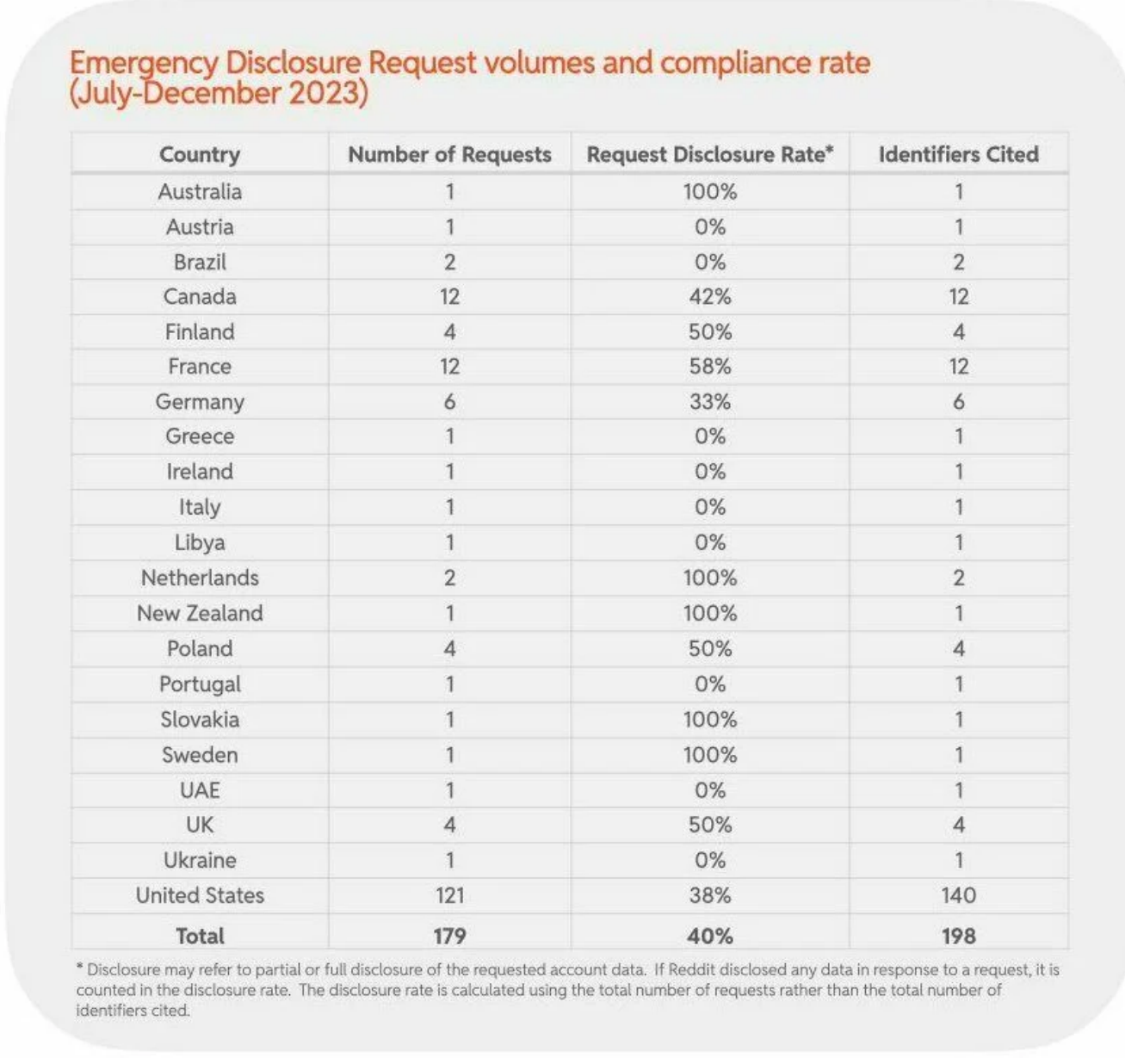
In emergency situations, law enforcement may submit Emergency Disclosure Requests (EDRs) seeking disclosure of limited account information to assist with preventing or mitigating the exigent situation without first obtaining legal process to compel disclosure, as is required under ordinary circumstances. Under U.S. law, Reddit may grant such requests if we have a good faith belief that disclosure is necessary to prevent imminent death or serious bodily harm to a person.

Reddit evaluates these requests on a case-by-case basis. We may request additional information for a variety of reasons, including to further contextualize the nature of the emergency, clarify overly-broad requests, or validate the identity of the law enforcement official that is seeking data. Requests that do not meet the emergency disclosure threshold may be denied, and the requester may be directed to obtain legal process.

In the second half of 2023, Reddit received 198 EDRs from law enforcement agencies around the world (down 7% compared to last report), and disclosed limited account information in response to 72 (40%) of those requests (up 6% from last report).

During this period, Reddit received EDRs from 21 different countries and disclosed limited account information in response to requests from 11. We also received our first-ever EDRs from Libya, Slovakia, and Ukraine.

Chart 52 : Emergency Disclosure Request volumes and disclosure rate (July-December 2023)

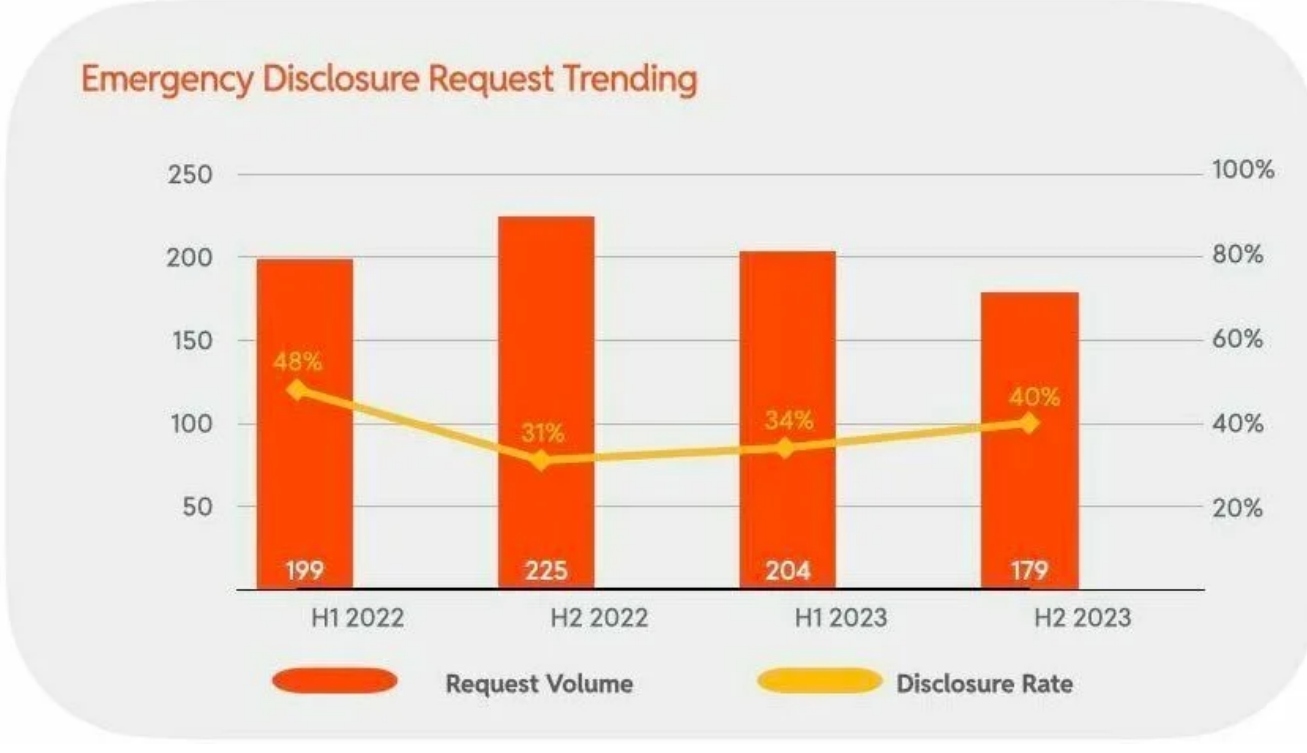


Emergency Disclosure Request volumes and compliance rate (July-December 2023)

Country	Number of Requests	Request Disclosure Rate*	Identifiers Cited
Australia	1	100%	1
Austria	1	0%	1
Brazil	2	0%	2
Canada	12	42%	12
Finland	4	50%	4
France	12	58%	12
Germany	6	33%	6
Greece	1	0%	1
Ireland	1	0%	1
Italy	1	0%	1
Libya	1	0%	1
Netherlands	2	100%	2
New Zealand	1	100%	1
Poland	4	50%	4
Portugal	1	0%	1
Slovakia	1	100%	1
Sweden	1	100%	1
UAE	1	0%	1
UK	4	50%	4
Ukraine	1	0%	1
United States	121	38%	140
Total	**179**	**40%**	**198**

* Disclosure may refer to partial or full disclosure of the requested account data. If Reddit disclosed any data in response to a request, it is counted in the disclosure rate. The disclosure rate is calculated using the total number of requests rather than the total number of identifiers cited.

Chart 53 : Emergency Disclosure Request Trending



Fraudulent Emergency Disclosure Requests

Emergency disclosure requests require companies like Reddit to enact a high degree of vigilance and scrutiny, as they neither follow a standard format nor include the same level of oversight as formal legal process. Over the past few years, the tech industry has faced an increase in targeted attempts to obtain account information through fraudulent EDRs and impersonation of law enforcement officials. If we receive a fraudulent EDR, we reject it and report the fake request to law enforcement for further investigation.

Reddit did not identify any fraudulent emergency requests during this reporting period.

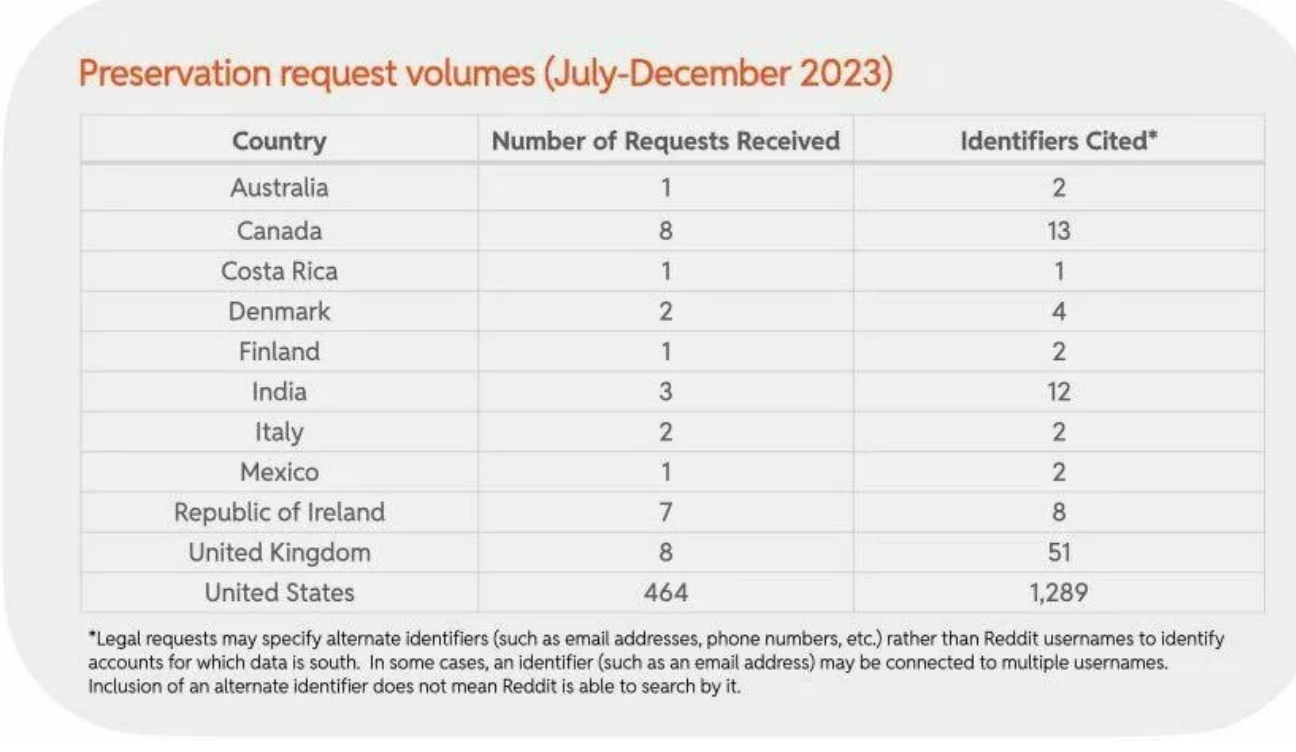
Preservation Requests

In addition to requesting the disclosure of account information, government and law enforcement entities also send legal requests directing Reddit to temporarily save certain account information. These preservation requests are ordinarily issued in anticipation of obtaining legal process (e.g., a subpoena, court order, or warrant) and require companies like Reddit to make a copy of the existing account information to ensure the data is not edited, altered, or destroyed in the meantime. Notably, preservation requests can only require retention of information already in the account when the request is received; a preservation request cannot compel Reddit to preserve new data on an ongoing basis, or capture data that is no longer contained in the account. A legally valid preservation request may result in account information being retained beyond Reddit's standard retention period.

Independent of whether Reddit preserves data pursuant to a preservation request, we will not disclose the preserved information to law enforcement unless and until Reddit receives valid legal process. After the requested preservation period lapses, Reddit purges the preserved data unless it receives a request to extend the preservation.

From July to December 2023, Reddit received 498 preservation requests from government and law enforcement agencies across the globe, representing a 3% decrease from the prior six month period.

Chart 54 : Preservation request volumes (July-December 2023)



Preservation request volumes (July-December 2023)

Country	Number of Requests Received	Identifiers Cited*
Australia	1	2
Canada	8	13
Costa Rica	1	1
Denmark	2	4
Finland	1	2
India	3	12
Italy	2	2
Mexico	1	2
Republic of Ireland	7	8
United Kingdom	8	51
United States	464	1,289

*Legal requests may specify alternate identifiers (such as email addresses, phone numbers, etc.) rather than Reddit usernames to identify accounts for which data is south. In some cases, an identifier (such as an email address) may be connected to multiple usernames. Inclusion of an alternate identifier does not mean Reddit is able to search by it.

Private Party Requests for Account Information

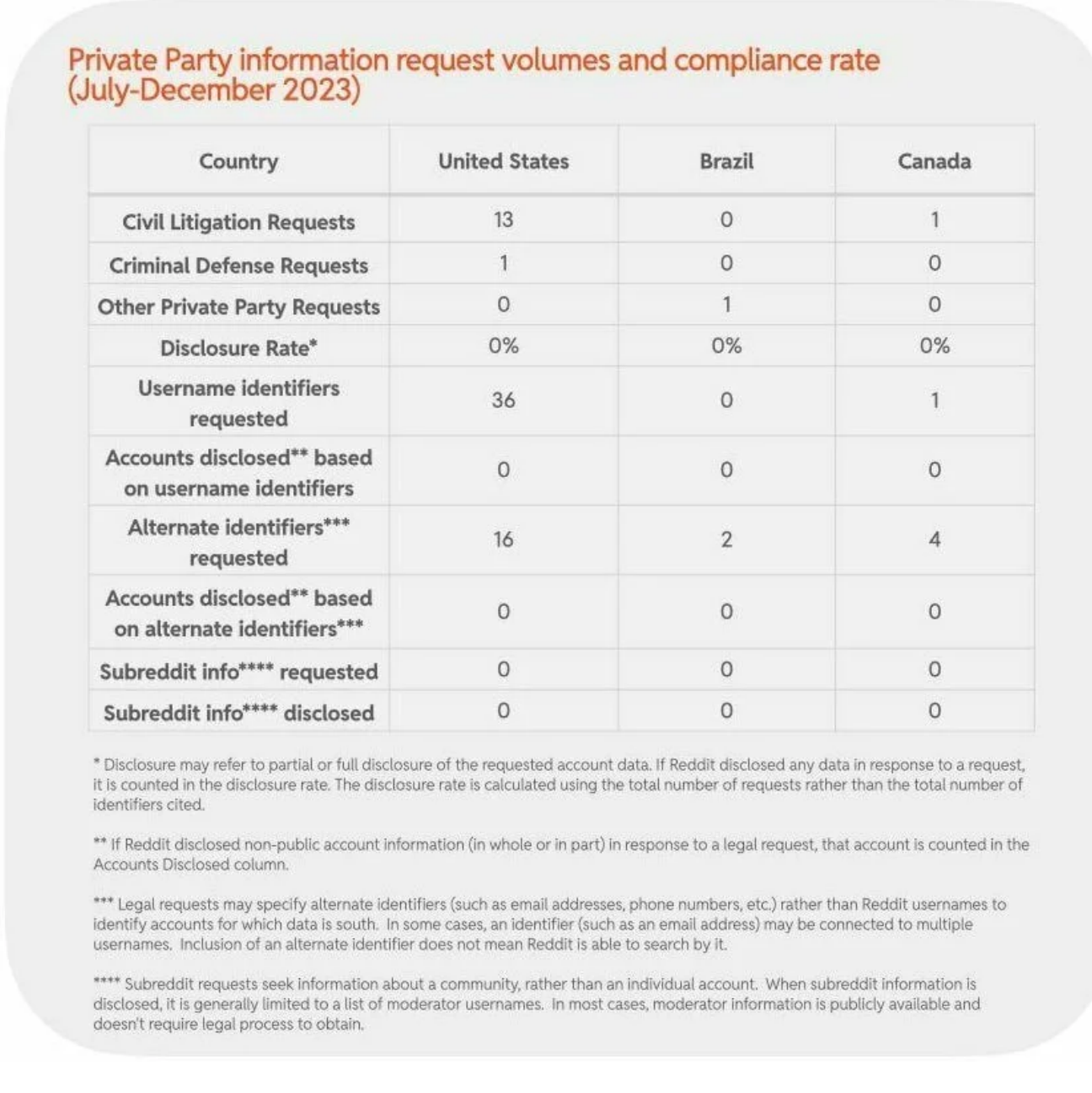
While government and law enforcement agencies submit the vast majority of the legal requests for account information that we receive, private parties also send Reddit legal process (e.g. subpoenas) seeking disclosure of information for use in criminal defense or civil litigation.

Reddit carefully reviews each request for compliance with applicable laws and regulations. If we determine that a request is invalid, overbroad, or in violation of applicable laws, Reddit will object to or challenge the request.

Starting with this report, Reddit will provide a more detailed breakdown of private party requests, including the identifiers specified.

Between July and December 2023, Reddit received 16 private party requests for account information from three different countries. Of these, 14 requests originated from the United States. Reddit disclosed account information in response to zero of these global requests.

Chart 55 : Private Party information request volumes and disclosure rate (July-December 2023)



Private Party information request volumes and compliance rate (July-December 2023)

Country	United States	Brazil	Canada
Civil Litigation Requests	13	0	1
Criminal Defense Requests	1	0	0
Other Private Party Requests	0	1	0
Disclosure Rate*	0%	0%	0%
Username identifiers requested	36	0	1
Accounts disclosed** based on username identifiers	0	0	0
Alternate identifiers*** requested	16	2	4
Accounts disclosed** based on alternate identifiers***	0	0	0
Subreddit info**** requested	0	0	0
Subreddit info**** disclosed	0	0	0

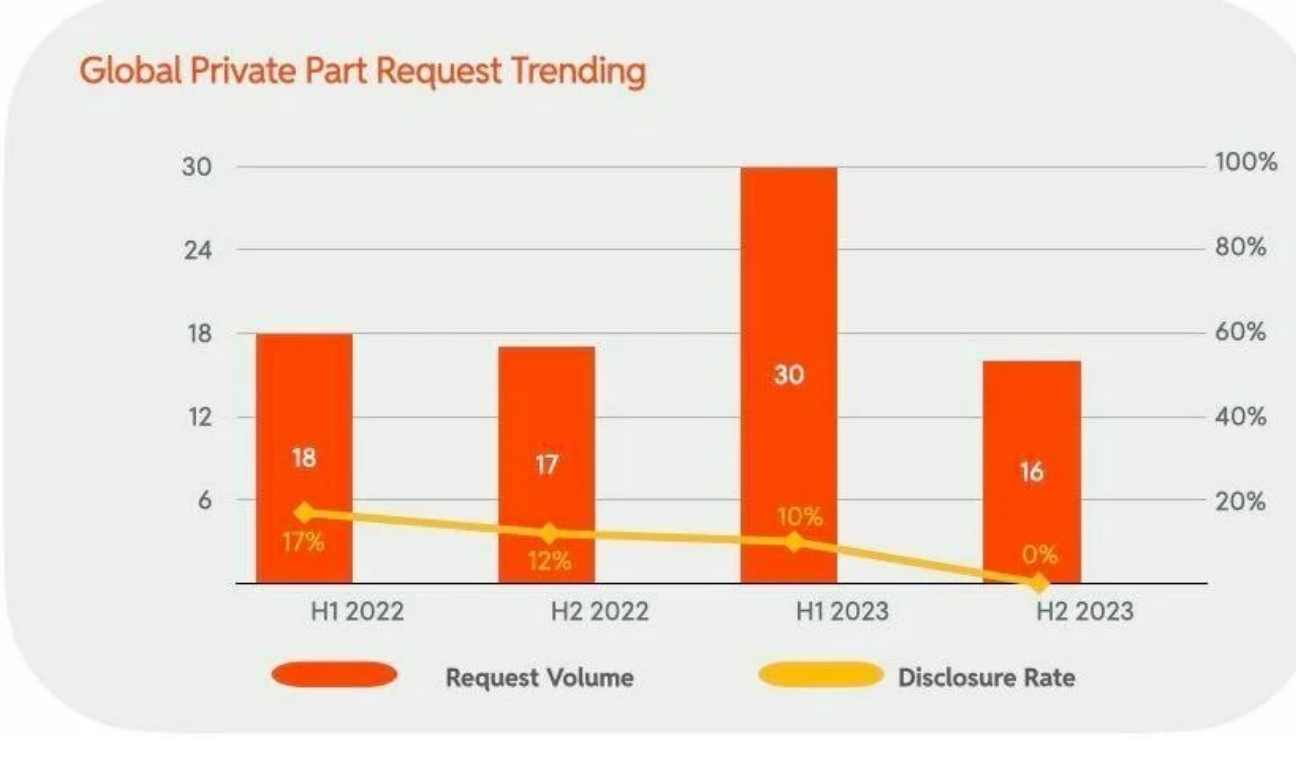
* Disclosure may refer to partial or full disclosure of the requested account data. If Reddit disclosed any data in response to a request, it is counted in the disclosure rate. The disclosure rate is calculated using the total number of requests rather than the total number of identifiers cited.

** If Reddit disclosed non-public account information (in whole or in part) in response to a legal request, that account is counted in the Accounts Disclosed column.

*** Legal requests may specify alternate identifiers (such as email addresses, phone numbers, etc.) rather than Reddit usernames to identify accounts for which data is south. In some cases, an identifier (such as an email address) may be connected to multiple usernames. Inclusion of an alternate identifier does not mean Reddit is able to search by it.

**** Subreddit requests seek information about a community, rather than an individual account. When subreddit information is disclosed, it is generally limited to a list of moderator usernames. In most cases, moderator information is publicly available and doesn't require legal process to obtain.

Chart 56 : Global Private Party Request Trending

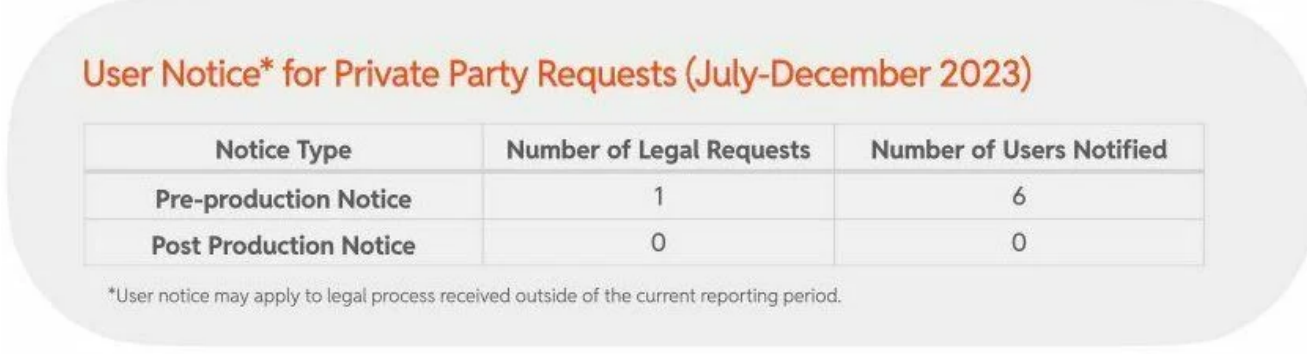


User Notice for Private Party Requests

In cases where Reddit receives a valid private party request for which Reddit may be required to provide responsive data, Reddit will attempt to notify impacted users prior to producing data. Reddit does not typically provide user notice regarding invalid or otherwise inactionable private party requests.

Between July and December 2023, Reddit provided user notice for 6% of private party requests received during this period. We provided pre-production notice for one private party request, but no account data was ultimately disclosed in response to that request.

Chart 57 : User Notice for Private Party Requests (July-December 2023)*



User Notice* for Private Party Requests (July-December 2023)

Notice Type	Number of Legal Requests	Number of Users Notified
Pre-production Notice	1	6
Post Production Notice	0	0

*User notice may apply to legal process received outside of the current reporting period.

User Access Requests

Reddit users can request a copy of their own Reddit account information (known as "access requests"). These requests may include EU General Data Protection Regulation ("GDPR") data subject access requests and California Consumer Privacy Act ("CCPA") consumer information requests.

In the second half of 2023, Reddit received 31,852 access requests, amounting to a 78% decrease compared to the first half of last year. For more context around the fluctuation in user access request volumes, please refer to the same section of our prior transparency report.

The below tables show the global distribution of user access requests for the second half of 2023.

For more information on this process, please refer to our Privacy Policy.

Chart 58 : User Access Requests by Continent (July-December 2023)

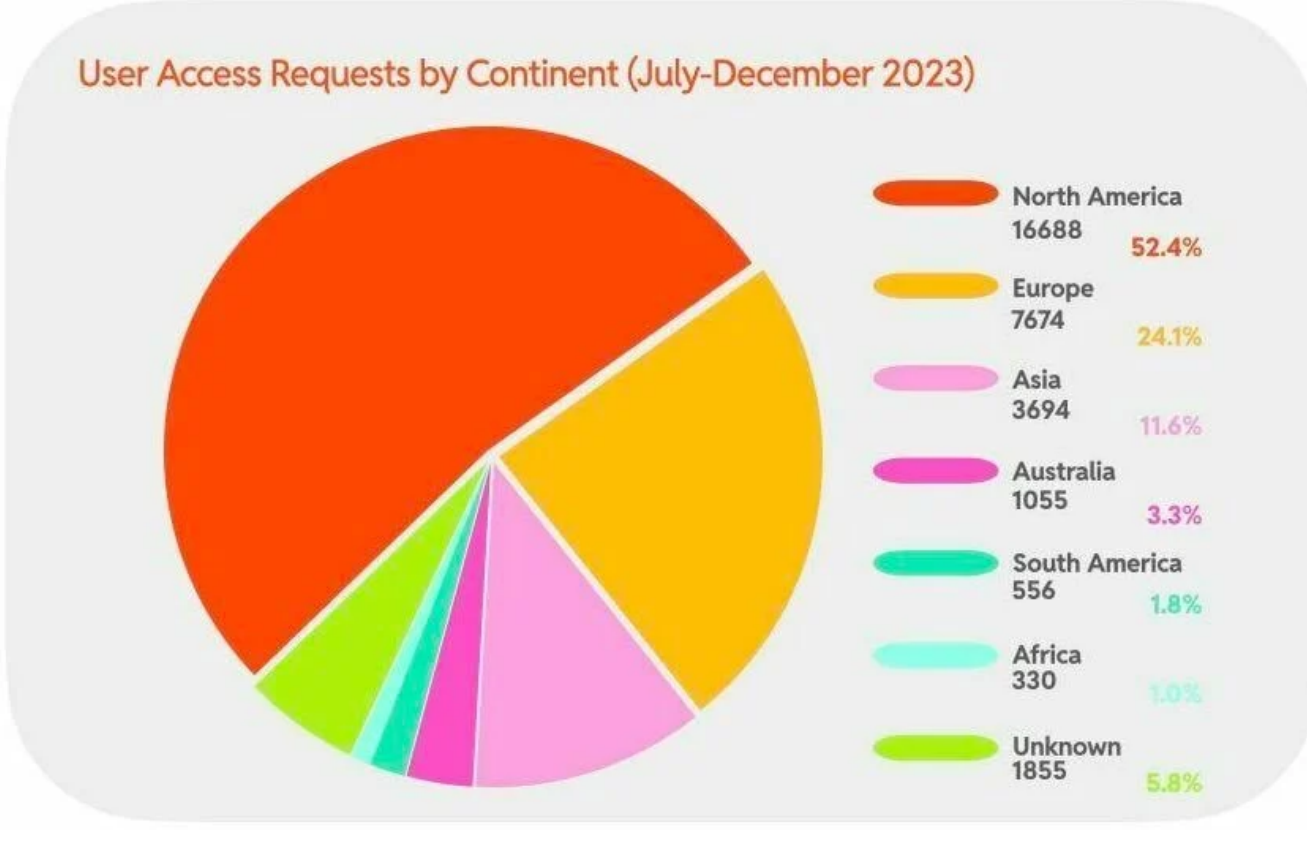
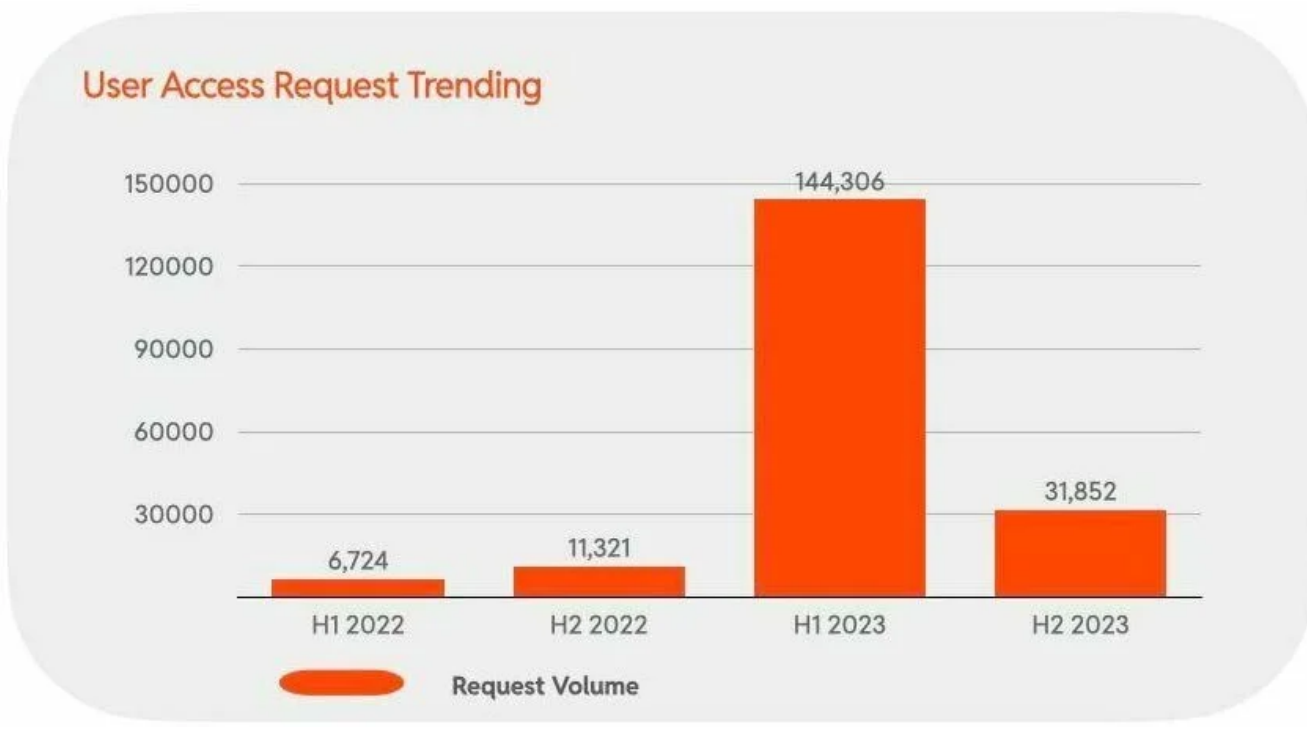


Chart 59 : User Access Request Trending



Appendix

Links to previous Transparency Reports (HERE)

- Transparency Report : Jan - Jun 2023 (LINK) (PDF)
- Transparency Report : Jan - Dec 2022 (LINK) (PDF)
- Transparency Report* : Jul - Dec 2022 (LINK) (PDF)
- Transparency Report : Jan - Dec 2021 (LINK) (PDF)
- Transparency Report : Jan - Dec 2020 (LINK) (CSV)
- Transparency Report : Jan - Dec 2019 (LINK)
- Transparency Report : Jan - Dec 2018 (LINK)
- Transparency Report : Jan - Dec 2017 (LINK)
- Transparency Report : Jan - Dec 2016 (HTML)
- Transparency Report : Jan - Dec 2015 (HTML)
- Transparency Report : Jan - Dec 2014 (HTML) (PDF)

** Legal Requests only*

Link to Quarterly Security Reports

- Q4 2023
- Q3 2023
- Q2 2023
- Q1 2023
- Q4 2022
- Q3 2022
- Q2 2022
- Q1 2022
- Q3 2021
- Q2 2021
- Q1 2021

Data available for download

Transparency Report: July - December 2023 (PDF)

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